

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Cārvāka / Lokāyata - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Cārvāka / Lokāyata

REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST

01

HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly)

02

EPISTEMOLOGY — PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE PRAMĀṆA

□ Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda: perception alone is a pramāṇa;

03

THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE — VYĀPTI, UPĀDHI, THE SOCRATES SYLLOGISM AND

The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference

04

THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE — AND A CRITICALLY BALANCED VERDICT

Nyāya's reply is architectural: vyāpti is assembled through five

05

METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM — FOUR BHÜTAS, THE REJECTION OF ĀKĀŚA, AND

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible

06

SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS — DEHĀTMAVĀDA, AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS

□ caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ / caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā —

07

THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES — GOD, SOUL, KARMA, REBIRTH, HEAVEN,

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul,

08

ETHICS AND THE POLITICAL-SOCIAL MEANING — AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS JAINA REALITY (2020,

This Cārvāka ethics may be called, therefore, hedonism or the theory

09

COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER-WRITING ARCHITECTURE

In simple words: every Cārvāka answer should show a chain, not a list.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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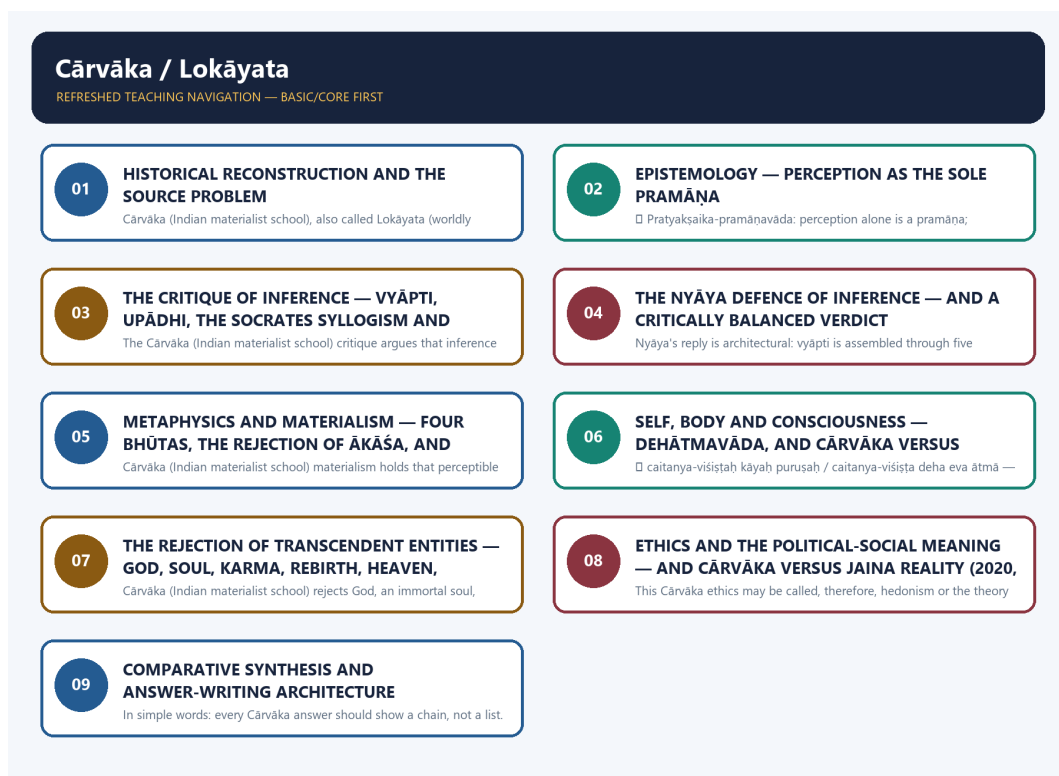
Cārvāka / Lokāyata - Learner-v2 Source-Complete Learning Session

Catalogue identity: Philosophy Optional · Philosophy Paper I - Indian Philosophy · philosophy-paper-i-indian-philosophy-01 **Generation:** g3, 21 August 2026 · **Supersedes:** philosophy-paper-i-indian-philosophy-01: learner-v2:g2 · **Approval:** pending explicit topic approval
Evidence discipline: the lost *Brhaspati-sūtra* and hostile-source problem require careful attribution. Model answers are independent pedagogic practice, never official UPSC keys.

Package practice counts

Component	Count
Direct verified topic-owned PYQs	9
Core diagnostic MCQs	40
Remedial diagnostic MCQs	8
Total diagnostics	48
Original solved Mains models	6 (2 × 10, 2 × 15, 2 × 20)
Consolidated register parts	12 (A-L), plus inherited detailed register
Approval	false

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

REGENERATION LEDGER

Source corpus	g3 treatment
Learner-v2 g2 Basic teaching	Retained in full
Learner-v2 g2 Optional Advanced	Retained in full after practice
g2 detailed register	Retained at the end beneath the new A-L retrieval register
g2 32+10 diagnostics	Replaced by standard 40+8 diagnostics
Verified PYQ corpus	Nine primary-owned questions rebuilt as complete solutions
Original Mains practice	Standardised to six solved models

Answer-worthiness. Perception-only epistemology, critique of inference, four-element materialism, body-self, emergent consciousness and rejection of transcendent entities are **CORE SYLLABUS**. Source historiography, strong versus softened readings, Jayarāśi and controlled modern comparisons are **CORE SUPPORTING DEPTH**. Crude hedonist caricature and invented primary-text certainty are excluded.

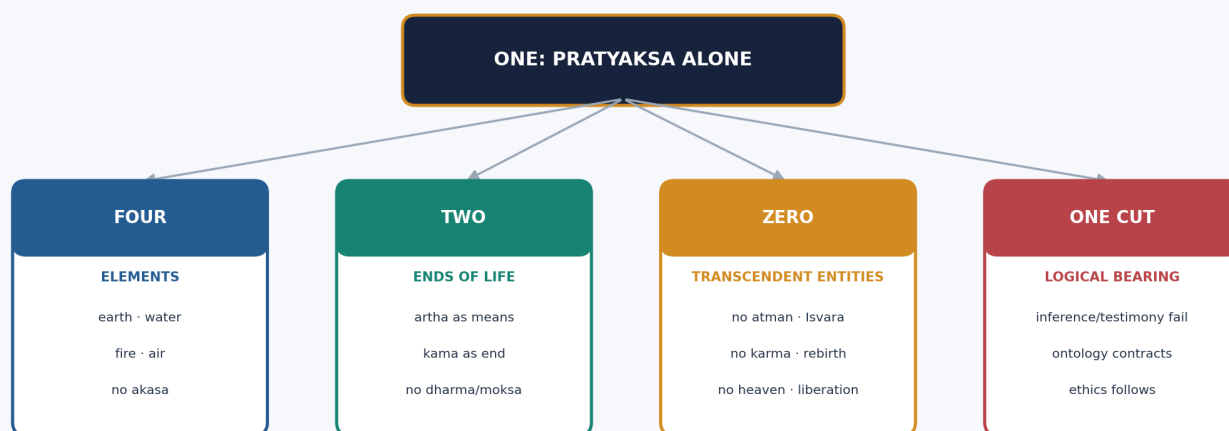
CONTEMPORARY-ANCHOR DISCIPLINE

FACT: **Search finding:** A live August 2026 search found continuing academic interest in Cārvāka/Lokāyata and broad philosophy conferences, but no direct official doctrinal development requiring insertion into the answer core.

ANALYSIS: **Inference:** Contemporary labels such as empiricism, naturalism or dissent may aid comparison only when qualified; they cannot replace historically controlled reconstruction.

CARVAKA: ONTOLOGY AS THE SHADOW OF EPISTEMOLOGY

Only perception is a truth-guaranteeing pramana



ONE pramana · FOUR elements · TWO purusharthas · ZERO transcendent entities

Exam logic: derive each denial from the epistemic restriction; do not present a disconnected list.

Carvaka retrieval map

Complete Basic first. Optional interpretive depth is deliberately withheld until Section D so the core doctrine remains easy to learn and usable in a competent answer.

ONE-SCREEN MAP

SOURCE PROBLEM

- > PERCEPTION AS SOLE PRAMANA
- > INFERENCE CRITIQUE
- > NYAYA DEFENCE
- > FOUR-ELEMENT MATERIALISM
- > BODY-SELF AND EMERGENT CONSCIOUSNESS
- > REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES
- > THIS-WORLDLY ETHICS AND SOCIAL MEANING
- > COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS

This is a route map, not a substitute for the nine complete Basic subtopics below.

SESSION 1 - HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: One-line memory: Cārvāka is known mostly through its critics, so reconstruct firmly but quote cautiously.

Technical definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Historical Reconstruction
- The Source Problem
- In simple words
- One-line memory
- Cārvāka
- Lokāyata

How to use them: Use Historical Reconstruction to define the issue, connect The Source Problem with In simple words to explain it, and use One-line memory to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

Plain-language visual - learning through an opponent's notes

ORIGINAL CARVAKA BOOK

|
X lost
|

What opponents quoted ---> our main evidence

|
One surviving sceptical work (Jāyāsini)

|
CAREFUL RECONSTRUCTION, not blind certainty

In simple words: imagine trying to understand a debater when their own notebook is lost and only the rival team's rebuttal survives. We can still recover the main position because several opponents repeat the same core claims, but we must distinguish secure doctrine from hostile caricature.

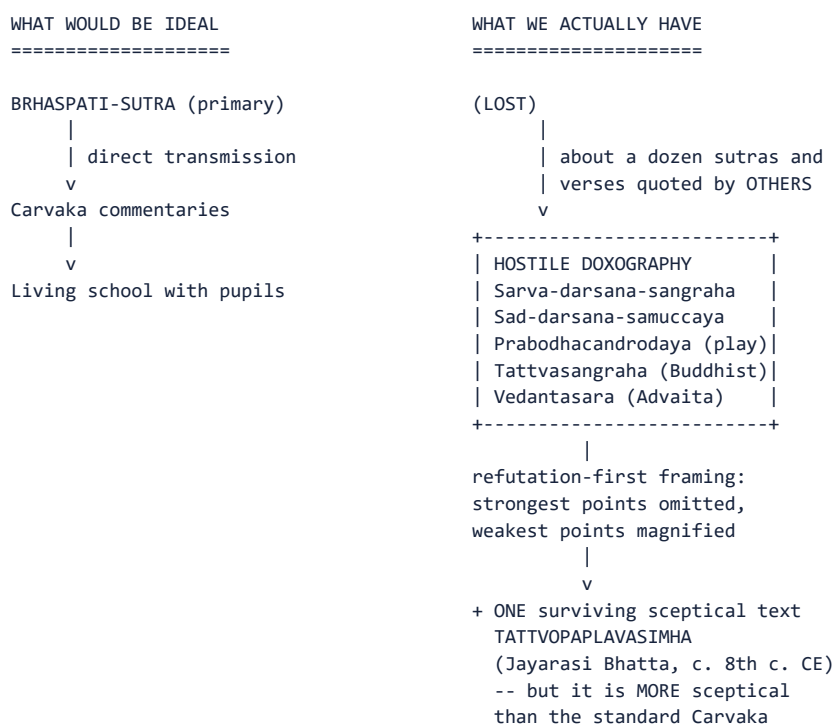
Remember first	Meaning
Cārvāka / Lokāyata / Bārhaspatya	Three names associated with the materialist tradition

Remember first	Meaning
Lost primary text	The <i>Bṛhaspati-sūtra</i> does not survive
Main caution	Write "on the standard doxographical reconstruction"
Why <i>nāstika</i> ?	Rejection of Vedic authority, not simply disbelief in God

One-line memory: Cārvāka is known mostly through its critics, so reconstruct firmly but quote cautiously.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

VISUAL: VISUAL - How we know what we know about Cārvāka



ANALYSIS: Caption. Every claim in this topic passes through a filter of refutation. That does not make reconstruction impossible; it makes *epistemic honesty about the reconstruction* itself a mark-earning move. The examiner rewards a candidate who writes "on the standard doxographical reconstruction" rather than one who quotes a lost text as though it were open on the desk.

1. The three names, and what each one tells you

Name	Literal sense	What it signals	Evidence status
Cārvāka	Possibly from <i>carv</i> , "to chew, to eat" - the doctrine of "eat, drink and be merry"; or from <i>cāru-vāk</i> , "sweet-worded / pleasant of speech"	Either a hostile nickname or a note that the doctrine is superficially attractive	FACT: Both etymologies are given in Chatterjee and Datta; C. D. Sharma adds a third gloss - one who "chews up" merit and demerit
Lokāyata	<i>Lokāyata-mata</i> , "the view of the common people"; a <i>lokāyatika</i> is its holder	The school is popular, worldly, this-worldly; by implication in hostile sources, unrefined	FACT: Chatterjee and Datta; Sharma adds that "commoner" carries a pejorative implication of low taste in the sources
Bārhaspa tya	"Of Bṛhaspati"	Traces the school to Bṛhaspati as its traditional founder	FACT: Sharma: "Bṛhaspati, a heretical teacher, is regarded as the traditional founder of this school. His <i>Sūtra</i> ... has unfortunately perished."

FACT: There is a further doxographical curiosity, reported in both Chatterjee and Datta and Sharma: some accounts identify this Br̥haspati with the *teacher of the gods*, who is said to have propagated materialism among the *asuras* precisely so that, following these attractive teachings, they would come to ruin. CAUTION: That story is polemical theology, not history; quote it only to illustrate how the tradition was framed by its enemies.

ANALYSIS: **Exam use.** The highlighted answer-grabbing line above is the preferred full opening. For a very short answer, write: "Cārvāka, also called Lokāyata and Bārhaspatya, is the materialist and *nāstika* (non-Vedic) school of Indian philosophy."

2. The source problem, stated precisely

FACT: **The facts, as the standard textbooks state them.**

1. No systematic primary work of the school survives. Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not find any systematic work on materialism, nor any organised school of followers as the other philosophical schools possess."
2. The *Br̥haspati-sūtra* is lost. Sharma: about **a dozen** *sūtras* and verses are found quoted or referred to by other authors as the materialistic teachings of Br̥haspati.
3. "Almost every work of the other schools states, for refutation, the materialistic views. Our knowledge of Indian materialism is chiefly based on these" (Chatterjee and Datta).
4. Sharma is blunter about the consequence: "the weak points in this school are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted. So we get only a faint caricature and not a true picture."
5. Sharma adds the decisive historiographical warning: even the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* summary "seems to be based on such accounts", so it does not give independent access to the school.

ANALYSIS: **What follows philosophically.** Three consequences, each usable as a line in an answer:

- (a) MODAL CAUTION : write "on the standard reconstruction", not "Carvaka says in his text".
- (b) CHARITY : where a doctrine has a crude and a defensible version, the crude one is the one an enemy would preserve. Reconstruct the strongest available reading and SAY that you are doing so.
- (c) NON-PARALYSIS : convergence across independent hostile sources on the same doctrinal core (perceptualism, anti-inferentialism, four elements, no soul, no afterlife) is itself evidence.

3. The surviving fragments - what is actually quoted

FACT: Sharma gleans the following from the *Br̥haspati* material quoted across philosophical writings. These are the closest thing to primary text that exists, and they are quoted *by others*:

#	Sūtra (as transmitted)	Doctrine
1	<i>pr̥thivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni</i>	Earth, water, fire and air are the elements
2	<i>tatsamudāye śarīrendriyaviśaya-saṃjñā</i>	Bodies, senses and objects are results of different combinations of the elements
3	<i>kiṇvāḍibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam</i>	Consciousness arises from matter as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents
4	<i>caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ</i>	The person is the body qualified by consciousness
5	<i>kāma evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ</i>	Enjoyment is the only end of human life
6	<i>maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>	Death alone is liberation

FACT: Alongside these, the second act of Kṛṣṇamiśra's allegorical play *Prabodhacandrodaya* summarises the doctrine in a single sweep: "Lokāyata is the only *śāstra*; perception is the only authority; earth, water, fire and air are the only elements; enjoyment is the only end of human existence; mind is only a product of matter. There is no other world; death means liberation."

CAUTION: **Caution to carry through the whole session.** A play written by an opponent, staged as allegory, is a *representation* of the doctrine. It is legitimate evidence of how the school was understood; it is not the school's own voice.

4. Why Cārvāka is nāstika - and the exact sense of the word

FACT: This is a precision point that separates strong scripts from weak ones. Chatterjee and Datta set it out exactly:

Sense of āstika	Meaning in Sanskrit philosophical literature	Is Cārvāka nāstika in this sense?
Primary, classificatory sense	One who accepts the authority of the Vedas	FACT: Yes - this is the sense that generates the six- <i>āstika</i> / three- <i>nāstika</i> division
Secondary sense	One who believes in life after death	FACT: Yes
Modern vernacular sense	"Theist" versus "atheist"	ANALYSIS: Misleading. Sāṃkhya, Mīmāṃsā and early Yoga-adjacent readings are non-theistic yet <i>āstika</i>

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta state the consequence directly: the six orthodox schools are *āstika*, "and the Cārvāka is *nāstika* in both the senses". Jaina and Bauddha schools are *nāstika* on the first criterion but would count as *āstika* on the second, since they accept life after death.

MEMORY: Trap, and it is examined: *Cārvāka is nāstika primarily because it rejects Vedic authority, not merely because it denies God.* If denial of God were the criterion, Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā would also be *nāstika* - and they are not.

5. Why materialism arose - the historical setting

FACT: Sharma gives the standard account: the school "seems to be very old", with references in the epics and in early Buddhist literature; Garbe is quoted to the effect that "even in the pre-Buddhist India proclaimers of purely materialistic doctrines appeared." Sharma locates its rise in the post-Upaniṣadic and pre-Buddhist age and attributes it to:

1. protest against the excessive monkdom of the Brāhmaṇa priests;
2. the externals of ritualism, "which ignored the substance and emphasized the shadow";
3. an Upaniṣadic idealism "unsuited to the commoners";
4. political and social crises, exploitation of the masses by petty rulers, monks and the wealthy class.

FACT: Early Buddhist scripture confirms an environment of such thinkers. The *Sāmaññaphala-sutta* names four contemporaries of the Buddha whom Chatterjee and Datta group as "cunning (*dhūrta*) Cārvākas":

Thinker	Position as reported
Pūraṇa Kassapa	Denies moral responsibility, virtue and vice
Makkhali Gosāla	Denies free will and the possibility of moral effort
Ajita Kesakambalī	Teaches the material origin and destructibility of man, the futility of good action, the impossibility of knowledge
Saṅjaya Belaṭṭhiputta	Will neither affirm, nor deny, nor both, nor even admit that he neither affirms nor denies

FACT: Sharma independently notes Ajita Kesakambalin in the *Majjhima Nikāya* as "a materialist ... who believed only in perception and in four elements", and records that Śāntarakṣita refers to him as *Kambalāśvatara*.

ANALYSIS: **Exam use.** Naming Ajita Kesakambalī gives you a *pre-systematic historical anchor* for four-element materialism that is independent of the hostile Brahmanical doxography - a genuinely strong evidential move in a 15- or 20-marker on sources.

6. Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa - the one surviving text, and why it must be handled carefully

FACT: **The facts.** Chatterjee and Datta: the *Tattvopaplavasīmha*, by Jayarāśi, "probably of the eighth century A.D.", is a "recently discovered manuscript" and "an interesting specimen of Indian absolute scepticism"; its author "is believed to be a Cārvāka (or Lokāyatika) of an **extreme type**." Sharma records the publication data: it is the "single exception" to the absence of extant works, published by the Oriental Institute of Baroda in 1940.

FACT: What Jayarāṣi actually does. He "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of **perceptual** knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements. With a relentless destructive dialectic he exposes the defects of all the usually accepted sources of knowledge." His conclusion, Chatterjee and Datta note, is that of "an anti-intellectualist pragmatist": even on the denial of all theoretical principles and doctrines, practical life will go on as ever with unreflective ease.

ANALYSIS: The distinction that must be preserved.

STANDARD CARVAKA	JAYARASI'S SCEPTICISM
-----	-----
Perception is VALID	Perception is ALSO attacked
Four elements are REAL	Even the elements are not admitted
Positive materialist ontology	NO positive ontology at all
Rejects inference and testimony	Rejects EVERY pramana
= dogmatic empiricism	= universal scepticism (tattva-upaplava, "the upsetting of all principles")

ANALYSIS: Why this matters for the exam. It is tempting, and wrong, to use Jayarāṣi as evidence for what "the Cārvākas" held about perception. If Jayarāṣi is used to establish the school's epistemology, the school's *defining* thesis - that perception alone is a *pramāṇa* - disappears. Use him for exactly two things: (i) as the sole surviving text-witness of the tradition, and (ii) as the internal limit-case showing where consistent Cārvāka scepticism, pressed hard, ends up.

Exam link

Source qualification improves every answer: the lost *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*, hostile doxography and contested attributions must be stated without allowing source caution to erase the convergent doctrinal core.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. CAUTION: Do not write that "Cārvāka wrote the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*". The text is lost; about a dozen *sūtras* survive only as quotations in other authors' works.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not treat the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* as an independent primary source. Sharma explicitly says its summary "seems to be based on" the same refutational accounts.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not use Jayarāṣi's *Tattvopaplavasīmha* to state the Cārvāka theory of knowledge. He attacks perception too, which no standard Cārvāka does.
4. FACT: Do not say Cārvāka is *nāstika* "because it is atheist". It is *nāstika* because it rejects the authority of the Veda - and, in the second textbook sense, because it denies life after death.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not present the "*asura*-deception" story about Bṛhaspati as history.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not conclude from the source problem that "nothing can be known". Convergent hostile testimony still fixes a doctrinal core.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not confuse *Lokāyata* ("view of the common people") with "folk religion". It names a philosophical position, not a devotional practice.

Revision notes

- FACT: Three names: **Cārvāka** (*carv*, to chew / *cāru-vāk*, sweet-worded), **Lokāyata** (*lokāyata-mata*, the view of common people), **Bārhaspatya** (of Bṛhaspati).
- FACT: Bṛhaspati is the traditional founder; his *Sūtra* is lost; about a dozen *sūtras* survive as quotations.
- FACT: Knowledge of the school comes chiefly from works that state its views **in order to refute them**.
- FACT: Sharma's verdict on transmission: strong points omitted, weak points exaggerated - "a faint caricature and not a true picture".
- FACT: Six transmitted *sūtras* to memorise: four elements · bodies-senses-objects from combination · consciousness like intoxicating power · person = body qualified by consciousness · *kāma* the only end · death alone is liberation.
- FACT: *Prabodhacandrodaya* Act II gives the classic one-sentence summary of the school.
- FACT: **Nāstika in both senses**: rejects Vedic authority; denies life after death. Vedic authority is the primary classificatory criterion.

- FACT: *Sāmaññaphala-sutta* names Pūraṇa Kassapa, Makkhali Gosāla, Ajita Kesakambalī and Sañjaya Belaṭṭhiputta as the environment of early scepticism and materialism.
- FACT: Ajita Kesakambalī - "believed only in perception and in four elements" - is the best independent historical anchor for the doctrine.
- FACT: **Jayarāsi Bhaṭṭa**, *Tattvopaplavasīmha*, c. 8th century CE, published Baroda 1940 - the single surviving text, but an extreme sceptic who attacks perception itself.
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka was the **touchstone** every school had to answer; its historical value is critical rather than constructive.
- ANALYSIS: Two-sided verdict to carry: philosophically fertile as critique (Chatterjee-Datta), unsuccessful as a system (Sharma).

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM

START / CONCEPT: HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Historical Reconstruction · The Source Problem · In simple words · One-line memory · Cārvāka · Lokāyata

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: One-line memory: Cārvāka is known mostly through its critics, so reconstruct firmly but quote cautiously.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: That does not make reconstruction impossible; it makes epistemic honesty about the reconstruction itself a mark-earning move.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: FACT: Chatterjee and Datta state the consequence directly: the six orthodox schools are āstika, "and the Cārvāka is nāstika in both the senses".

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

SESSION 2 - EPISTEMOLOGY - PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE PRAMĀṆA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

Technical definition: FACT: Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda: perception alone is a pramāṇa; everything else in the system follows logically from this. FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend logically on their epistemology." FACT: The Cārvāka's test for pramāṇa-hood: knowledge "about which we can have no doubt" and "which must be true to reality". FACT: Both external and internal perception are admitted; consciousness is perceived, an immaterial soul is not. FACT: Cārvāka denies the inference from consciousness to a soul, not consciousness itself. FACT: "Truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one." ANALYSIS: Distinguish laukika (corrigible, practical) from pāramārthika (uncheckable, transcendental) inference; the second is the real target. FACT: Śabda in five steps: words heard are perceived -> what they mean is unperceived -> acceptance runs through a reliability inference -> inference is precarious -> testimony is not independent. FACT: Sharma's reductio: if testimony proved vyāpti, "none would be able to infer anything by himself". FACT: The Veda is rejected as the work of "cunning priests" whose promises benefit only the officiants - an epistemic charge with a sociological edge. ANALYSIS: The single template that kills upamāna, arthāpatti and anupalabdhi: each needs an unperceived universal. ANALYSIS: Sharma's charge: Cārvāka accepts perception and rejects inference from the same standpoint, lacking the saṃvṛti/paramārtha or vyāvahārika/pāramārthika distinction that saves Śūnyavāda and Advaita.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Epistemology
- Perception As The Sole Pramāṇa
- In simple words
- One-line memory
- lower bound
- logically

How to use them: Use Epistemology to define the issue, connect Perception As The Sole Pramāṇa with In simple words to explain it, and use One-line memory to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

Plain-language visual - the knowledge gate

Can I directly experience it?

YES v NO
accept inference/testimony may guide action,
as known but cannot guarantee philosophical certainty

In simple words: Cārvāka treats perception as the only secure entrance to knowledge. Inference and testimony may be useful in daily life, but their conclusions can fail; therefore they do not independently certify unseen realities.

Everyday case	Cārvāka reading
Seeing fire	Directly known through perception
Seeing smoke and expecting fire	A useful expectation, not infallible knowledge
Hearing a trustworthy person	The words are heard; their truth still needs checking
Feeling pain or pleasure	Internally experienced and therefore perceptible

One-line memory: perception gives certainty; other routes may give practical probability.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The pramāṇa ledger of Indian philosophy, and where Cārvāka stands

	pratyakṣa (percep.)	anumāna (infer.)	upamāna (compar.)	śabda (test.)	arthapatti (postul.)	anupalabdhi (non-cogn.)	
CARVAKA	YES	no	no	no	no	no	= 1
Vaisesika	YES	YES	no	no	no	no	= 2
Buddhism	YES	YES	no	no	no	no	= 2
Samkhya / Yoga	YES	YES	no	YES	no	no	= 3
Nyaya	YES	YES	YES	YES	no	no	= 4
Prabhakara Mimamsa	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	no	= 5
Bhatta Mimamsa / Advaita Vedanta	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	= 6

^
|
CARVAKA SITS AT THE MINIMUM OF THE LEDGER.
Everything else in the system follows from that single cell.

ANALYSIS: Caption. This ledger is worth reproducing from memory in any *pramāṇa* question in Paper I. It shows at a glance that the Cārvāka position is not an eccentric outlier but the **lower bound** of a shared Indian debate about how

many independent sources of knowledge there are. Nyāya sits at four; Cārvāka drives the number down to one and forces every other school to justify its additions.

1. The core thesis, stated exactly

FACT: **Thesis (pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda).** Perception alone is a *pramāṇa* - an independent, dependable source of valid knowledge (*pramā*).

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta frame the architecture of the whole system on this thesis: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend **logically** on their epistemology." Every later denial - of soul, God, *karma*, rebirth, heaven and liberation - is a consequence drawn from this one epistemic restriction, not a separate act of unbelief.

FACT: The vocabulary must be precise:

Term	Meaning	Why the exam cares
Pramā	Valid cognition; knowledge of reality	The thing to be explained
Pramāṇa	The <i>means</i> by which <i>pramā</i> arises	The disputed list
Pratyakṣa	Perception	The only item Cārvāka admits
Anumāna	Inference	Rejected as uncertain
Śabda	Verbal testimony, including scripture	Rejected as derivative
Upamāna	Comparison / analogy	Rejected with the rest

ANALYSIS: **The condition Cārvāka imposes.** Chatterjee and Datta state it as a conditional test: "If inference is to be regarded as a *pramāṇa*, it must yield knowledge **about which we can have no doubt** and **which must be true to reality**." Note the strength of the demand. This is not "usually reliable"; it is indubitability plus correspondence. Every subsequent Cārvāka argument is an application of this standard.

2. Two kinds of perception, and why the Cārvāka needs both

FACT: Cārvāka accepts perception in both its classical forms, and the second is often forgotten by candidates:

```

PRATYAKSA
|
+--- BAHYA (external) : through the five external senses --
|   sight, hearing, touch, taste, smell                       |
|                                                             | > both admitted
+--- ANTARA / MANASA (internal) : the mind's immediate      |
|   awareness of pleasure, pain, desire, and                 |
|   consciousness itself                                     |
|                                                             |
|-----
  
```

FACT: This is not a decorative detail. Chatterjee and Datta present the strongest objection to Cārvāka materialism precisely through internal perception: "do we not have a kind of perception, called internal, which gives an immediate knowledge of our mental states? And do we not perceive in these consciousness which is nowhere to be perceived in the external material objects?" The objector's aim is to force the admission of an immaterial substrate.

FACT: **The Cārvāka answer, and it is subtle.** "The Cārvākas admit that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception. But they deny that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material or spiritual entity." Consciousness is *given*; a soul is *not* given. What internal perception delivers is a state of the living body, not evidence of a separate substance.

ANALYSIS: **Exam-critical inference.** Cārvāka is therefore **not** a denier of consciousness. It is a denier of the *inference* from consciousness to an immaterial bearer of consciousness. A script that writes "Cārvāka denies consciousness" has confused materialism with eliminativism and has thrown away the 2024 twenty-marker.

3. Certainty versus practical belief - the distinction that saves the position

ANALYSIS: The most common failure in this topic is to write that "Cārvāka says nobody ever infers anything." That is not the doctrine, and the texts themselves block it.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta record the Cārvāka's own concession: "It is true that in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference. But that only shows that we act **uncritically** on the wrong belief that our inference is true. It is a fact that sometimes our inference comes true and leads to successful results. But it is also a fact that sometimes inference leads to error as well. **Truth is not then an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident,**

and a separable one, that we find only in some inferences."

ANALYSIS: Unpack that last sentence, because it is the philosophical hinge of the whole topic.

For inference to be a PRAMANA, truth would have to be an ESSENTIAL and INSEPARABLE character of the inferential process.

But truth attaches to SOME inferences and not to others.

=> truth is ACCIDENTAL (agantuka) to inference, and SEPARABLE from it.

=> inference is not a truth-GUARANTEERING instrument.

...and yet people go on inferring, and often succeed.
The Carvaka does not deny THAT. He denies that success confers PRAMANA-STATUS.

FACT: The authored knowledge file records the same distinction under the heading *lokasiddha* or *laukika* inference: practical, corrigible, worldly inference tied to future perceptual confirmation is tolerated; **transcendental** inference - from ritual to unseen merit, from world to God, from body to soul - is the real target, because nothing could ever check it perceptually.

Axis	Everyday (laukika / vyāvahārika) inference	Transcendental (alaukika / pāramārthika) inference
Example	Smoke on a hill, so probably fire; dark clouds, so probably rain	Ritual now, so heaven later; world exists, so God made it
Corrigibility	FACT: Can be checked by later perception	ANALYSIS: In principle uncheckable
Cārvāka attitude	ANALYSIS: Tolerated as practical habit; denied <i>pramāṇa</i> -status	FACT: Rejected outright
What the exam wants	The distinction stated in one sentence	The target of the critique identified correctly

4. Why śabda falls - the argument in five steps

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta give a compact and precise argument, worth reproducing as numbered steps:

1. Testimony consists of **words** (*śabda*). Insofar as words are heard through our ears, they are **perceived** - and knowledge of words is therefore perceptual and quite valid.
2. But insofar as those words *suggest or mean* things not within our perception, and aim at giving knowledge of unperceived objects, "they are not free from error and doubt."
3. Reliance on an authority always proceeds through a suppressed inference. The believer's mind runs: "This authority should be accepted because it is reliable, and all reliable authority should be accepted."
4. That is an inference. "Being based on inference, knowledge derived from verbal testimony or authority is **as precarious as inference**."
5. Therefore testimony is not an *independent* source of knowledge.

FACT: **The special case of the Veda.** Chatterjee and Datta report the Cārvāka verdict without softening: "The authority of the Vedas ... is held in high esteem by many. But in reality the Vedas are the works of some cunning priests who earned their living by duping the ignorant and the credulous. With false hopes and promises the Vedas persuade men to perform Vedic rites, the only tangible benefit of which goes to the priests who officiate and enjoy the emoluments."

ANALYSIS: Two distinctions to keep clean.

- (1) WORDS AS SOUNDS : perceived, and therefore fine.
WORDS AS EVIDENCE : not perceived, and therefore suspect.
- (2) REJECTING TESTIMONY != REJECTING COMMUNICATION.
Language can guide action; it cannot CERTIFY what it reports until perception catches up with it.

FACT: Sharma adds the reinforcing point that testimony cannot be used to rescue inference either: "if testimony proves *vyāpti*, inference would become dependent on testimony, and then **none would be able to infer anything by himself**." That *reductio* is worth a line in any answer on the rejection of inference.

5. Why upamāna, arthāpatti and anupalabdhi fall too

ANALYSIS: Cārvāka's argument is a single template applied repeatedly, and stating the template is more impressive than listing the *pramāṇas*.

Pramāṇa	Its claim	The Cārvāka template applied
Upamāna (Nyāya)	From "the <i>gavaya</i> resembles the cow" plus later sight of the animal, one knows the word's referent	ANALYSIS: The similarity is perceived; the <i>linkage of name to kind</i> is a generalisation reaching beyond what is perceived, hence inferential and insecure
Arthāpatti (Mīmāṃsā)	Devadatta is fat, yet does not eat by day; therefore he eats by night	ANALYSIS: A postulation to remove an inconsistency - but the postulated fact is unperceived, and the necessity of the postulation is itself a generalisation
Anupalabdhi (Bhāṭṭa, Advaita)	Non-apprehension of the jar yields knowledge of its absence	ANALYSIS: Requires the rule "if it existed here it would have been perceived", which is a universal not given in any single perception

ANALYSIS: **The template in one line, for the answer script:** *every candidate pramāṇa other than perception depends on a universal proposition, and no universal proposition is perceived.* That single sentence disposes of the whole list and shows the examiner you understand the structure rather than the catalogue.

6. What the position buys, and what it costs

	Strength FACT:	Cost ANALYSIS:
Epistemic	An austere, honest criterion; no unfalsifiable postulates	Knowledge shrinks to the present-and-perceived; science and history become impossible as <i>knowledge</i>
Ontological	No inflated metaphysics; explanatory economy	Cannot account for micro-entities, other minds or the past
Religious	Immunity to priestly manipulation and unverifiable promises	Loses any account of moral order beyond prudence
Dialectical	Forces every rival to justify each additional <i>pramāṇa</i>	Invites the self-refutation charge (Subtopic 3)

Exam link

Route this foundation into 2019 Q5(c), 2021 Q5(e) and 2025 Q5(a): define *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*, distinguish certainty from practical expectation, and derive the rejection of testimony and transcendence.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

- ANALYSIS: Do not write "Cārvāka accepts only perception **and** ordinary experience" as if these were two things. Ordinary experience is admitted as perception.
- FACT: Do not forget internal perception. Its admission is what makes Cārvāka a materialist about consciousness rather than a denier of consciousness.
- ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka rejects language or communication. It rejects testimony's claim to *independent pramāṇa-status*.
- ANALYSIS: Do not list the rejected *pramāṇas* without giving the single template that rejects them all: each rests on an unperceived universal.
- ANALYSIS: Do not attribute the *vyāvahārika / pāramārthika* level-distinction to Cārvāka as a historical doctrine. Sharma's point is precisely that Cārvāka lacks it; offering it is a philosophical *repair*, and it must be labelled as such.
- ANALYSIS: Do not confuse the Cārvāka's demand ("no doubt whatever, and true to reality") with modern fallibilist standards. The strength of the demand is what drives the entire critique.
- ANALYSIS: Do not say the Vedas are rejected "because they are old" or "because they are religious". They are rejected because their authority cannot be perceptually certified and their content promises the unperceivable.

Revision notes

- FACT: *Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*: perception alone is a *pramāṇa*; everything else in the system follows logically from this.
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend logically on their epistemology."
- FACT: The Cārvāka's test for *pramāṇa*-hood: knowledge "about which we can have no doubt" and "which must be true to reality".
- FACT: Both **external** and **internal** perception are admitted; consciousness is perceived, an immaterial soul is not.
- FACT: Cārvāka denies the *inference* from consciousness to a soul, not consciousness itself.
- FACT: "Truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a **separable** one."
- ANALYSIS: Distinguish *laukika* (corrigible, practical) from *pāramārthika* (uncheckable, transcendental) inference; the second is the real target.
- FACT: *Śabda* in five steps: words heard are perceived -> what they *mean* is unperceived -> acceptance runs through a reliability inference -> inference is precarious -> testimony is not independent.
- FACT: Sharma's reductio: if testimony proved *vyāpti*, "none would be able to infer anything by himself".
- FACT: The Veda is rejected as the work of "cunning priests" whose promises benefit only the officiants - an epistemic charge with a sociological edge.
- ANALYSIS: The single template that kills *upamāna*, *arthāpatti* and *anupalabdhi*: each needs an unperceived universal.
- ANALYSIS: Sharma's charge: Cārvāka accepts perception and rejects inference **from the same standpoint**, lacking the *saṃvṛti/paramārtha* or *vyāvahārika/pāramārthika* distinction that saves Śūnyavāda and Advaita.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - EPISTEMOLOGY - PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE PRAMĀṆA

START / CONCEPT: EPISTEMOLOGY - PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE PRAMĀṆA

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Epistemology · Perception As The Sole Pramāṇa · In simple words · One-line memory · lower bound · logically

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: FACT: *Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*: perception alone is a *pramāṇa*; everything else in the system follows logically from this. FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend logically on their epistemology." FACT: The Cārvāka's test for *pramāṇa*-hood: knowledge "about which we can have no doubt" and "which must be true to reality". FACT: Both external and internal perception are admitted; consciousness is perceived, an immaterial soul is not. FACT: Cārvāka denies the inference from consciousness to a soul, not consciousness itself. FACT: "Truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one." ANALYSIS: Distinguish *laukika* (corrigible, practical) from *pāramārthika* (uncheckable, transcendental) inference; the second is the real target. FACT: *Śabda* in five steps: words heard are perceived -> what they mean is unperceived -> acceptance runs through a reliability inference -> inference is precarious -> testimony is not independent. FACT: Sharma's reductio: if testimony proved *vyāpti*, "none would be able to infer anything by himself". FACT: The Veda is rejected as the work of "cunning priests" whose promises benefit only the officiants - an epistemic charge with a sociological edge. ANALYSIS: The single template that kills *upamāna*, *arthāpatti* and *anupalabdhi*: each needs an unperceived universal. ANALYSIS: Sharma's charge: Cārvāka accepts perception and rejects inference from the same standpoint, lacking the *saṃvṛti/paramārtha* or *vyāvahārika/pāramārthika* distinction that saves Śūnyavāda and Advaita.

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v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: FACT: Chatterjee and Datta frame the architecture of the whole system on this thesis: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend logically on their epistemology." Every later denial - of soul, God, karma, rebirth, heaven and liberation - is a consequence drawn from this one epistemic restriction, not a separate act of unbelief.

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v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Chatterjee and Datta present the strongest objection to Cārvāka materialism precisely through internal perception: "do we not have a kind of perception, called internal, which gives an immediate knowledge of our mental states?"

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v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats *pratyakṣa* (perception) as the only independent *pramāṇa* (means of valid knowledge), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

SESSION 3 - THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE - VYĀPTI, UPĀDHI, THE SOCRATES SYLLOGISM AND SELF-REFUTATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: This is why the correct one-line statement of the doctrine is: the Cārvāka critique of inference is a critique of the grounding of vyāpti, not of syllogistic validity.

Technical definition: The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference cannot establish certainty because vyāpti (invariable concomitance) cannot be universally known without circular inference and may always be defeated by an undiscovered upādhi (hidden limiting condition).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference cannot establish certainty because vyāpti (invariable concomitance) cannot be universally known without circular inference and may always be defeated by an undiscovered upādhi (hidden limiting condition).

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The Critique Of Inference
- Vyāpti
- Upādhi
- The Socrates Syllogism
- Self-Refutation
- In simple words

How to use them: Use The Critique Of Inference to define the issue, connect Vyāpti with Upādhi to explain it, and use The Socrates Syllogism to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference cannot establish certainty because vyāpti (invariable concomitance) cannot be universally known without circular inference and may always be defeated by an undiscovered upādhi (hidden limiting condition).

Plain-language visual - why smoke may mislead

Observed many times: SMOKE -> FIRE

|

v

Hidden condition may exist: wet fuel / special cause

|

v

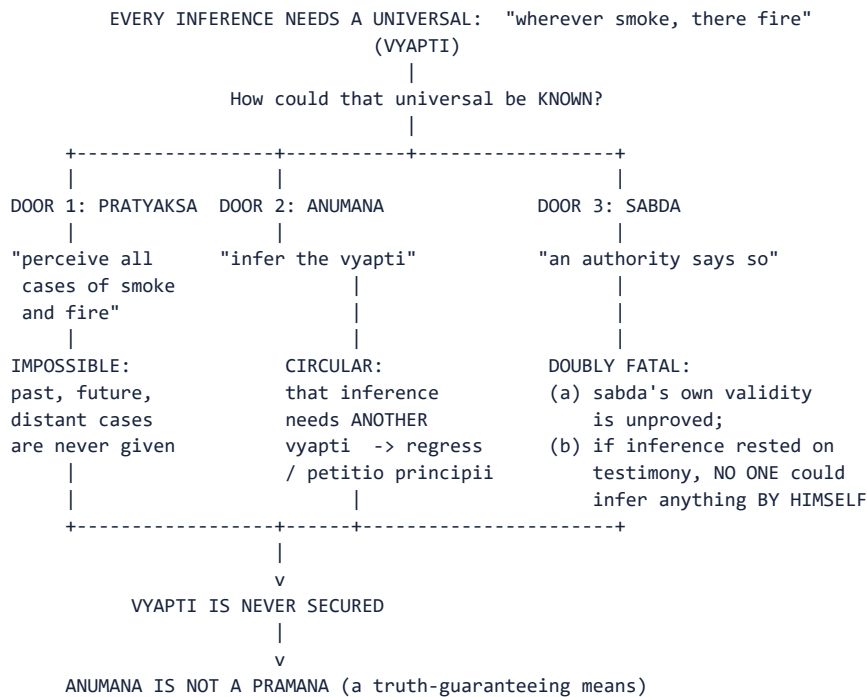
So "all smoke has fire" is not guaranteed merely by past cases

In simple words: inference needs a universal link called *vyāpti*. Cārvāka asks how anyone can inspect every past, present, future and distant case. A hidden condition (*upādhi*) may explain why the relation held in observed cases but fail elsewhere.

Term	Easy meaning
<i>Vyāpti</i>	Exceptionless relation used by inference
<i>Upādhi</i>	Hidden condition that limits an apparently universal rule
Induction	Moving from observed cases to a universal rule
Deduction	Applying that universal rule to a particular case

One-line memory: if induction cannot secure the universal premise, deduction cannot rescue the conclusion.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The three-door trap: how vyāpti is cornered



ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Draw this in the answer booklet. Three doors, all shut - that is the entire 2025 ten-marker, and the spine of the 2018, 2019 and 2022 questions. Notice that Door 3 is shut *twice*, and the second bolt (Sharma's "none would be able to infer anything by himself") is the one most candidates miss.

1. The doctrine, stated exactly

FACT: **Thesis.** *Anumāna* is not a *pramāṇa*, because inference is "a mere leap in the dark" (Sharma): we proceed from the known to the unknown, and there is no certainty in this, "though some inferences may turn out to be **accidentally** true."

FACT: **The structural point.** Inference is a movement from a perceived mark (*liṅga*, e.g. smoke) to an unperceived *sādhya* (e.g. fire), licensed by an invariable concomitance (*vyāpti*) between them. Chatterjee and Datta present the Naiyāyika's own fuller statement of the inference - "all cases of smoke are cases of fire; this mountain is a case of smoke; therefore this is a case of fire" - and then locate the Cārvāka attack precisely: the argument "would be acceptable only if the **major premise**, stating the invariable relation between the middle term and the major, were beyond doubt."

ANALYSIS: The move to memorise. The Cārvāka never attacks the *form* of the inference. He grants that if the major premise were secure the conclusion would follow. He attacks the **licence** - the universal proposition that makes the movement legitimate. This is why the correct one-line statement of the doctrine is: *the Cārvāka critique of inference is a critique of the grounding of vyāpti, not of syllogistic validity*.

2. Door 1 - vyāpti cannot be established by perception

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "this invariable relation (*vyāpti*) can be established only if we have a knowledge of **all** cases of smoke and presence of fire. This, however, is not possible, as we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing **now** in different parts of the world, to speak nothing of those which existed in the **past** or will exist in the **future**."

OBSERVED SET		UNIVERSAL CLAIMED
-----		-----
[kitchen fire]		ALL smoke, everywhere,
[hill fire]	---- ? ---->	at every time, past,
[hearth fire]		present and future
[...n cases]		
finite, present,		infinite, temporally
local, contingent		unbounded, exceptionless
++> the gap here is not a gap of DEGREE. It is a gap of KIND.		

FACT: **The class-character (sāmānya) rejoinder, and the Cārvāka's answer.** This is the sharpest exchange in the topic and almost no candidate reproduces it. The Naiyāyika-style objector says: granted we cannot perceive all

individual smokes, but can we not perceive the **class-characters** "smokeness" (*dhūmatva*) and "fireness" (*vahnitva*), and perceive a relation *between the universals*, and thereby license the inference?

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta record the Cārvāka's two-part reply verbatim in substance:

1. Even granting perception of a relation between smokeness and fireness, "we cannot know therefrom any invariable relation between **all individual cases** of smoke and fire. To be able to infer a **particular** fire, we must know that it is inseparably related to the **particular** smoke perceived."
2. Worse, "it is not possible even to **know by perception** what 'smokeness' ... is, because we do not perceive all cases of smoke."

ANALYSIS: **What this exchange really shows.** The Cārvāka refuses to let the Naiyāyika escape the particular-universal gap by relocating it in the universals: the same finitude that blocks the enumeration of instances blocks the perceptual grasp of the class-character. Chatterjee and Datta conclude for him: "the difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal, therefore, remains here as before."

3. Door 2 - vyāpti cannot be established by inference

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "Neither can it be said to be based on another inference, because it will involve a **petitio principii**, since the validity of that inference again has to be similarly proved."

FACT: Sharma sharpens the same point into a pair:

```
DEDUCTION : "All men are mortal; Socrates is a man; so Socrates is mortal."
            The conclusion is ALREADY CONTAINED in the major premise.
            => petitio principii, an argument in a circle.

INDUCTION : offered to establish the major premise.
            But induction "proceeds unwarrantedly from the known to the
            unknown."
            => the major premise is never secured.

RESULT      : "Induction is uncertain and deduction is argument in a circle.
            The logicians, therefore, find themselves stuck up in the mud
            of inference." (Sharma, quoting the Carvaka gibe)
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ANALYSIS: **Why this is not merely a dilemma but a trap.** Each horn is repaired only by the other. Deduction's circularity is cured by grounding the major premise inductively; induction's insecurity is cured by grounding it deductively. The Cārvāka's point is that the two cures are the same wound seen from two directions.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta add the causal variant, which candidates often think is a way out: "can we not base our knowledge of the invariable relation between smoke and fire on a **causal** relation between them?" The Cārvāka reply: "a causal relation, being only a kind of invariable relation, cannot be established by perception owing to the same difficulties."

4. Door 3 - vyāpti cannot be established by testimony

FACT: Two independent bolts, and both should appear in a 15-marker:

1. FACT: "Nor can this *vyāpti* be based on the testimony (*śabda*) of reliable persons ... For, the validity of testimony **itself requires to be proved by inference**" (Chatterjee and Datta). Grounding inference in testimony and testimony in inference is a closed circle.
2. FACT: "Besides, if inference always depended on testimony, **no one could infer anything by himself**" (Chatterjee and Datta; Sharma states the same *reductio*). Inference is manifestly a first-person cognitive capacity; making it parasitic on the word of another misdescribes what inference is.

5. The upādhi problem - the deepest cut

FACT: **Statement.** Even where two things are repeatedly observed together, an unnoticed condition (*upādhi*) may be doing the work; so observed constancy never establishes *unconditional* concomitance.

FACT: **The textbook example, exactly as Chatterjee and Datta give it** - and note that it runs in the direction most candidates get backwards:

```
A man perceives fire accompanied by smoke, many times.
On another occasion he perceives FIRE and infers SMOKE.
                        ^^^^                ^^^^^
He is liable to ERROR.
Why? Because he failed to notice a CONDITION (upādhi):
```

WETNESS OF FUEL -- on the presence of which ALONE fire is attended with smoke.

The relation "fire -> smoke" holds only ARDRENDHANA-SAMYOGA-SAHITE, i.e. where fire is joined with wet fuel. A red-hot iron ball is fire WITHOUT smoke.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta draw the general conclusion: "So long as the relation between two phenomena is not proved to be **unconditional**, it is an uncertain ground for inference. And unconditionality or **absence of conditions cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden and escape notice**. Inference or testimony cannot be used for proving this unconditionality without a *petitio principii*, because its validity also is being questioned here."

ANALYSIS: **Why the upādhi argument is stronger than the enumeration argument.** The enumeration argument says: you have not checked enough cases. The *upādhi* argument says: **even if you had checked every case you can check, you could not know that you had identified the right property as the ground of the relation**. The first is a problem of quantity; the second is a problem of the *identification of the relevant variable*. Nyāya can answer the first with more observation. It cannot answer the second with more observation alone - which is why it must bring in *tarka* (Subtopic 4).

7. The self-refutation charge (2018, 2019, 2022) - and the Cārvāka's replies

FACT: **The charge, in its strongest form.** Sharma states it without mercy: "To refuse the validity of inference from the empirical standpoint is to refuse to think and discuss. All thoughts, all discussions, all doctrines, all affirmations and denials, all proofs and disproofs are made possible by inference. The Cārvāka view that perception is valid and inference is invalid **is itself a result of inference**. The Cārvāka can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference. Thoughts and ideas, not being material objects, cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred. Hence the self-refuted Cārvāka position is called sheer nonsense and no system of philosophy."

ANALYSIS: Reconstructed as numbered steps, because the examiner wants the logic and not the invective:

1. The Carvaka asserts: "No inference is a valid source of knowledge."
2. That assertion is UNIVERSAL. It quantifies over all inferential acts, past, present and future.
3. No universal proposition is given in any single perception.
4. Therefore the thesis is either (a) itself inferential -- and so self-defeating -- or (b) not knowledge by its own standard.
5. Further: to REFUTE Nyaya, the Carvaka must reason. To be UNDERSTOOD, he must rely on his hearers inferring his meaning from his words.
6. Further still: other MINDS are never perceived. The Carvaka's very act of arguing with an opponent presupposes an inference to another mind.

ANALYSIS: **The Cārvāka's three available replies - a strong answer gives all three and grades them.**

Reply	Formulation	Assessment
R1 - The "no thesis" or vitaṇḍā reply	The Cārvāka advances no positive doctrine; he only <i>destroys</i> the opponent's claim to certainty, using the opponent's own standards. A purely destructive dialectic incurs no commitments.	ANALYSIS: Coherent, but it converts Cārvāka from a philosophy into a method - and Cārvāka <i>does</i> assert four elements, a body-self and <i>kāma</i> as the end, so it cannot be a global reply.
R2 - The softened-thesis reply	The thesis is not "no one ever infers" but "inference never yields apodictic certainty beyond what perception can check". As a claim about certainty rather than usability, it is not refuted by the fact that the Cārvāka reasons.	ANALYSIS: The strongest reply. It is the reading the authored knowledge file endorses, and it rescues consistency at the price of weakening the doctrine into radical fallibilism.
R3 - The level-distinction reply	Concede <i>vyāvahārika</i> validity to inference and deny only <i>pāramārthika</i> validity.	ANALYSIS: Effective against Sharma's "same standpoint" charge, but the level-distinction is, as Sharma says, "unknown to the Cārvāka" - so it is a repair offered by the interpreter, and must be labelled as such.

ANALYSIS: **The verdict to write.** Against the uncompromising formulation the self-refutation charge is decisive; against the softened formulation it loses its force but so does the doctrine, which becomes a fallibilist warning rather than a denial of a *pramāṇa*. The Cārvāka can be consistent or radical, but not both. That sentence answers 2019 Q5(c) almost by itself.

8. Sharma's counter-attack on perception - the *tu quoque*

FACT: Sharma turns the Cārvāka's weapon around: "Perception itself which is regarded as valid by the Cārvāka is **often found untrue**. We perceive the earth as flat but it is almost round. We perceive the earth as static but it is moving round the sun. We perceive the disc of the sun as of a small size, but it is much bigger than the size of the earth. Such perceptual knowledge is **contradicted by inference**."

FACT: And the constructive half, which is really a Kantian point made in an Indian idiom: "pure perception in the sense of mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless conception or thought has arranged into order and has given meaning and significance to the loose threads of sense-data." Sharma cites the Buddhist *Tattvasaṅgraha* for this line of attack.

ANALYSIS: **Why this is devastating and must be handled, not avoided.** If perception is fallible *and* is corrected by inference, then the very hierarchy Cārvāka asserts is inverted: inference becomes the tribunal before which perception is judged. A 15- or 20-mark answer that reproduces the Cārvāka case without meeting this rejoinder is one-sided.

ANALYSIS: **Best Cārvāka response available:** the errors Sharma lists are corrected by **further perception plus practical checking**, not by pure inference - and a fallibilist Cārvāka can concede correction within perception while still denying that any *unperceivable* entity is established by it. That reply is decent for the flat-earth case and weak for the heliocentric case, and you should say so.

Exam link

Primary routes: 2019 Q5(c), 2019 Q6(c) and 2025 Q5(a). Reconstruct *vyāpti* through the three-door argument, add *upādhi*, then face self-refutation.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not write that the Cārvāka says the syllogism is **invalid**. He says the major premise is ungrounded, and that deduction is therefore circular.
2. FACT: Do not give the *upādhi* example backwards. The standard case is inferring **smoke from fire**, which fails because the *upādhi* of **wet fuel** was unnoticed.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not omit the *sāmānya* / class-character exchange. It is the difference between a textbook answer and a top answer.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not present the self-refutation charge without the Cārvāka's replies. A one-sided demolition scores poorly on "critically examine".
5. ANALYSIS: Do not claim all inference is literally impossible for the Cārvāka. Distinguish *pramāṇa*-status from everyday expectation and practical action.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not forget Door 3's second bolt: if inference rested on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not ignore Sharma's *tu quoque* about perceptual error. Meeting it is what "critically evaluate" means.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not treat the causal-relation escape as untouched. A causal relation is itself a species of invariable relation and inherits the same problem.

Revision notes

- FACT: Inference is "a leap in the dark"; some inferences are true only "accidentally".
- FACT: The attack is on the **major premise** (*vyāpti*), never on syllogistic form.
- FACT: **Door 1 (perception)**: all cases past, present and future can never be surveyed.
- FACT: **Class-character reply**: even *dhūmatva* and *vahnitva* cannot be perceptually known, since all instances are not perceived; and universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference.
- FACT: **Door 2 (inference)**: *petitio principii* or infinite regress; deduction is circular, induction unwarranted.

- FACT: Causal relation is only a species of invariable relation and inherits the same defect.
- FACT: **Door 3 (testimony)**: testimony's validity is itself inferred; and "if inference always depended on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself."
- FACT: **Upādhi**: the wet-fuel condition; unconditionality can never be perceptually certified because conditions may remain hidden.
- FACT: *Upādhi* is a problem of the *right variable*, not merely of *sample size* - which is why more observation alone cannot answer it.
- FACT: **Self-refutation**: the universal denial of inference is itself a universal; and other minds, thoughts and ideas are never perceived.
- ANALYSIS: **Three replies**: no-thesis (*vitaṇḍā*) · softened certainty-thesis · level-distinction. The second is strongest; the third is a repair, not a historical doctrine.
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's tu quoque**: flat earth, static earth, small sun - perception errs and is corrected *by inference*.
- ANALYSIS: **Verdict formula**: the Cārvāka may be consistent or radical, but not both.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE - VYĀPTI, UPĀDHI, THE SOCRATES SYLLOGISM AND SELF-REFUTATION

START / CONCEPT: THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE - VYĀPTI, UPĀDHI, THE SOCRATES SYLLOGISM AND SELF-REFUTATION

|
v

EXACT TERMS: The Critique Of Inference · Vyāpti · Upādhi · The Socrates Syllogism · Self-Refutation
· In simple words

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: FACT: Inference is "a leap in the dark"; some inferences are true only "accidentally". FACT: The attack is on the major premise (vyāpti), never on syllogistic form. FACT: Door 1 (perception): all cases past, present and future can never be surveyed. FACT: Class-character reply: even dhūmatva and vahnitva cannot be perceptually known, since all instances are not perceived; and universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference. FACT: Door 2 (inference): petitio principii or infinite regress; deduction is circular, induction unwarranted. FACT: Causal relation is only a species of invariable relation and inherits the same defect. FACT: Door 3 (testimony): testimony's validity is itself inferred; and "if inference always depended on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself." FACT: Upādhi: the wet-fuel condition; unconditionality can never be perceptually certified because conditions may remain hidden. FACT: Upādhi is a problem of the right variable, not merely of sample size - which is why more observation alone cannot answer it. FACT: Self-refutation: the universal denial of inference is itself a universal; and other minds, thoughts and ideas are never perceived. ANALYSIS: Three replies: no-thesis (vitaṇḍā) · softened certainty-thesis · level-distinction.

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v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This is why the correct one-line statement of the doctrine is: the Cārvāka critique of inference is a critique of the grounding of vyāpti, not of syllogistic validity.

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v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Against the uncompromising formulation the self-refutation charge is decisive; against the softened formulation it loses its force but so does the doctrine, which becomes a fallibilist warning rather than a denial of a pramāṇa.

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v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference cannot establish certainty because vyāpti (invariable concomitance) cannot be universally known without circular inference and may always be defeated by an undiscovered upādhi (hidden limiting condition).

SESSION 4 - THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE - AND A CRITICALLY BALANCED VERDICT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons, and a criterion-named verdict on whether they are justified.

Technical definition: Nyāya's reply is architectural: vyāpti is assembled through five distinguishable operations, and the burden of certainty is distributed across them.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons, and a criterion-named verdict on whether they are justified.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The Nyāya Defence Of Inference
- A Critically Balanced Verdict
- In simple words
- One-line memory
- assembled
- bhūyodarśana

How to use them: Use The Nyāya Defence Of Inference to define the issue, connect A Critically Balanced Verdict with In simple words to explain it, and use One-line memory to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya (school of logic and realism) replies that repeated observation, agreement and difference, tarka (hypothetical reasoning) and the elimination of upādhi (hidden limiting conditions) justify defeasible but rationally warranted inference.

Plain-language visual - Nyaya's repair workshop

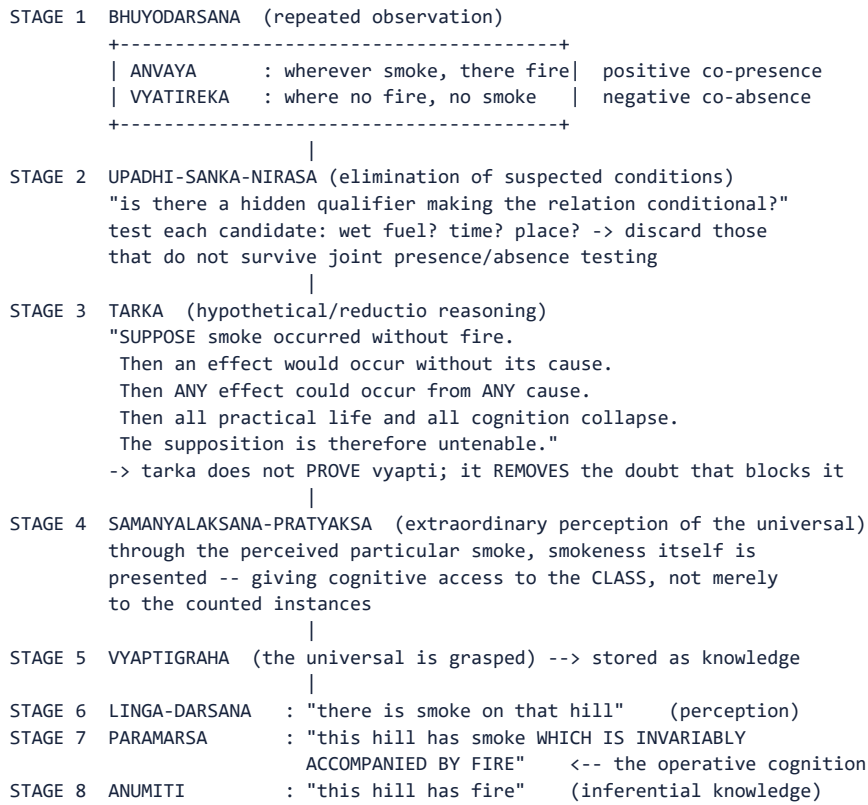
Repeated agreement: where smoke, there fire	(anvaya)
Repeated absence: where no fire, no smoke	(vyatireka)
Search for hidden conditions	(upadhi test)
Reject absurd alternatives	(tarka)
Apply the tested rule to this hill	(paramarsa)

In simple words: Nyāya does not claim that one casual observation proves a universal rule. It builds confidence through positive cases, negative cases, elimination of hidden conditions and rational testing. The final inference occurs when the tested universal relation is applied to the present case.

Cārvāka challenge	Nyāya reply
You have not seen every case	Universal features and systematic observation matter
A hidden condition may exist	Actively search for and eliminate <i>upādhis</i>
Inference is circular	<i>Tarka</i> and repeated agreement/disagreement support <i>vyāpti</i>

One-line memory: Nyāya answers "blind generalisation" with a disciplined method of testing.

VISUAL: VISUAL - How Nyāya actually builds a vyāpti, step by step



ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The Cārvāka argues as if *vyāpti* had to be acquired in one impossible act of total enumeration. Nyāya's reply is architectural: *vyāpti* is **assembled** through five distinguishable operations, and the burden of certainty is distributed across them. Reproducing this eight-stage ladder is the single most effective way to show an examiner that you understand what Cārvāka is actually up against.

1. Why Nyāya cannot simply concede

ANALYSIS: Nyāya is the school of *pramāṇa*-theory. If inference falls, then *upamāna* falls with it, *śabda* loses its warrant, the proofs of God (*kāryāt*, *āyojanāt*, *dhrtyādeḥ*, *padāt/śruteḥ*) collapse, the atomic theory becomes unstateable, and the Nyāya proofs of the self go with them. The Cārvāka attack is therefore not a peripheral irritant but an existential threat, which is why the Naiyāyika reply is so highly developed.

2. Anvaya and vyatireka - the joint method

FACT: **The doctrine.** *Vyāpti* is established by **bhūyodarśana**, repeated observation, but of a particular disciplined kind:

Method	Sanskrit	Form	Function
Method of agreement	anvaya	Wherever <i>hetu</i> , there <i>sādhya</i>	Establishes positive co-presence across varied cases
Method of difference	vyatireka	Wherever <i>sādhya</i> is absent, <i>hetu</i> is absent	Rules out cases where the mark occurs without the probandum
Joint method	anvaya-vyatireka	Both together	The absence of a single counter-instance across wide, varied observation

ANALYSIS: **The philosophical point to make explicit.** The Cārvāka treats repeated observation as mere counting. Nyāya treats it as **structured testing**: it is not the number of positive cases that matters but the survival of the relation through deliberate search for **negative** cases. A relation that survives systematic attempts to find *hetu*-without-*sādhya* has a warrant that a mere tally does not.

3. Upādhi-elimination - meeting the Cārvāka's strongest weapon

FACT: **The Nyāya procedure.** An *upādhi* is defined technically as a condition that pervades the *sādhya* but does not pervade the *hetu*. To test a suspected relation, the Naiyāyika asks whether any such condition can be found; where one is found, the *vyāpti* is reformulated to include it.

BAD VYAPTI : "wherever fire, there smoke"
 UPADHI FOUND: wet fuel (ardra-indhana)
 REPAIR : "wherever fire joined with wet fuel, there smoke"
 RESULT : the conditional relation is not abandoned -- it is
 RESTATED at the correct level of generality.

ANALYSIS: **The concession Nyāya must make, and an honest answer states it.** Nyāya can eliminate *suspected* and *known upādhis*. It cannot demonstrate that **no upādhi** whatever remains undetected. What it claims instead is that a relation which survives systematic testing, negative-case search and *tarka* is **rationally warranted**, not that it is guaranteed by an omniscient survey.

ANALYSIS: **The move that decides the debate.** Nyāya shifts the standard from **impossible omniscience** to **disciplined rational warrant**. The Cārvāka has set a bar - indubitability plus correspondence - that nothing except present perception could clear, and even present perception clears it only if perceptual error is ignored. Nyāya's reply is that this bar is not a criterion of knowledge but a recipe for its abolition.

4. Tarka - the argument the Cārvāka has no answer to

FACT: **What tarka is.** *Tarka* is hypothetical reasoning, *reductio ad absurdum*: it assumes the contradictory of the proposed relation and exhibits the unacceptable consequence. It is expressly **not** an independent *pramāṇa* in Nyāya; it is a *pramāṇa-anugrahaka* - an auxiliary that removes doubt so that *vyāptigraha* can occur.

SUPPOSE : smoke without fire
 THEN : an effect exists without its cause
 THEN : the causal order is arbitrary
 THEN : no expectation, no action, no discourse, no refutation
 BUT : the Carvaka HIMSELF acts, expects, argues and refutes
 THEREFORE: the supposition is untenable (anista-prasanga)

ANALYSIS: **Why this is so powerful against Cārvāka specifically.** The Cārvāka concedes that people act on inference and that action often succeeds. *Tarka* converts that concession into a premise: the intelligibility of the Cārvāka's own practice - including the practice of arguing against Nyāya - presupposes the very regularities he refuses to certify. The Cārvāka can escape only by retreating to the softened thesis (Subtopic 3, reply R2), at which point the dispute becomes verbal rather than doctrinal.

5. Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa - Nyāya's direct answer to the class-character objection

FACT: **The doctrine.** Nyāya admits an extraordinary (*alaukika*) perception in which, through a perceived particular, the **universal** itself is presented - smokeness through this smoke. The authored Nyāya file records the trap explicitly: it is an error to say that universals are not perceived in Nyāya; they are, through *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.

ANALYSIS: **The exchange, laid out for the answer script:**

Move	Claim
Cārvāka	FACT: You cannot perceive all smokes; therefore you cannot perceive smokeness; therefore you have no universal
Nyāya	FACT: The universal is not reached by adding up particulars; it is presented in any particular through extraordinary perception
Cārvāka rejoinder	ANALYSIS: <i>Sāmānyalakṣaṇa</i> is a technical device invented precisely to plug the hole; it is theory-laden, not independently attested
Assessment	ANALYSIS: Honest verdict: the device does real work inside Nyāya's realism about universals, but it will not convince anyone who does not already accept that realism. The debate here bottoms out in ontology, not in epistemology

6. Parāmarśa - what actually generates the inferential cognition

FACT: **The doctrine.** In Nyāya, inferential knowledge (*anumiti*) is produced by a specific operative cognition (*karaṇa*) called **parāmarśa**: the cognition of the mark *as qualified by* its invariable concomitance - "this hill possesses smoke, which is invariably accompanied by fire."

ANALYSIS: **Why this matters against Cārvāka.** The Cārvāka pictures inference as a **leap** across a gap: from perceived smoke, jump to unperceived fire. Nyāya's analysis denies that there is any leap at all. What produces the conclusion is a single complex cognition in which the mark is *already* apprehended under the concomitance. There is no moment at which the mind is stranded between premises with a chasm to cross.

ANALYSIS: **A memorable line for the answer:** *For Cārvāka, inference is a jump in the dark; for Nyāya, it is a step taken in the light of a concomitance already grasped.*

7. The Nyāya counter-attack on perception

FACT: Sharma reports this as the decisive counter-move, and it was set out in Subtopic 3 §8: perception itself errs - the flat earth, the static earth, the small solar disc - "such perceptual knowledge is contradicted by **inference**." And, following the *Tattvasaṅgraha*, "pure perception in the sense of mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless **conception or thought** has arranged into order and has given meaning and significance to the loose threads of sense-data."

ANALYSIS: **The structural result, and it is a genuine reversal:**

CARVAKA'S PICTURE -----	NYAYA'S CORRECTED PICTURE -----
perception = certain inference = derivative hierarchy: P > I	perception = fallible, and CORRECTED by inference inference = the tribunal that corrects perception hierarchy: neither is self-sufficient; perception supplies content, inference supplies order and correction

ANALYSIS: **Note the Nyāya distinction that keeps this honest:** Nyāya distinguishes **nirvikalpaka** (indeterminate, pre-predicative) from **savikalpaka** (determinate, qualified) perception. Only determinate perception is judgemental - and determinate perception already involves conceptual qualification. The Cārvāka's "pure given" is therefore, on the Nyāya analysis, either pre-cognitive and useless, or already conceptually shaped and therefore not the innocent bedrock he supposes.

Exam link

Primary route: 2018 Q8(b); cross-link 2022 Q7(c). Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons, and a criterion-named verdict on whether they are justified.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not say Nyāya "proves" *vyāpti* with certainty. It claims disciplined warrant and eliminates *suspected* conditions.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not call *tarka* a *pramāṇa*. It is *pramāṇa-anugrahaka*, an auxiliary that removes doubt.
3. FACT: Do not write that Nyāya denies the perception of universals. It affirms it through *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not omit *parāmarśa*. Without it, you cannot explain why Nyāya denies that inference is a "leap" at all.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not answer 2018 Q8(b) with only one school. The question says "the other systems" - plural - and asks for your own verdict as a third limb.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not present Advaita as agreeing with Cārvāka about inference. Advaita's denial is at the *pāramārthika* level and applies to perception equally.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not forget Nyāya's *nirvikalpaka* / *savikalpaka* distinction when replying to the "pure given" assumption.

Revision notes

- FACT: *Vyāpti* is built by **bhūyodarśana**, disciplined as **anvaya** (co-presence) and **vyatireka** (co-absence).
- FACT: **Upādhi**-elimination repairs a defective universal by restating it at the correct level of generality - "fire **with wet fuel**, there smoke".
- FACT: **Tarka** is hypothetical *reductio* reasoning; it is not a *pramāṇa* but removes the doubt blocking *vyāptigraha*.
- FACT: *Tarka*'s force against Cārvāka: his own acting, expecting and arguing presuppose the regularities he refuses to certify.
- FACT: **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** answers the class-character objection by presenting the universal through the particular.

- FACT: **Parāmarśa** - the cognition of the mark as qualified by concomitance - is the *karaṇa* of *anumiti*; hence no "leap".
- FACT: The eight-stage ladder: *bhūyodarśana* -> *upādhi*-elimination -> *tarka* -> *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* -> *vyāptigraha* -> *liṅga-darśana* -> *parāmarśa* -> *anumiti*.
- FACT: Sharma's counter-attack: perception errs (flat earth, static earth, small sun) and is corrected **by inference**.
- FACT: *Tattvasaṅgraha* point: mere sensation is not knowledge until conception orders "the loose threads of sense-data".
- ANALYSIS: Nyāya's decisive move: replace **omniscient certainty** with **disciplined warrant** as the standard for *pramāṇa*-hood.
- ANALYSIS: Honest residue: *tarka* proves nothing alone; *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* presupposes realism about universals; undetected *upādhis* cannot be excluded in principle.
- ANALYSIS: 2018 Q8(b) has **three** limbs - is it accepted, why not, and are the objectors justified. Answer all three.
- ANALYSIS: Verdict formula: Cārvāka loses the war and wins a battle - inference survives as warranted, not as indubitable.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE - AND A CRITICALLY BALANCED VERDICT

START / CONCEPT: THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE - AND A CRITICALLY BALANCED VERDICT

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The Nyāya Defence Of Inference • A Critically Balanced Verdict • In simple words • One-line memory • assembled • bhūyodarśana

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Nyāya's reply is architectural: *vyāpti* is assembled through five distinguishable operations, and the burden of certainty is distributed across them.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The question says "the other systems" - plural - and asks for your own verdict as a third limb. ANALYSIS: Do not present Advaita as agreeing with Cārvāka about inference.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: In simple words: Nyāya does not claim that one casual observation proves a universal rule.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons, and a criterion-named verdict on whether they are justified.

SESSION 5 - METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM - FOUR BHŪTAS, THE REJECTION OF ĀKĀŚA, AND SVABHĀVAVĀDA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The Cārvāka's best reply is that the soul-hypothesis renames the gap rather than closing it. FACT: Pot-and-potter: the objector needs an efficient cause; the Cārvāka answers with *svabhāva* and denies that design is proved. FACT: Three labels from the textbook: naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*), mechanism (*yadr̥cchāvāda*), and positivism ("believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena"). ANALYSIS: Separate the deflationary use of *svabhāva* (regularity, with no guarantee of future uniformity) from the substantive cosmological use (nature in place of God). FACT: Vedāntasāra: four materialist schools identify the self with gross body, senses, vital breaths, or *manas*. ANALYSIS: Cārvāka's materialism is anti-inferential; modern materialism is thoroughly inferential.

Technical definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible *bhūtas* (material elements) combine according to *svabhāva* (inherent nature) to produce the world, without requiring *ākāśa* (ether), a creator, or a supersensible cause.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible bhūtas (material elements) combine according to svabhāva (inherent nature) to produce the world, without requiring ākāśa (ether), a creator, or a supersensible cause.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Metaphysics
- Materialism
- Four Bhūtas
- The Rejection Of Ākāśa
- Svabhāvavāda
- In simple words

How to use them: Use Metaphysics to define the issue, connect Materialism with Four Bhūtas to explain it, and use The Rejection Of Ākāśa to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible bhūtas (material elements) combine according to svabhāva (inherent nature) to produce the world, without requiring ākāśa (ether), a creator, or a supersensible cause.

Plain-language visual - matter first

```

EARTH + WATER + FIRE + AIR
      |
    organised combinations
      |
body + senses + mind-like functions
      |
consciousness emerges
  
```

AKASA is excluded because it is not directly perceived.

In simple words: Cārvāka accepts four perceptible elements and explains bodies and consciousness through their combinations. Consciousness need not exist separately before matter, just as an intoxicating power appears when ingredients ferment together.

Claim	Simple analogy
Consciousness emerges from matter	Red colour appears when betel ingredients combine
No separate soul-substance is needed	The living body itself is conscious
No creator is needed	Natural properties and combinations explain formation
No ākāśa	It is inferred from sound rather than directly perceived

One-line memory: organised matter produces life and consciousness; do not add an unseen substance without evidence.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The elemental ledger, and the one cell that is empty

	PRTHIVI (earth)	AP (water)	TEJAS (fire)	VAYU (air)	AKASA (ether/space)	
NYAYA-VAISESIKA	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	(+ kala, dik, atman, manas = 9 dravyas)
SAMKHYA	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	(from tanmatras)
JAINISM		(pudgala covers matter)			Y	(akasa is a separate dravya)
MIMAMSA / VEDANTA	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	
CARVAKA	Y	Y	Y	Y	-- NO -- ^^^^^^ the empty cell that carries the whole epistemology	

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** One empty cell, and it is not an accident of cosmology. *Ākāśa* is refused for exactly the reason inference and testimony are refused: it is not perceived, it is **inferred**. The elemental ledger is therefore the neatest possible demonstration that Cārvāka metaphysics is epistemology applied. This visual answers the first half of the 2020 fifteen-marker on its own.

1. The bridging principle - ontology follows epistemology

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta state the derivation in a single sentence: "The Cārvāka theory of reality **follows from** the epistemological conclusion just discussed. If perception is the only reliable source of knowledge, we can rationally assert only the reality of perceptible objects. God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like *adr̥ṣṭa*) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

ANALYSIS: **The principle, formalised for the answer script:**

- P1. Only perception is a pramana. (epistemology)
P2. Ontological commitment should not outrun the reach of the pramanas one accepts. (bridging principle)

C. Only perceptible entities may be admitted as real. (ontology)

ANALYSIS: **P2 is doing enormous work and is rarely noticed by candidates.** It is not a truth of logic. An opponent could accept P1 and yet hold that reality exceeds knowledge - that there are unknowable realities. Cārvāka refuses that gap: for him, what cannot in principle be presented in perception has no claim to be admitted. Naming P2 explicitly, and observing that it is a *presupposition* rather than a proof, is exactly the kind of move that separates a 60% script from an 80% script.

2. The four bhūtas

FACT: **The transmitted sūtra:** *pr̥thivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* - "earth, water, fire and air are the elements." And the second: *tatsamudāye śarīrendriya-viśaya-saṃjñā* - "bodies, senses and objects" are the results of the different combinations of these elements.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta add the biological consequence explicitly: "Not only non-living material objects but also **living organisms**, like plants and animal bodies, are composed of these four elements, by the combination of which they are produced and to which they are **reduced on death**." There is no separate vital principle and no separate psychic substance.

FACT: Sharma adds the ontological refinement that many candidates miss: "**The elements are eternal, but their combinations undergo production and dissolution.**"

ANALYSIS: **This is a significant doctrinal point.** Cārvāka is not a philosophy of universal flux. The material elements are permanent; only configurations arise and perish. That gives Cārvāka a stable ontological substrate - and it is why the school is classified as a **realist** materialism rather than as a scepticism. It also sharpens the contrast with Buddhism (Subtopic 6) and with Jainism (Subtopic 8).

3. Why ākāśa is rejected - the 2020 question's first half

FACT: **The argument, in four steps.**

1. Earth, water, fire and air are each **perceptible**: they present themselves through manifest sensible qualities - solidity, fluidity, heat and light, motion and touch.

2. *Ākāśa* is **not** perceived as an entity. Chatterjee and Datta: the Cārvākas "reject ether, because its existence cannot be perceived; **it has to be inferred.**" Sharma: "he rejects the fifth, the ether, because it is not perceived but inferred."
3. The inference in question is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika one: sound (*śabda* as a quality) is a quality; every quality must inhere in a substance; sound is not a quality of earth, water, fire, air, *ātman*, *manas*, time or space; therefore there is a ninth-listed substance, *ākāśa*, as its unique substrate.
4. Since inference is not a *pramāṇa*, that argument cannot establish anything. Hence the world is composed of **four** elements.

ANALYSIS: **The exchange in table form**, which is what a 15-marker needs:

Move	Position
Vaiśeṣika	FACT: Sound is heard; qualities require substrates; by elimination the substrate is <i>ākāśa</i> , which is one, eternal, all-pervading and imperceptible
Cārvāka	FACT: The hearing of sound is perceptual; the <i>substrate</i> is not. The move from quality to imperceptible substance is an inference and inherits the whole <i>vyāpti</i> problem
Vaiśeṣika rejoinder	ANALYSIS: Then sound is left without a bearer, and the doctrine that qualities inhere in substances is broken
Cārvāka reply	ANALYSIS: Either sound is a state of the perceptible air-medium, or the demand for a bearer is itself a metaphysical prejudice; positing an imperceptible substrate is an unnecessary multiplication
Assessment	ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka is consistent, and the cost is real: he must either naturalise sound into the air or abandon the substance-quality framework that his own four-element realism assumes

ANALYSIS: **The self-critical point that earns the highest marks on this question.** The Cārvāka accepts the four elements as *substances*. But if he accepts the substance-quality scheme for earth, water, fire and air, he cannot simply refuse it for sound without argument. His most defensible line is therefore **not** "qualities need no substrates" but "sound is a modification of perceptible air", which is a naturalising move rather than a sceptical one. Saying this shows you have thought past the textbook.

4. Consciousness from matter - *bhūta-caitanya-vāda*

FACT: **The transmitted sūtra:** *kiṇvādhībhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam* - "consciousness [arises] from matter as the intoxicating power [arises] from fermenting agents."

FACT: **The problem the doctrine answers.** Chatterjee and Datta pose the objection sharply: "we do not perceive consciousness in **any** of the four material elements. How can it then come to qualify their product, the body?"

FACT: **The Cārvāka reply - the emergence thesis and its two canonical analogies.**

Analogy	The ingredients	The novel property	The point made
Betel (tāmbūla)	Betel leaf, lime and areca nut - "none of which is originally red"	A reddish tinge, "when chewed together"	A property may appear in a combination that is present in no ingredient separately
Fermentation	Molasses (<i>guḍa</i>), "originally non-intoxicant"	Intoxicating power, "when allowed to ferment"	The same substance under a different condition may develop qualities originally absent

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta draw the conclusion: "In a similar way, it is possible to think that the material elements combined in a particular way give rise to the conscious living body. **Consciousness is an epiphenomenon or bye-product of matter**; there is no evidence of its existence independent of the body." Sharma reports the same doctrine and quotes the striking Western formulation used of it: "Matter secretes mind as liver secretes bile."

ANALYSIS: **Read the two analogies carefully, because they are not the same argument.**

BETEL : combination of DIFFERENT ingredients -> new quality
(structural / compositional emergence)

FERMENTATION: the SAME ingredient under a NEW CONDITION -> new quality

Together they block two different objections:

- (i) "consciousness is in none of the elements" -> betel answers it
- (ii) "the elements are the same before and after" -> fermentation answers it

ANALYSIS: The explanatory gap, stated honestly - and this is what distinguishes a philosophical answer from a report. Both analogies establish that **novel observable qualities** can arise from combination. Consciousness, however, is not an observable third-person quality like redness or intoxicating power. It is the *condition of observation itself* - subjective, first-personal, and, as Sharma notes, **private** in a way redness is not: consciousness "is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard", and "consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others". The analogies therefore establish emergence of the wrong logical type.

ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka's best available reply, which a fair answer must supply: positing an immaterial soul does not close the gap either - it **renames** it. To say "consciousness arises because there is a conscious substance" explains nothing that "consciousness arises from a specifically organised living body" does not; the dualist has bought a word, not an explanation. **ANALYSIS: Assessment:** the reply neutralises the dualist's claim to explanatory superiority without discharging the Cārvāka's own explanatory debt. Both sides face the gap; only one side pretends to have crossed it.

5. Why no God is needed - the pot-and-potter exchange and svabhāvavāda

FACT: The objection, in Chatterjee and Datta's exact form. "Can the material elements by themselves give rise to this wonderful world? We find that even the production of an object like an earthen jar requires, in addition to **clay** which is its **material cause**, a **potter** who is the **efficient cause**, that shapes the material into the desired form. The four elements supply only the material cause of the world. Do we not require an efficient cause, like God, as the shaper and designer?"

FACT: The Cārvāka reply. "The material elements themselves have got each its **fixed nature (svabhāva)**. It is by the natures and laws inherent in them that they combine together to form this world. There is thus no necessity for God. **There is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design.** They can be explained more reasonably as the fortuitous products of the elements."

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta then supply the three technical labels, all of which should appear in a 10-marker on Cārvāka metaphysics:

Label	Sanskrit	Meaning	Textbook wording
Naturalism	<i>svabhāvavāda</i>	The world is explained "only by nature"; things behave by their own inherent natures	FACT: "Insofar as this Cārvāka theory tries to explain the world only by nature, it is sometimes called naturalism"
Mechanism / accidentalism	<i>yadṛcchāvāda</i>	Denies conscious purpose behind the world; explains it as "a mere mechanical or fortuitous combination of elements"	FACT: "It is also called mechanism (<i>yadṛcchā-vāda</i>)"
Positivism	-	Believes "only in positive facts or observable phenomena"	FACT: "The Cārvāka theory on the whole may also be called positivism "

ANALYSIS: Note carefully for the 2024 question: the label "positivism" is not an examiner's invention or a modern imposition. It is applied to Cārvāka **by the standard textbook itself**, and with a stated reason. That is a decisive evidential point for Subtopic 9 and for the workbook's 2024 answer - although, as we shall see, the label still needs heavy qualification.

ANALYSIS: A refinement on svabhāvavāda that strengthens any answer. *Svabhāva* is invoked twice in Cārvāka, at two different points, and they must not be confused:

- (1) **EPISTEMOLOGICAL USE** : "why is fire always hot and water cool?"
-> because of their inherent natures; no supernatural principle is needed, AND "there is neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future."
(Chatterjee & Datta)
- (2) **COSMOLOGICAL USE** : "who arranged the world?"
-> nothing did; the elements combine by their own natures; no designer is required.

ANALYSIS: Use (1) is a **deflationary** appeal: "nature" is a label for observed regularity, deliberately not an explanatory power, and the Cārvāka refuses to guarantee its persistence. Use (2) is a **substantive** appeal: nature is doing real cosmological work in place of God. The obvious objection - that "nature" is an empty word unless analysed - bites hard on use (2) and hardly at all on use (1). Separating them is the most sophisticated move available in this subtopic.

6. How many materialisms? Sadānanda's fourfold classification

FACT: Sharma records, from Sadānanda's *Vedāntasāra*, that **four** different materialist schools were distinguished by their identification of the self:

Variant	The self is identified with	Sanskrit
1	The gross body	<i>sthūla śarīra</i>
2	The senses	<i>indriya</i>
3	The vital breaths	<i>prāṇa</i>
4	The mental organ	<i>manas</i>

FACT: Sharma adds: "All the schools agree in regarding the soul as a **product of matter**." He also records Śāntarākṣita's report that the materialist *Kambalāśvatara* held that consciousness arises out of the material body **associated with vital breaths**.

ANALYSIS: **Exam value**. This single table shows that "Cārvāka" names a **family** of materialist positions, not a monolith. It supports the source-caution of Subtopic 1, it forestalls the objection that the school was crude and undifferentiated, and it gives you a precise, citable internal differentiation almost no other candidate will have.

Exam link

Primary route: the first half of 2020 Q6(b). Derive four-element materialism and the rejection of *ākāśa* from the epistemic rule, then evaluate emergence without calling it modern science.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. FACT: **Four elements, not five**. This is the single most examined factual trap in the topic.
2. FACT: Do not say Cārvāka "does not know of" *ākāśa*. He knows the Vaiśeṣika argument for it and rejects it, precisely because it is inferential.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka denies the reality of sound. He denies the inference from sound to an imperceptible substrate.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not say the elements are impermanent. Sharma: "the elements are eternal, but their combinations undergo production and dissolution."
5. ANALYSIS: Do not present the betel and fermentation analogies as one analogy. They answer two different objections - compositional and transformational emergence.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not claim the analogies solve the problem of consciousness. State the explanatory gap **and** the Cārvāka's reply that dualism merely renames it.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not translate *svabhāvavāda* as "scientific naturalism". It is a metaphysical refusal of teleology, not an experimental programme.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not forget *yadṛcchāvāda*. The denial of purpose is a distinct thesis from the affirmation of inherent natures, and the two sit together somewhat uneasily.
9. ANALYSIS: Do not treat "Cārvāka" as one uniform doctrine. The *Vedāntasāra* records four materialist identifications of the self.

Revision notes

- FACT: **Bridging principle**: ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *pramāṇas*. Name it as a presupposition, not a proof.
- FACT: *prthivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* - four elements; and *tatsamudāye śarīrendriya-viśaya-saṃjñā* - bodies, senses and objects from their combination.

- FACT: Living bodies too are elemental combinations, "reduced on death" to the elements.
- FACT: **The elements are eternal; only their combinations arise and perish** (Sharma).
- FACT: *Ākāśa* is rejected "because it is not perceived but inferred" - the Vaiśeṣika sound-to-substrate inference is refused.
- FACT: *kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam* - consciousness arises as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents.
- FACT: **Betel** = compositional emergence (leaf, lime, nut -> red). **Fermentation** = transformational emergence (*guḍa* -> intoxicant).
- FACT: Consciousness is an "epiphenomenon or by-product of matter"; "matter secretes mind as liver secretes bile."
- ANALYSIS: **Explanatory gap**: redness and intoxication are third-person properties; consciousness is private and first-personal. The Cārvāka's best reply is that the soul-hypothesis renames the gap rather than closing it.
- FACT: **Pot-and-potter**: the objector needs an efficient cause; the Cārvāka answers with *svabhāva* and denies that design is proved.
- FACT: Three labels from the textbook: **naturalism** (*svabhāvavāda*), **mechanism** (*yadr̥cchāvāda*), and **positivism** ("believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena").
- ANALYSIS: Separate the **deflationary** use of *svabhāva* (regularity, with no guarantee of future uniformity) from the **substantive** cosmological use (nature in place of God).
- FACT: *Vedāntasāra*: four materialist schools identify the self with gross body, senses, vital breaths, or *manas*.
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka's materialism is anti-inferential; modern materialism is thoroughly inferential. Same conclusion, opposite method.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM - FOUR BHŪTAS, THE REJECTION OF ĀKĀŚA, AND SVABHĀVAVĀDA

START / CONCEPT: METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM - FOUR BHŪTAS, THE REJECTION OF ĀKĀŚA, AND SVABHĀVAVĀDA

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Metaphysics · Materialism · Four Bhūtas · The Rejection Of Ākāśa · Svabhāvavāda · In simple words

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Cārvāka's best reply is that the soul-hypothesis renames the gap rather than closing it. FACT: Pot-and-potter: the objector needs an efficient cause; the Cārvāka answers with *svabhāva* and denies that design is proved. FACT: Three labels from the textbook: naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*), mechanism (*yadr̥cchāvāda*), and positivism ("believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena"). ANALYSIS: Separate the deflationary use of *svabhāva* (regularity, with no guarantee of future uniformity) from the substantive cosmological use (nature in place of God). FACT: *Vedāntasāra*: four materialist schools identify the self with gross body, senses, vital breaths, or *manas*. ANALYSIS: Cārvāka's materialism is anti-inferential; modern materialism is thoroughly inferential.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The elemental ledger is therefore the neatest possible demonstration that Cārvāka metaphysics is epistemology applied.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: State the explanatory gap and the Cārvāka's reply that dualism merely renames it. ANALYSIS: Do not translate *svabhāvavāda* as "scientific naturalism".

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible bhūtas (material elements) combine according to *svabhāva* (inherent nature) to produce the world, without requiring *ākāśa* (ether), a creator, or a supersensible cause.

SESSION 6 - SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS - DEHĀTMAVĀDA, AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS BUDDHIST ANĀTMAN (2024, 20 MARKS)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Dehātmavāda (doctrine that the body is the self) explains consciousness as an emergent property of the living body, whereas Buddhist anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine) analyses the person as a causal continuum without identifying self and body.

Technical definition: FACT: caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ / caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā - the person is the living body qualified by consciousness. FACT: Negative argument: "the non-material soul is never perceived." FACT: Positive argument: "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind" - bodily predicates attach directly to "I"; on dualism they would be meaningless. FACT: Covariation: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease alter awareness. FACT: Consequence: death of the body is the end of the individual; questions of rebirth, heaven and hell "become meaningless". FACT: Sharma's objections: swoon and dreamless sleep (body without consciousness) · dreams (consciousness without body) · subject cannot be reduced to object · co-existence is not causation (light and sight; the two horns of a bull) · consciousness is neither smelt, tasted, seen, touched nor heard · consciousness is private · non-existence of the soul is equally undemonstrable. ANALYSIS: Best evaluative line: the evidence establishes dependence, and dependence is compatible with the body being the instrument rather than the cause. FACT: Memory: Nyāya/Vedānta invoke ātman; Cārvāka invokes bodily-psychological continuity; Buddhism invokes santāna, pratisandhāna and ālaya-vijñāna. FACT: 2024 contrast in one line: Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves the self into process. FACT: Cārvāka's ground is epistemic; Buddhism's is ontological (pratītyasamutpāda, kṣaṇikavāda) and soteriological (self-belief breeds craving). FACT: Cārvāka rejects rebirth, karma and mokṣa; Buddhism retains rebirth, karma and nirvāṇa without a self. ANALYSIS: Rūpa is one of the five skandhas - so Buddhist anātman refutes the Cārvāka body-self by name. ANALYSIS: Puggalavāda (Vātsīputrīya) is the internal Buddhist foil; Sadānanda's four materialisms are the internal Cārvāka foil.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Dehātmavāda (doctrine that the body is the self) explains consciousness as an emergent property of the living body, whereas Buddhist anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine) analyses the person as a causal continuum without identifying self and body.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Self
- Body
- Consciousness
- Dehātmavāda
- Cārvāka Versus Buddhist Anātman (2024
- 20 Marks)

How to use them: Use Self to define the issue, connect Body with Consciousness to explain it, and use Dehātmavāda to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dehātmavāda (doctrine that the body is the self) explains consciousness as an emergent property of the living body, whereas Buddhist anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine) analyses the person as a causal continuum without identifying self and body.

Plain-language visual - two different denials of a permanent soul

CARVAKA	BUDDHISM
living body = conscious self	changing five aggregates
continuity of body explains "I"	causal continuity explains "I"
no body-independent atman	no permanent substance at all

In simple words: Cārvāka does not deny the everyday person; it identifies the person with the conscious living body. Buddhism also rejects a permanent *ātman*, but analyses the person as a changing causal stream rather than as one material body.

Test	Cārvāka answer
What is the self?	The body qualified by consciousness
Why say "I am strong"?	The first-person predicate applies directly to the body
What happens at death?	The organised body dissolves; consciousness ends
Main difficulty	Explaining memory, unity and personal identity fully

One-line memory: Cārvāka is body-self theory; Buddhism is no-substance process theory.

VISUAL: VISUAL - Three ways of denying the transcendental self (they are not the same denial)

THE QUESTION: what am I?

NYAYA / VEDANTA (the target)

```

+-----+
|  ATMAN  |
| permanent |
| substance |
| OWNER of |
| states   |
+-----+
  ^
  |
states inhere
in a substance

```

CARVAKA

```

+-----+
|  BODY   |
| qualified |
| by con-  |
| scioussness|
+-----+
  ^
  |
"caitanya-
visista deha
eva atma"
  |
SUBSTANCE
RETAINED --
relocated to
the BODY
  |
no rebirth,
no karma
(death = end)

```

BUDDHISM

```

+-----+
| (no owner)|
+-----+
| | | |
rupa vedana
samjna samskara
vijnana
(5 skandhas)
  |
a causal STREAM
(santana), no
substance, but
REAL continuity
  |
SUBSTANCE
ABOLISHED
  |
rebirth WITHOUT
a self; karma
preserved

```

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** This single diagram is the answer to the 2024 twenty-marker. Cārvāka **relocates** the self into matter; Buddhism **dissolves** the self into a process. One keeps a bearer and changes its nature; the other removes the bearer altogether. The moral and soteriological consequences then diverge completely: Cārvāka's denial ends the moral story at death, while Buddhism's denial is designed precisely to keep the moral story running without an owner.

1. Dehātmavāda - the doctrine stated exactly

FACT: **The transmitted formula:** *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ* - "the person is the body qualified by consciousness"; and, in Chatterjee and Datta's rendering of the Cārvāka position, "What people mean by a soul is nothing more than this **conscious living body** (*caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā*)."

ANALYSIS: **Read the formula carefully - every word is load-bearing:**

```

CAITANYA-VISISTA      : QUALIFIED BY CONSCIOUSNESS
                        -> not any body; the LIVING body
KAYAH                 : THE BODY
                        -> the perceptible material organism
PURUSAH / ATMA        : IS the person / IS the self
                        -> identity, not correlation

```

ANALYSIS: **Three misreadings to avoid**, each of which has sunk otherwise good answers:

1. It is **not** "the self is the corpse". The self is the *living, conscious* body; consciousness is the qualifier that makes a body a self.
2. It is **not** "there is no self". There is a self; it is material. Cārvāka is not an eliminativist about persons.
3. It is **not** "consciousness is identical with any one element". Consciousness belongs to the **organised** body-complex, as the emergence analogies establish.

2. The argument for dehātmavāda

FACT: **Step 1 - the negative argument.** "The non-material soul is **never perceived**" (Chatterjee and Datta). What internal perception delivers is a state, not a substance behind the state.

FACT: **Step 2 - the positive argument from ordinary first-person judgements.** This is the Cārvāka's most distinctive and most quotable move: "we have **direct evidence of the identity of the self with the body** in our daily experiences and judgments like, 'I am fat,' 'I am lame,' 'I am blind.' If the 'I', the self, were different from the body, these would be **meaningless**."

ANALYSIS: **The logic of the argument from first-person statements, reconstructed:**

1. In ordinary speech, bodily predicates are attached directly to "I":
I am fat; I am lame; I am blind; I am hungry; I am tall.
2. Predication of this kind is intelligible only if the SUBJECT and the BEARER of the predicate are the same thing.
3. If "I" named an immaterial soul, "I am fat" would be a CATEGORY MISTAKE -- as odd as "the number seven is blue".
4. But these statements are not category mistakes; they are the ordinary currency of self-description.
5. Therefore "I" refers to the body.

ANALYSIS: **The dualist's standard reply, and the Cārvāka's rejoinder.** The dualist answers that such expressions are **figurative** - the soul speaks of *its* body as a person speaks of "my house". The Cārvāka's rejoinder is that the figurative reading is a **theory-driven reinterpretation** of language, adopted only to save a doctrine that has no independent perceptual support; and that "my body" and "I am lame" are not on a par, since no one says "my body is lame, therefore I am figuratively lame" in the natural course of speech. ANALYSIS: Assessment: the argument does not *prove* materialism, but it correctly shifts the burden onto the dualist to explain why ordinary self-ascription runs the way it does.

FACT: **Step 3 - the argument from covariation.** The authored knowledge file records the standard supporting evidence: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease visibly alter awareness. Consciousness tracks the states of the body with a fidelity that would be inexplicable if it belonged to something else.

FACT: **Step 4 - the consequence.** Chatterjee and Datta: "If the existence of a soul apart from the body is not proved, there is no possibility of proving its immortality. On the contrary, **death of the body means the end of the individual**. All questions about previous life, after-life, rebirth, enjoyment of the fruits of actions in heaven or hell, therefore, become **meaningless**."

ANALYSIS: Note the word Chatterjee and Datta use twice: *meaningless*, not merely false. That is a quasi-verificationist register, and it is a genuine evidential asset for the 2024 "positivism" question - though it must be used carefully, since the Cārvāka has no explicit theory of meaning.

3. The objections - Sharma's full battery, and the Cārvāka's replies

ANALYSIS: This is the richest objection-set in Indian philosophy, and reproducing four or five of these with replies is what turns a 12/20 into an 16/20. Sharma sets them out at length; each is paired below with the best available Cārvāka answer.

#	Objection (Sharma)	Best Cārvāka reply	Residual pressure
1	Self-consciousness. If consciousness means <i>self</i> -consciousness, it cannot be identified with the living body, since animals have living bodies without rational consciousness	ANALYSIS: Only a particular combination of elements, obtaining in the human body, produces consciousness; so no counter-example arises from animals	ANALYSIS: Sharma calls this "wrong": it makes consciousness essential to a specific organisation, which invites objection 2
2	Separability. If consciousness were an essential property of the living body it would be inseparable from it. But "in swoons, fits, epilepsy, dreamless sleep etc. the living body is seen without consciousness"	ANALYSIS: These are states in which the relevant <i>organisation</i> is disrupted; the property is essential to the organisation, not to bare bodily existence	ANALYSIS: Strong reply, but it moves the doctrine from "body" to "functional organisation", which is a real concession

#	Objection (Sharma)	Best Cārvāka reply	Residual pressure
3	Dream-consciousness. "In dreams, consciousness is seen without the living body"; the dreamer on waking disowns the dream-body but owns the dream-consciousness	ANALYSIS: The dreaming subject is the sleeping physical body; the dream-body is imagined content, not a second body	ANALYSIS: The reply is decent; Sharma's inference that consciousness therefore "persists through" waking, dream and deep sleep already presupposes the Vedāntic three-state argument
4	Subject-object asymmetry. "The subject, the knower, cannot be reduced to the object, the known, since all objects presuppose the existence of the subject"; the subject is enjoyer, the object enjoyed	ANALYSIS: A material organism can be both knower and known, as a hand can touch itself; asymmetry of <i>role</i> does not entail difference of <i>substance</i>	ANALYSIS: This is the deepest objection and it is not fully answered; it is the ancestor of the modern subjectivity problem
5	Co-existence is not causation. "The eye cannot see in darkness. Sight is not possible without light, yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; "the two horns of a bull which are always found together cannot be regarded as causally related." The body may be the instrument of consciousness, not its cause	ANALYSIS: Correct as logic - but the instrument-hypothesis needs an independent user, and no such user is perceived; the materialist hypothesis is the more economical of two unproven options	ANALYSIS: Genuinely undecided; both sides are arguing from the same evidence to different best explanations
6	Imperceptibility of the alleged property. "If consciousness is a property of the body, it must be perceived like other material properties. But it is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard "	ANALYSIS: It is perceived - by internal perception, which Cārvāka admits	ANALYSIS: But then the Cārvāka's own criterion has been stretched: internal perception delivers something with no external sensory mode, which is precisely the anomaly the dualist is pointing at
7	Privacy. A material property "should be known by all in the same manner and should not be private. But we find that consciousness is intimately private and consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others"	ANALYSIS: Privacy is explained by the <i>locality</i> of the organism: each body has its own internal states, as each fire has its own heat	ANALYSIS: The reply confuses <i>causal locality</i> with <i>epistemic inaccessibility</i> ; the objection retains real force
8	Self-manifestation regress. If consciousness is a property of the body, "why should the body, qualified to produce consciousness, itself stand in need of being manifested by consciousness?"	ANALYSIS: Being a producer of awareness and being an object of awareness are different roles, and one thing may play both	ANALYSIS: A fair reply, though it again concedes a role-distinction that dualists exploit
9	Symmetry of ignorance. "If the existence of the soul surviving death cannot be demonstrated, its non-existence too cannot be so demonstrated"	ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka's principle is asymmetrical by design: the burden lies on the one who <i>posits</i> an entity, not on the one who withholds assent	ANALYSIS: This exposes the difference between <i>not asserting</i> and <i>denying</i> , and most doxographies attribute outright denial rather than agnosticism to Cārvāka

ANALYSIS: **The single most useful evaluative sentence to carry from this table:** *Sharma's objections 2, 3 and 5 show that the Cārvāka's evidence establishes at most a dependence of consciousness on the body, and dependence is compatible with the body being the instrument rather than the cause - so the materialist conclusion is under-determined by the materialist's own evidence.* That sentence is worth reproducing in any answer on the Cārvāka self.

4. Memory and personal identity

ANALYSIS: **The objection.** Memory reaches across time: I remember what I did. What sustains the "I" through the constant replacement of bodily material? A permanent substance seems required.

ANALYSIS: **The three answers on the table, and the exam requires you to distinguish them:**

School	What secures the identity of the rememberer
Nyāya / Vedānta	FACT: A permanent <i>ātman</i> which is the single owner of past experience and present memory

School	What secures the identity of the rememberer
Cārvāka	ANALYSIS: Bodily-psychological continuity: the same living organism persists, so the same organism that experienced now recalls. Memory is a bodily-mental trace in a continuing body
Buddhism	FACT: <i>Santāna</i> , the causal stream; memory belongs to the same causal continuum, reinforced by <i>pratisandhāna</i> (relinking), and in Yogācāra by <i>ālaya-vijñāna</i> carrying <i>bījas</i>

ANALYSIS: **The comparative point that examiners reward.** Cārvāka and Buddhism both reject the permanent owner, but they replace it with different things: Cārvāka with a **material continuant** (a body that endures), Buddhism with a **causal continuant** (a stream in which nothing endures). The Cārvāka answer is metaphysically cheaper and psychologically thinner; the Buddhist answer is metaphysically subtler and must work much harder, which is why it develops *santāna*, *pratisandhāna* and eventually *ālaya-vijñāna*.

Exam link

Primary route: 2024 Q6(a), 20 marks. Use shared denial but different reconstruction: Cārvāka relocates self into body; Buddhism dissolves self into a causal process.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. FACT: **Never write that Cārvāka and Buddhism deny the self "in the same way".** This is the exact error the 2024 question was designed to catch.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka denies the self *simpliciter*. He denies a transcendental self and affirms a material one.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not say Buddhism reduces the person to the body. *Rūpa* is only one of five *skandhas*, and is itself denied selfhood.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka denies consciousness. He denies that consciousness needs an immaterial bearer.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not omit *santāna* when handling memory in Buddhism; and do not smuggle a soul into it.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not present Sharma's objections as unanswerable. Give the Cārvāka's reply and *then* assess.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not miss the asymmetry point: Cārvāka's denial ends the moral narrative; Buddhism's denial is constructed to continue it.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not forget the first-person statements - "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind". They are the Cārvāka's own positive argument and are frequently omitted.
9. ANALYSIS: Do not treat "death alone is liberation" as a serious soteriology. It is a *rejection* of soteriology expressed in soteriological vocabulary.

Revision notes

- FACT: *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ / caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā* - the person is the **living** body qualified by consciousness.
- FACT: Negative argument: "the non-material soul is **never perceived**."
- FACT: Positive argument: "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind" - bodily predicates attach directly to "I"; on dualism they would be meaningless.
- FACT: Covariation: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease alter awareness.
- FACT: Consequence: death of the body is the end of the individual; questions of rebirth, heaven and hell "become meaningless".
- FACT: **Sharma's objections**: swoon and dreamless sleep (body without consciousness) · dreams (consciousness without body) · subject cannot be reduced to object · co-existence is not causation (light and sight; the two horns of a bull) · consciousness is neither smelt, tasted, seen, touched nor heard · consciousness is **private** · non-existence of the soul is equally undemonstrable.
- ANALYSIS: Best evaluative line: the evidence establishes **dependence**, and dependence is compatible with the body being the **instrument** rather than the cause.

- FACT: Memory: Nyāya/Vedānta invoke *ātman*; Cārvāka invokes bodily-psychological continuity; Buddhism invokes *santāna*, *pratisandhāna* and *ālaya-vijñāna*.
- FACT: **2024 contrast in one line**: Cārvāka **relocates** the self into matter; Buddhism **dissolves** the self into process.
- FACT: Cārvāka's ground is epistemic; Buddhism's is ontological (*pratītyasamutpāda*, *kṣaṇikavāda*) and soteriological (self-belief breeds craving).
- FACT: Cārvāka rejects rebirth, karma and *mokṣa*; Buddhism retains rebirth, karma and *nirvāṇa* without a self.
- ANALYSIS: *Rūpa* is one of the five *skandhas* - so Buddhist *anātman* refutes the Cārvāka body-self **by name**.
- ANALYSIS: **Puggalavāda** (Vātsīputrīya) is the internal Buddhist foil; **Sadānanda's four materialisms** are the internal Cārvāka foil.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS - DEHĀTMAVĀDA, AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS BUDDHIST ANĀTMAN (2024, 20 MARKS)

START / CONCEPT: SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS - DEHĀTMAVĀDA, AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS BUDDHIST ANĀTMAN (2024, 20 MARKS)

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Self · Body · Consciousness · Dehātmavāda · Cārvāka Versus Buddhist Anātman (2024 · 20 Marks)

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: FACT: *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ* / *caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā* - the person is the living body qualified by consciousness. FACT: Negative argument: "the non-material soul is never perceived." FACT: Positive argument: "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind" - bodily predicates attach directly to "I"; on dualism they would be meaningless. FACT: Covariation: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease alter awareness. FACT: Consequence: death of the body is the end of the individual; questions of rebirth, heaven and hell "become meaningless". FACT: Sharma's objections: swoon and dreamless sleep (body without consciousness) · dreams (consciousness without body) · subject cannot be reduced to object · co-existence is not causation (light and sight; the two horns of a bull) · consciousness is neither smelt, tasted, seen, touched nor heard · consciousness is private · non-existence of the soul is equally undemonstrable. ANALYSIS: Best evaluative line: the evidence establishes dependence, and dependence is compatible with the body being the instrument rather than the cause. FACT: Memory: Nyāya/Vedānta invoke *ātman*; Cārvāka invokes bodily-psychological continuity; Buddhism invokes *santāna*, *pratisandhāna* and *ālaya-vijñāna*. FACT: 2024 contrast in one line: Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves the self into process. FACT: Cārvāka's ground is epistemic; Buddhism's is ontological (*pratītyasamutpāda*, *kṣaṇikavāda*) and soteriological (self-belief breeds craving). FACT: Cārvāka rejects rebirth, karma and *mokṣa*; Buddhism retains rebirth, karma and *nirvāṇa* without a self. ANALYSIS: *Rūpa* is one of the five *skandhas* - so Buddhist *anātman* refutes the Cārvāka body-self by name. ANALYSIS: **Puggalavāda** (Vātsīputrīya) is the internal Buddhist foil; **Sadānanda's four materialisms** are the internal Cārvāka foil.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Use shared denial but different reconstruction: Cārvāka relocates self into body; Buddhism dissolves self into a causal process.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: He denies a transcendental self and affirms a material one. ANALYSIS: Do not say Buddhism reduces the person to the body.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Dehātmavāda (doctrine that the body is the self) explains consciousness as an emergent property of the living body, whereas Buddhist *anātman* (no-permanent-self doctrine) analyses the person as a causal continuum without identifying self and body.

SESSION 7 - THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES - GOD, SOUL, KARMA, REBIRTH, HEAVEN, MOKṢA, VEDA AND RITUAL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: FACT: The template: X is imperceptible -> only inference or testimony could reach X -> neither is a pramāṇa -> X is unwarranted -> X is rejected. ANALYSIS: Note the gap between withholding assent and denying; the doxographies attribute denial, the argument licenses only the weaker conclusion. FACT: God falls twice over: epistemically (no pramāṇa) and explanatorily (svabhāva suffices; "no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design"). FACT: Adrṣṭa is named explicitly among the casualties - "any unperceived law (like adrṣṭa)". FACT: Transmigration requires a separable self, its survival, a carrier of desert, and knowledge of all three; Cārvāka cuts every one. FACT: Heaven and hell are "the inventions of the priests"; svarga is rejected because it rests on "the unproved existence of a life after death". FACT: The liberation dilemma: freedom of a soul (absurd - there is no soul) or freedom from all pain in this life (impossible - embodiment mixes pleasure and pain); residue - maraṇam eva apavargaḥ. FACT: Three ritual reductions: śrāddha and the traveller's food · food downstairs for a person upstairs · jyotiṣṭoma and "why not sacrifice their own old parents". FACT: Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha: Agnihotra, the three Vedas, the three staves and ashes are "the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness"; "the three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons" - quote with a source-caution. ANALYSIS: The jyotiṣṭoma argument is an argument from revealed preference about what the priest actually believes. ANALYSIS: Cārvāka is not the only non-theistic Indian school; it is the only one whose atheism is generated epistemologically, and the only one that also discards karma, rebirth and mokṣa. ANALYSIS: Internal tension worth noting: svabhāvavāda grounds regularity in fixed natures, while yadṛcchāvāda calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".

Technical definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, karma (moral causation across lives), rebirth and mokṣa (liberation) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, karma (moral causation across lives), rebirth and mokṣa (liberation) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The Rejection Of Transcendent Entities
- God
- Soul
- Karma
- Rebirth
- Heaven

How to use them: Use The Rejection Of Transcendent Entities to define the issue, connect God with Soul to explain it, and use Karma to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, karma (moral causation across lives), rebirth and mokṣa (liberation) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

Plain-language visual - one rule removes seven unseen claims

Only perception is certain

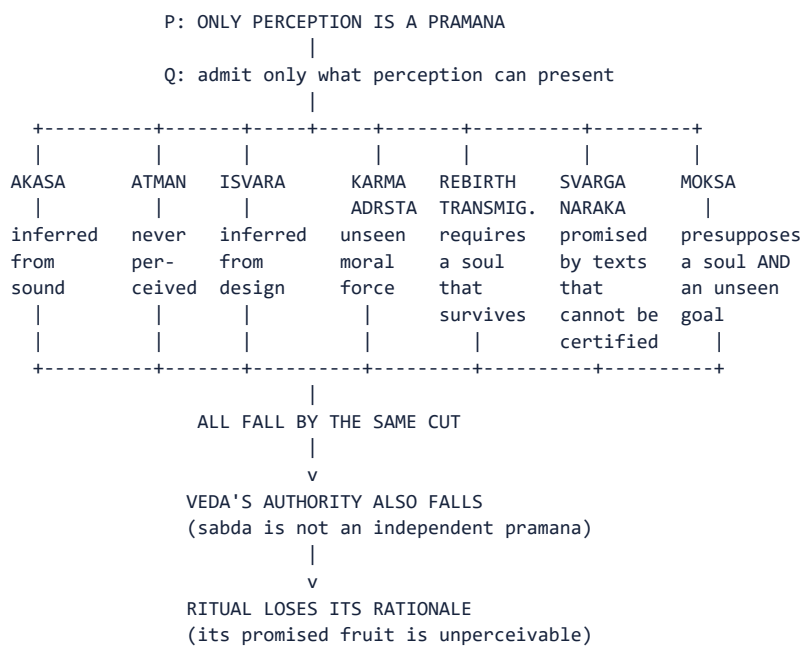
- |
- +--> no separate soul
- +--> no God
- +--> no unseen karma/adrista
- +--> no rebirth
- +--> no heaven or hell
- +--> no mokṣa after death
- +--> no infallible Vedic authority

In simple words: these denials are not seven unrelated opinions. Each follows from the same rule: if an entity can be reached only through inference or testimony, Cārvāka does not accept it as established knowledge.

Unseen claim	Why it falls
God	Known through design inference, which Cārvāka rejects
Karma and rebirth	Require an unseen moral force and a surviving carrier
Heaven, hell and liberation	Post-mortem states are not perceived
Vedic ritual	Scriptural testimony has no independent authority

One-line memory: epistemology is the root; rejection of transcendence is the branch.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The demolition tree: one premise, seven casualties



ANALYSIS: Caption. This tree is the answer to the 2021 ten-marker in diagram form. The examiner's phrase - "the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities" - asks for exactly this: not a list of denials, but the demonstration that a single epistemic cut severs them all at once.

1. The general form of every Cārvāka denial

ANALYSIS: Every denial in this subtopic instantiates one template. Learn the template, not the list.

1. X is claimed to exist.
2. X is not, and cannot in principle be, presented in perception.
3. The only routes to X are inference or scriptural testimony.
4. Neither inference nor testimony is an independent pramana.
5. Therefore there is no valid means by which X could be known.
6. Therefore X should not be admitted into our ontology.

ANALYSIS: The precision point at step 6. There is a real difference between *withholding assent* (agnosticism) and *denying* (atheism, in the broad sense). CAUTION: The doxographical sources overwhelmingly present Cārvāka as **denying** - "the Cārvākas, therefore, prefer atheism" (Chatterjee and Datta) - but the argument as stated licenses only the weaker conclusion. Sharma records the opposing school's exploitation of exactly this gap: "if the existence of the soul surviving death cannot be demonstrated, its **non-existence** too cannot be so demonstrated." A first-class answer notes the gap and states which reading it is defending.

2. God - and why svabhāvavāda is the operative reason

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "God, whose existence cannot be perceived, **fares no better than the soul**. The material elements produce the world, and the supposition of a creator is unnecessary."

ANALYSIS: Two distinct arguments are at work, and separating them is worth marks:

Argument	Form	Force
Epistemic	God is imperceptible; the only routes to God are inference (the design and causal arguments) and <i>śabda</i> ; both are denied <i>pramāṇa</i> -status	FACT: Removes the warrant for theism
Explanatory (<i>svabhāvavāda</i>)	Even granting the explanatory question, the fixed natures of the elements suffice; "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design"	FACT: Removes the need for theism

ANALYSIS: Note that the second argument is logically independent of the first, and is the more interesting one, because it engages Nyāya on Nyāya's own ground. Nyāya's *kāryāt* inference argues from the world as a composite **effect** to an intelligent efficient cause. The Cārvāka's *svabhāvavāda* rejoinder does not merely say "you cannot know that"; it says "the explanandum is discharged without you". ANALYSIS: Chatterjee and Datta record the further Cārvāka move: the objects of the world "can be explained more reasonably as the **fortuitous** products of the elements" - which is *yadrchāvāda*, and which sits in some tension with a strong *svabhāvavāda* that grounds regularity in fixed natures. Noting that internal tension is a genuinely advanced observation.

3. Karma, adṛṣṭa and the moral order

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta name *adṛṣṭa* explicitly among the casualties: "God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and **any unperceived law (like adṛṣṭa)** cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

ANALYSIS: **Why adṛṣṭa is the decisive test case.** *Adṛṣṭa* - "the unseen" - is by its own definition imperceptible. It is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā device for connecting an act performed now with a fruit enjoyed later, sometimes in another life. The Cārvāka's objection is therefore not incidental but **definitional**: an entity whose name announces its imperceptibility is precisely what an epistemology of perception must refuse.

FACT: **The objection from moral order, and the Cārvāka's reply.** The authored knowledge file records the exchange: without *karma* and rebirth, moral order is said to collapse. The Cārvāka answer is that "morality need not be underwritten by cosmic bookkeeping; human pain, pleasure, prudence, and social consequences are enough for practical conduct."

ANALYSIS: **Assessment to write.** The reply establishes that a *this-worldly* account of moral motivation is available; it does not establish that such an account can support obligations that run against self-interest with no observer. This is the enduring weak point of Cārvāka ethics and connects directly to Subtopic 8.

4. Rebirth and transmigration - the 2020 question's second half

FACT: **Exact question (2020, Q6(b), 15 marks).** "Critically evaluate Cārvākas' rejection of Ākāśa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul."

ANALYSIS: **What transmigration requires, and where Cārvāka cuts each requirement:**

Requirement of transmigration	Cārvāka's cut
(a) A self distinct from the body	FACT: <i>Dehātmanvāda</i> : the self is the living body; no separable subject exists to migrate
(b) Survival of that self after bodily death	FACT: "Death of the body means the end of the individual"; the elements disperse, and the combination that carried consciousness is dissolved
(c) A carrier of moral desert across the gap	FACT: <i>Karma</i> and <i>adṛṣṭa</i> are unperceived and hence unwarranted
(d) Knowledge that any of (a)-(c) obtains	FACT: Only scripture and inference could supply it; both are denied <i>pramāṇa</i> -status
(e) Meaningfulness of the claim	ANALYSIS: Chatterjee and Datta report that questions about "previous life, after-life, rebirth, enjoyment of the fruits of actions in heaven or hell" become meaningless - a quasi-verificationist step

ANALYSIS: The critical evaluation the question explicitly demands. A "critically evaluate" question is not answered by exposition. Supply both sides:

STRENGTHS of the Carvaka position

- (i) consistency: the same criterion cuts akasa, atman and rebirth alike
- (ii) economy: nothing unobservable is posited
- (iii) anti-exploitation: it removes the machinery on which ritual prescription and priestly authority rested
- (iv) it forces every rival school to say HOW an unseen bearer of desert is known -- a demand Nyaya answers only inferentially

WEAKNESSES

- (i) the argument rests on the rejection of inference, which is itself vulnerable (Subtopics 3-4)
- (ii) dependence of consciousness on the body does not entail production by the body (Sharma's instrument objection)
- (iii) "not established" is slid into "does not exist"
- (iv) the disappearance of moral continuity leaves desert and obligation without any ground beyond prudence
- (v) Sharma: the non-existence of a surviving soul is as undemonstrable as its existence

ANALYSIS: Verdict formula for this question: *The rejection of ākāśa and of transmigration are the same argument applied twice - once to cosmology and once to soteriology - and their force is exactly the force of the underlying epistemology. Where that epistemology is defensible, as a demand that metaphysical postulates earn their keep, the rejection is powerful; where it over-reaches, in converting "unestablished" into "unreal", the rejection outruns its warrant.*

5. Heaven, hell and mokṣa

FACT: Heaven. Chatterjee and Datta: the Mīmāṃsakas hold that the highest goal is heaven (*svarga*), "a state of unalloyed bliss that can be attained hereafter by performing here the Vedic rites. **The Cārvāka rejects this view, because it is based on the unproved existence of a life after death.** 'Heaven' and 'hell' are the inventions of the priests whose professional interest lies in coaxing, threatening and making people perform the rituals. Enlightened men will always refuse to be duped by them."

FACT: Liberation. The Cārvāka argument is a dilemma, and it is elegant:

What could "liberation" mean?

HORN 1: freedom of the SOUL from bondage to physical existence
-> "absurd, because there is no soul"

HORN 2: attainment, IN THIS LIFE, of a state free from ALL pain
-> "an impossible ideal. Existence in this body is bound up with pleasure as well as pain."

RESIDUE: "Liberation in the sense of complete cessation of sufferings can only mean DEATH." -> maraṇam eva apavargah

FACT: Both horns and the residue are given verbatim in substance by Chatterjee and Datta, and the residue is one of the six transmitted *Bṛhaspati sūtras*.

ANALYSIS: How to present maraṇam eva apavargah without caricature. It is not a recommendation of death and it is not nihilism. It is a **reductio of the concept of liberation**: if *mokṣa* means the total cessation of suffering, then the only state that satisfies the definition is the one no wise person would work for. The verse is a critique of the *coherence* of the goal, not an endorsement of dying. Saying this in one sentence is worth a mark and protects you from the commonest misreading in the topic.

6. The Veda, priestcraft and the ritual reductions

FACT: The epistemic charge. *Śabda* is not an independent *pramāṇa* (Subtopic 2); Vedic authority therefore has no certified standing. Claims of authorlessness or infallibility are not perceptually available.

FACT: The sociological charge. Chatterjee and Datta report it plainly: "in reality the Vedas are the works of some cunning priests who earned their living by duping the ignorant and the credulous", and the tangible benefit of the rites goes to "the priests who officiate and enjoy the emoluments."

FACT: The Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha summary, as reproduced by Sharma, is the sharpest form of the polemic and should be used with an explicit source-caution: "There is no heaven, no final liberation, nor any soul in another world;

nor do the actions of the four castes, orders etc. produce any real effect. The **Agnihotra**, the three Vedas, the ascetic's three staves and smearing one's self with ashes, were made by Nature as the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness... **(All the ceremonies are) a means of livelihood (for) Brāhmaṇas. The three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons."**

FACT: **The three ritual reductions** - each is a genuine argument, not merely abuse, and each has the same logical shape: *take the ritual's own premise seriously, and derive an absurdity the practitioner will not accept.*

#	The reductio	The premise it tests	The absurdity generated
1	The śrāddha argument. If the food offered at the funeral ceremony can appease the hunger of the departed, "what is the use of a traveller's taking food with him? Why should not his people make some offerings in his name at home to satisfy his hunger?"	That an offering here nourishes a person elsewhere	ANALYSIS: Nourishment at a distance would make travel provisions pointless - a consequence no one accepts
2	The upstairs argument. "Food offered on the ground floor should satisfy a person living upstairs."	The same, in miniature	ANALYSIS: A vivid <i>reductio</i> of action-at-a-distance nourishment
3	The jyotiṣṭoma argument. "If the priests really believe, as they say, that the animals killed at a sacrifice are sure to reach heaven, why do they not rather sacrifice their own old parents instead of animals and make heaven sure for them?"	That ritual slaughter secures heaven for the victim	ANALYSIS: The priest's refusal reveals that he does not believe his own premise - an argument from revealed preference

ANALYSIS: **The philosophically important observation to add.** The *jyotiṣṭoma* argument is not a joke; it is an early and powerful use of **revealed preference** as evidence about belief. It says: your unwillingness to apply your doctrine where it would cost you shows that you do not hold it in the way you profess. That is a serious epistemic argument and deserves to be presented as one.

ANALYSIS: **The balance an answer must strike.** Chatterjee and Datta themselves describe the Cārvākas as raising "cheap laughter at the customary rites". An answer that reproduces only the abuse looks unserious; an answer that reproduces only the epistemology misses the school's historical bite. Present the polemic **and** extract the argument inside it.

Exam link

Primary routes: 2020 Q6(b) on transmigration and 2021 Q5(e) on the bearing of epistemology. Show one premise generating each denial rather than listing conclusions.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

- ANALYSIS: Do not present the denials as a list. Show the **derivation** from the single epistemic premise - that is what "bearing" means in 2021 Q5(e).
- ANALYSIS: Do not slide from "not established" to "does not exist" without noticing. Sharma exploits exactly that slide.
- ANALYSIS: Do not read *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ* as a recommendation of death. It is a *reductio* of the concept of liberation.
- ANALYSIS: Do not reduce the ritual criticisms to abuse. The *śrāddha* and *jyotiṣṭoma* arguments are genuine *reductios*, and the second is an argument from revealed preference.
- ANALYSIS: Do not quote the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* invective without a source-caution; it is a summary preserved by an opponent.
- ANALYSIS: Do not say "Cārvāka is the only atheist school in India". Sāṃkhya, Mīmāṃsā, Jainism and Buddhism are all non-theistic. Cārvāka is the only school whose atheism follows from its **epistemology** and which also discards karma, rebirth and liberation.
- ANALYSIS: Do not forget *adr̥ṣṭa* by name. It is the perfect test case, since its name means "the unseen".

8. ANALYSIS: Do not miss the internal tension between *svabhāvavāda* (fixed natures grounding regularity) and *yadṛcchāvāda* (fortuitous combination). Noting it is a mark of independent thought.

Revision notes

- FACT: **The template:** X is imperceptible -> only inference or testimony could reach X -> neither is a *pramāṇa* -> X is unwarranted -> X is rejected.
- ANALYSIS: Note the gap between withholding assent and denying; the doxographies attribute denial, the argument licenses only the weaker conclusion.
- FACT: God falls twice over: **epistemically** (no *pramāṇa*) and **explanatorily** (*svabhāva* suffices; "no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design").
- FACT: *Adṛṣṭa* is named explicitly among the casualties - "any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*)".
- FACT: Transmigration requires a separable self, its survival, a carrier of desert, and knowledge of all three; Cārvāka cuts every one.
- FACT: Heaven and hell are "the inventions of the priests"; *svarga* is rejected because it rests on "the unproved existence of a life after death".
- FACT: **The liberation dilemma:** freedom of a soul (absurd - there is no soul) or freedom from all pain in this life (impossible - embodiment mixes pleasure and pain); residue - *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.
- FACT: **Three ritual reductions:** *śrāddha* and the traveller's food · food downstairs for a person upstairs · *jyotiṣṭoma* and "why not sacrifice their own old parents".
- FACT: *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*: Agnihotra, the three Vedas, the three staves and ashes are "the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness"; "the three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons" - quote with a source-caution.
- ANALYSIS: The *jyotiṣṭoma* argument is an argument from **revealed preference** about what the priest actually believes.
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka is not the only non-theistic Indian school; it is the only one whose atheism is generated **epistemologically**, and the only one that also discards karma, rebirth and *mokṣa*.
- ANALYSIS: Internal tension worth noting: *svabhāvavāda* grounds regularity in fixed natures, while *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES - GOD, SOUL, KARMA, REBIRTH, HEAVEN, MOKṢA, VEDA AND RITUAL

START / CONCEPT: THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES - GOD, SOUL, KARMA, REBIRTH, HEAVEN, MOKṢA, VEDA AND RITUAL

|
v

EXACT TERMS: The Rejection Of Transcendent Entities · God · Soul · Karma · Rebirth · Heaven

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: FACT: The template: X is imperceptible -> only inference or testimony could reach X -> neither is a pramāṇa -> X is unwarranted -> X is rejected. ANALYSIS: Note the gap between withholding assent and denying; the doxographies attribute denial, the argument licenses only the weaker conclusion. FACT: God falls twice over: epistemically (no pramāṇa) and explanatorily (svabhāva suffices; "no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design"). FACT: Adṛṣṭa is named explicitly among the casualties - "any unperceived law (like adṛṣṭa)". FACT: Transmigration requires a separable self, its survival, a carrier of desert, and knowledge of all three; Cārvāka cuts every one. FACT: Heaven and hell are "the inventions of the priests"; svarga is rejected because it rests on "the unproved existence of a life after death". FACT: The liberation dilemma: freedom of a soul (absurd - there is no soul) or freedom from all pain in this life (impossible - embodiment mixes pleasure and pain); residue - maraṇam eva apavargaḥ. FACT: Three ritual reductios: śrāddha and the traveller's food · food downstairs for a person upstairs · jyotiṣṭoma and "why not sacrifice their own old parents". FACT: Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha: Agnihotra, the three Vedas, the three staves and ashes are "the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness"; "the three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons" - quote with a source-caution. ANALYSIS: The jyotiṣṭoma argument is an argument from revealed preference about what the priest actually believes. ANALYSIS: Cārvāka is not the only non-theistic Indian school; it is the only one whose atheism is generated epistemologically, and the only one that also discards karma, rebirth and mokṣa. ANALYSIS: Internal tension worth noting: svabhāvaavāda grounds regularity in fixed natures, while yadrpcchāvāda calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".

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v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Cārvāka is the only school whose atheism follows from its epistemology and which also discards karma, rebirth and liberation. ANALYSIS: Do not forget adṛṣṭa by name.

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v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: FACT: The Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha summary, as reproduced by Sharma, is the sharpest form of the polemic and should be used with an explicit source-caution: "There is no heaven, no final liberation, nor any soul in another world; nor do the actions of the four castes, orders etc. produce any real effect.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, karma (moral causation across lives), rebirth and mokṣa (liberation) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

SESSION 8 - ETHICS AND THE POLITICAL-SOCIAL MEANING - AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS JAINA REALITY (2020, 15 MARKS)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

Technical definition: This Cārvāka ethics may be called, therefore, hedonism or the theory that pleasure is the highest goal."

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Ethics
- The Political-Social Meaning
- Cārvāka Versus Jaina Reality (2020)

- In simple words
- One-line memory
- 15 Marks)

How to use them: Use Ethics to define the issue, connect The Political-Social Meaning with Cārvāka Versus Jaina Reality (2020) to explain it, and use In simple words to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

Plain-language visual - the purpose-of-life filter

DHARMA -> rejected as scripture-dependent
 ARTHA -> accepted as a means
 KAMA -> accepted as the final this-worldly end
 MOKSA -> rejected as an unproved post-mortem ideal

ARTHA -----> KAMA
 means end

In simple words: because this life is the only life securely known, Cārvāka values attainable well-being here. Wealth matters as a tool for enjoyment, not as an end by itself. The tradition must not be reduced automatically to reckless pleasure: sources distinguish crude and cultured forms.

Crude reading	Refined reading
Immediate sensual gratification	Intelligent enjoyment shaped by skill and self-control
Ignores social discipline	Recognises that society requires restraint
Common hostile caricature	Supported by the <i>dhūrta</i> / <i>suśikṣita</i> distinction

One-line memory: this-worldly enjoyment is central, but intelligent enjoyment is not identical with reckless indulgence.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The puruṣārtha ledger, and the two axes of the Cārvāka position

THE FOUR PURUSARTHAS	CARVAKA'S VERDICT
DHARMA (virtue / duty)	REJECTED : "distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted"
ARTHA (wealth)	ACCEPTED as MEANS, not as end
KAMA (enjoyment)	ACCEPTED as THE END
MOKSA (liberation)	REJECTED : obtainable "only by death, and no wise man would work for that"

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+-----+
| ARTHA ---- means ----> KAMA |
|                               |
|                               |
+-----+
  
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AND WITHIN "KAMA" THERE ARE TWO CARVAKAS:

DHURTA (cunning/crude)	SUSIKSITA (cultured/refined)
gross sensual pleasure	pleasure disciplined by the
immediate gratification	sixty-four fine arts, self-
egoistic hedonism	control and urbanity
the caricature the	Vatsyayana's Kama-sutra as the
opponents preserved	"best positive evidence"
	(Chatterjee & Datta)

ANALYSIS: Caption. Two axes, not one. The first axis is which *puruṣārthas* survive; the second is *what kind of* hedonist is doing the surviving. Almost every weak answer collapses the second axis and presents only the *dhūrta*. The textbooks themselves refuse that collapse.

1. The doctrine, stated exactly

FACT: **The transmitted sūtra:** *kāma evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ* - "enjoyment is the only end of human life."

FACT: **The four-fold verdict**, in Chatterjee and Datta's exact terms: "Of these four, the Cārvāka rejects the last two. Liberation in the sense of destruction of all sufferings can be obtained only by death and no wise man would willingly work for that end. **Virtue and vice are distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted.** Therefore neither liberation nor virtue should be our end. Wealth and enjoyment are the only rational ends that a wise man can toil to achieve. But **enjoyment is the ultimate end; wealth is not an end in itself, it is good only as a means to enjoyment.**"

ANALYSIS: **Two things to notice, both examinable.**

1. The rejection of *dharma* is **epistemically** driven, not merely appetitive. *Dharma* is rejected because it is a *scriptural* category and *śabda* is not a *pramāṇa* - the same cut that removed *ākāśa* and *ātman*. Writing "Cārvāka rejects virtue because he loves pleasure" reverses the direction of the argument.
2. *Artha* is subordinated, not co-ordinate. Cārvāka is not a materialist about *wealth*; wealth is instrumental. That is a real ethical thesis and it separates Cārvāka from mere acquisitiveness.

2. The standard of right action, and its consequentialist form

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "A **good action** is one which leads to a **balance of pleasure** and a **bad action** is one which brings about **more pain than pleasure**. This Cārvāka ethics may be called, therefore, **hedonism** or the theory that pleasure is the highest goal."

ANALYSIS: **The structure of the criterion, made explicit:**

VALUE THEORY	: pleasure is the sole intrinsic good; pain the sole intrinsic evil
NORMATIVE THEORY	: the right action is the one whose balance of pleasure over pain is greatest
SCOPE	: the doxographies present the scope as EGOISTIC -- "pleasure of the senses in this life and that too of the individual is the sole end" (Sharma)
BUT	: Chatterjee & Datta explicitly deny that ALL materialists were egoistic hedonists

ANALYSIS: **The scope question is where the real philosophy is.** Egoistic hedonism and universalistic hedonism share a value theory and differ entirely in their normative consequences. Chatterjee and Datta record the decisive consideration: "**Egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline. Life in society is impossible if man does not sacrifice a part of his pleasures for others.**" And they immediately supply the evidence that some Cārvākas saw this: "Some Cārvākas, we are told, regard the **king as God**. This implies their great faith in the necessity of society and its head."

3. Refined hedonism - the evidence, and why it matters

FACT: **The dhūrta / suśikṣita distinction.** Chatterjee and Datta: "a distinction found sometimes between the **cunning (dhūrta)** and **cultured (suśikṣita)** Cārvākas makes it likely that the Cārvākas were **not all of the same gross, uncultured type.**" Sharma records the same twofold division of "Crude and Refined Materialists".

FACT: **The evidence for refinement**, as Chatterjee and Datta present it:

Evidence	Detail
The fine arts	Materialists "devoted themselves also to the pursuit of more refined pleasures by cultivating, for example, the fine arts, the number of which is as large as sixty-four (<i>catuḥ-ṣaṣṭi-kalāḥ</i>), according to Vātsyāyana"
Political philosophy and economics	" Political philosophy and economy (daṇḍanīti and vārttā) came to be incorporated at some stage in the philosophy of the Lokāyatikas "
The king as God	Reported of some Cārvākas - implying "great faith in the necessity of society and its head"

Evidence	Detail
Vātsyāyana's Kāma-sūtra	"The best positive evidence of refined hedonism is found in the ethical philosophy propounded by Vātsyāyana in the second chapter of the <i>Kāma-sūtra</i> "

FACT: **Vātsyāyana's position, stated precisely - and note the important qualification.** Chatterjee and Datta are careful: "Though Vātsyāyana **believes in God and in life after death** and, therefore, is **not a materialist in the ordinary sense**, yet he may be regarded as one, according to a **wider** sense of the term, namely, one who tries to explain 'higher phenomena by lower ones'." His materialist tendency "consists in holding that *dharma* and *artha* are to be treated only as **means** to enjoyment, which is therefore the supreme end."

FACT: **The content of the refinement**, which is the material that rescues Cārvāka ethics from caricature:

1. Emphasis on **self-control (brahmacharya)**, spiritual discipline (*dharma*) and **urbanity (nāgarika-vṛtti)**, "without which human enjoyment of pleasure is reduced to the level of beastly enjoyment."
2. All *kāma* is "ultimately reducible to the gratification of the five senses"; the satisfaction of the senses is "necessary for the very existence of the body (*śarīra-sthiti*)", like the satisfaction of hunger.
3. The senses "must be **educated, disciplined and cultured** through a training in the sixty-four fine arts", given only after "absolute self-continenence and study" in the earlier part of life.
4. Against the impatient hedonist who will not "forgo present comfort" or "undergo any toil for future enjoyment", Vātsyāyana argues that such an attitude "would be **suicidal**", since it "would prevent a man even from the toil of cultivation and sowing seeds in the hope of the future enjoyment of a crop."
5. **"Inordinate desire, inconsistent with the principles of dharma and wealth, leads to ruin and annihilates the chances of all enjoyment."**
6. He argues, "like a modern scientific man, that some science is at the root of every successful practice."

ANALYSIS: **The philosophical upshot, and it is important.** Point 4 is a **prudential** argument *internal* to hedonism: unregulated present gratification is self-defeating **on hedonistic grounds**. That is exactly the structure of Epicurus' argument in the West, and it means that the refined Cārvāka position is not a compromise with morality imported from outside - it is what consistent hedonism requires of itself. Chatterjee and Datta conclude that Vātsyāyana "represents Indian hedonism at its best", and that the name *suśikṣita-cārvāka* was "perhaps" applied to thinkers of this kind.

ANALYSIS: **The honest counterweight.** Sharma's verdict is far harsher and must be carried too: "The ethics of the Cārvāka is a **crude individual hedonism**"; "All values are mere phantoms created by a diseased mind"; and he locates the school's downfall not in its atheism or its materialism - which it shares with respected schools - but in "the Cārvāka's **denial of all human values** which make life worth living... Sensual pleasure is a very faint shadow of the supreme pleasure. There is a qualitative difference in pleasure. **The pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher.**"

ANALYSIS: **How to adjudicate in an answer.** The two verdicts are about different things and both are usable:

SHARMA'S TARGET	: the doctrine as transmitted in the doxographies -- gross, egoistic, quantitative hedonism
CHATTERJEE & DATTA'S TARGET	: the historical breadth of the movement -- the susikṣita strand, the fine arts, dandaniti and varta, the king-as-God report, Vatsyayana's discipline
VERDICT TO WRITE	: the transmitted doctrine is vulnerable to Sharma's "pleasure of the pig" objection because it offers no QUALITATIVE distinction among pleasures; the refined strand supplies a PRUDENTIAL and CULTURAL regulation of pleasure but still no independent standard of value. Carvaka can be made prudent; it cannot easily be made moral.

4. The "debt and ghee" verse - and the source caution

CAUTION: **The verse**, as preserved in the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* and reproduced by Sharma: **"While life remains let a man live happily, let him feed on ghee (clarified butter) even though he runs in debt; when once the body becomes ashes, how can it ever return here?"**

ANALYSIS: **The source caution, which must accompany every use of this verse.** This is:

1. A verse preserved in a **fourteenth-century doxography** compiled by **Mādhava**, a Vedāntin - that is, by an opponent;
2. Presented in a chapter whose purpose is refutation;
3. Not attributable to any surviving primary Cārvāka text;
4. Frequently paraphrased in exam scripts as *yāvaj jīvet sukhaṃ jīvet*, which the authored knowledge file itself flags as a **doxographical verse associated with the tradition, not a securely locatable quotation from an extant primary Cārvāka text**.

ANALYSIS: **How to use it correctly in an answer:** "*The often-quoted verse - live happily, feed on ghee even in debt, for the body once turned to ashes does not return - is preserved in the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha, an opponent's compendium, and should be treated as a doxographical characterisation of the school's spirit rather than as its own scripture.*" That single sentence signals scholarly care and forestalls the examiner's objection.

ANALYSIS: **The philosophical point beneath the rhetoric.** Strip away the polemic and the verse encodes a real argument: *if there is no post-mortem accounting, then the discounting of present goods in favour of future or other-worldly ones is irrational*. That is an argument about the **rationality of deferral under a finite horizon**, and it is answerable - Vātsyāyana himself answers it, in point 4 above, by observing that a refusal to defer would prevent even sowing a crop. Presenting the verse *with* its internal rebuttal is far better than quoting it as a slogan.

5. Positivistic, naturalistic, secular - a first pass at the 2024 label

ANALYSIS: Full treatment belongs to Subtopic 9 and the workbook, but the ethical material contributes three of the strongest points:

Label	Why it fits FACT:	Why it must be qualified ANALYSIS:
Naturalistic	<i>Svabhāvavāda</i> ; value grounded in embodied pleasure and pain; no supernatural sanction	The notion of "nature" is descriptive, not analysed into laws
Secular	Morality is detached from scripture and priesthood; <i>daṇḍanīti</i> and <i>vārttā</i> enter the school; the king, not God, is the guarantor of order	The detachment is polemical rather than institutional; no political theory survives
Positivistic	FACT: Chatterjee and Datta apply the word themselves: the theory "may also be called positivism, because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena "; they add that the Cārvāka view "that no inference can yield certain knowledge is the view of many contemporary Western thinkers like the pragmatists and logical positivists "	ANALYSIS: Positivism venerates science , which is built on inference; Cārvāka attacks inference. Positivism has a constructive programme; Cārvāka has a polemical minimalism. And Comte's positivism carries a philosophy of history and a sociology entirely absent here

Exam link

Primary routes: 2020 Q7(c) and 2024 Q5(a). Keep ethics source-critical, separate prudence from morality, and compare Cārvāka with Jainism or positivism only on named axes.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not reduce Cārvāka ethics to reckless sensualism. The textbooks themselves distinguish *dhūrta* from *suśikṣita* Cārvākas.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka rejects *dharma* because he prefers pleasure. He rejects it because it is a **scriptural** category, and *śabda* is not a *pramāṇa*.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not treat *artha* as a second end. It is explicitly a **means** to *kāma*.
4. CAUTION: Do not quote the "ghee and debt" verse as Cārvāka scripture. It is preserved in the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*, an opponent's compendium.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not call Vātsyāyana a Cārvāka without qualification. He "believes in God and in life after death" and is a materialist only "according to a wider sense of the term".
6. ANALYSIS: Do not omit *daṇḍanīti*, *vārttā* and the king-as-God report if the question touches the school's social or political meaning.

7. ANALYSIS: Do not answer the 2020 Jainism comparison with "materialism versus spirituality". Run the axes: *pramāṇas*, definition of the real, constituents, *ākāśa*, soul, substance-mode, standpoint, karma, liberation.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not forget that Jainism holds consciousness to be the soul's **inseparable essence**, expressly denying the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".
9. ANALYSIS: Do not present Sharma's harsh verdict and Chatterjee and Datta's sympathetic one as a contradiction. They target different objects - the transmitted doctrine and the historical movement.

Revision notes

- FACT: *kāma evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ* - enjoyment is the only end; *artha* is its **means**; *dharma* and *mokṣa* are rejected.
- FACT: *Dharma* is rejected on **epistemic** grounds: virtue and vice are "distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted".
- FACT: Criterion of right action: a good action yields a balance of pleasure; a bad one brings more pain than pleasure. Hence hedonism.
- FACT: **Dhūrta** (cunning/crude) versus **suśikṣita** (cultured/refined) Cārvākas - the textbooks refuse a single, gross portrait.
- FACT: Evidence for refinement: the sixty-four fine arts (*catuḥ-śaṣṭi-kalāḥ*); *daṇḍanīti* and *vārtā* incorporated into Lokāyata; some Cārvākas regard the **king as God**.
- FACT: **Vātsyāyana** is "the best positive evidence of refined hedonism" - but he believes in God and an afterlife and so is a materialist only "in a wider sense".
- FACT: Vātsyāyana's regulation: *brahmacarya*, urbanity (*nāgarika-vṛtti*), education of the senses, and the argument that refusing to defer would prevent even sowing a crop.
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "Egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline."
- ANALYSIS: Sharma's counterweight: "crude individual hedonism"; the school fell through "the denial of all human values"; "the pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher."
- CAUTION: The "ghee and debt" verse comes from the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* - an opponent's compendium; quote with caution, and extract the argument about deferral under a finite horizon.
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta apply the word **positivism** to Cārvāka themselves - "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" - and compare its view of inference to the pragmatists and logical positivists.
- FACT: **2020 comparison**: one *pramāṇa* versus five kinds of knowledge · four *bhūtas* versus six *dravyas* · *ākāśa* rejected versus accepted · no soul versus infinite *jīvas* with consciousness as inseparable essence · single standpoint versus *anekāntavāda* and *syādvāda* · no karma versus **material** karma · no liberation versus *mokṣa* and *kevala-jñāna*.
- ANALYSIS: Shared ground with Jainism: both *nāstika*, both realist about the perceptible world, both reject a creator God.
- ANALYSIS: Verdict: Cārvāka's ethics is a coherent theory of **prudence** and an incomplete theory of **morality**.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ETHICS AND THE POLITICAL-SOCIAL MEANING - AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS JAINA REALITY (2020, 15 MARKS)

START / CONCEPT: ETHICS AND THE POLITICAL-SOCIAL MEANING - AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS JAINA REALITY (2020, 15 MARKS)

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Ethics · The Political-Social Meaning · Cārvāka Versus Jaina Reality (2020 · In simple words · One-line memory · 15 Marks)

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Hence hedonism. FACT: Dhūrta (cunning/crude) versus suśikṣita (cultured/refined) Cārvākas - the textbooks refuse a single, gross portrait. FACT: Evidence for refinement: the sixty-four fine arts (catuḥ-ṣaṣṭi-kalāḥ); daṇḍanīti and vārttā incorporated into Lokāyata; some Cārvākas regard the king as God. FACT: Vātsyāyana is "the best positive evidence of refined hedonism" - but he believes in God and an afterlife and so is a materialist only "in a wider sense".

FACT: Vātsyāyana's regulation: brahmacarya, urbanity (nāgarika-vṛtti), education of the senses, and the argument that refusing to defer would prevent even sowing a crop. FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "Egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline." ANALYSIS: Sharma's counterweight: "crude individual hedonism"; the school fell through "the denial of all human values"; "the pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher." CAUTION: The "ghee and debt" verse comes from the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha - an opponent's compendium; quote with caution, and extract the argument about deferral under a finite horizon. FACT: Chatterjee and Datta apply the word positivism to Cārvāka themselves - "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" - and compare its view of inference to the pragmatists and logical positivists. FACT: 2020 comparison: one pramāṇa versus five kinds of knowledge · four bhūtas versus six dravyas · ākāśa rejected versus accepted · no soul versus infinite jīvas with consciousness as inseparable essence · single standpoint versus anekāntavāda and syādvāda · no karma versus material karma · no liberation versus mokṣa and kevala-jñāna. ANALYSIS: Shared ground with Jainism: both nāstika, both realist about the perceptible world, both reject a creator God. ANALYSIS: Verdict: Cārvāka's ethics is a coherent theory of prudence and an incomplete theory of morality.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This Cārvāka ethics may be called, therefore, hedonism or the theory that pleasure is the highest goal."

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: One-line memory: this-worldly enjoyment is central, but intelligent enjoyment is not identical with reckless indulgence.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

SESSION 9 - COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER-WRITING ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The synthesis-stage diagnostic questions are retained in the next section so that the complete Basic teaching remains separate from objective retrieval practice.

Technical definition: In simple words: every Cārvāka answer should show a chain, not a list.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Final verdict: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) is philosophically strongest as a critique of dogmatism and weak inference, but its restriction of knowledge to perception is too narrow to explain science, ordinary reasoning and its own universal claims.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Comparative Synthesis
- Writing Architecture
- In simple words
- One-line memory
- Cārvāka

- Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika

How to use them: Use Comparative Synthesis to define the issue, connect Writing Architecture with In simple words to explain it, and use One-line memory to distinguish or qualify the conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Final verdict: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) is philosophically strongest as a critique of dogmatism and weak inference, but its restriction of knowledge to perception is too narrow to explain science, ordinary reasoning and its own universal claims.

Plain-language visual - the complete answer spine

PERCEPTION ONLY
|
INFERENCE / TESTIMONY REJECTED
|
FOUR-ELEMENT MATERIALISM
|
BODY-SELF + NO TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES
|
ARTHA AS MEANS + KAMA AS END
|
BALANCED VERDICT: critical empiricism, but too narrow for science

In simple words: every Cārvāka answer should show a chain, not a list. Begin with the epistemic rule, derive the metaphysics and ethics, then evaluate both the achievement and the cost.

Marks	Fast structure
10	Define -> derive -> one objection -> verdict
15	Reconstruct -> example -> criticism/reply -> evaluation
20	Full dialectic -> comparison -> graded conclusion

One-line memory: ONE *pramāṇa*, FOUR elements, TWO accepted aims, ZERO transcendent entities.

VISUAL: MASTER CONCEPT MAP - the whole syllabus item on one page



1. The master comparison table

Axis	Cārvāka	Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	Buddhism	Jainism
<i>Pramāṇas</i>	FACT: 1 - perception	FACT: 4 - perception, inference, comparison, testimony	FACT: 2 - perception, inference	FACT: Fivefold knowledge; inference admitted
Elements / substances	FACT: 4 <i>bhūtas</i> , no <i>ākāśa</i>	FACT: 9 <i>dravyas</i> , including <i>ākāśa</i> , <i>ātman</i> , <i>manas</i>	ANALYSIS: <i>Dharmas</i> , momentary	FACT: 6 <i>dravyas</i> , including <i>ākāśa</i> and <i>kāla</i>
Self	FACT: Living body (<i>dehātmavāda</i>)	FACT: Eternal substantial <i>ātman</i>	FACT: No self; five <i>skandhas</i> , <i>santāna</i>	FACT: Infinite <i>jīvas</i> ; consciousness their inseparable essence
Consciousness	FACT: Emergent by-product of matter	FACT: Adventitious quality of <i>ātman</i>	FACT: <i>Vijñāna</i> , one conditioned <i>skandha</i>	FACT: Essence of the soul, obscured by karma
God	FACT: Rejected; <i>svabhāva</i> suffices	FACT: Proved by <i>kāryāt</i> , <i>āyojanāt</i> , <i>dhṛtyādeḥ</i> , <i>padāt/śruteḥ</i>	FACT: Rejected; conditions suffice	FACT: No creator; godhood attained by the <i>siddha</i>
Karma	FACT: Rejected as unseen	FACT: Accepted; <i>adṛṣṭa</i> , God as dispenser	FACT: Accepted; causal-moral continuity	FACT: Accepted; karma as subtle matter
Rebirth	FACT: Rejected	FACT: Accepted	FACT: Accepted, without a self	FACT: Accepted
Liberation	FACT: None; <i>maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>	FACT: <i>Apavarga</i> as cessation of pain	FACT: <i>Nirvāṇa</i>	FACT: <i>Mokṣa</i> ; <i>kevala-jñāna</i>
Vedic authority	FACT: Rejected - hence <i>nāstika</i>	FACT: Accepted	FACT: Rejected	FACT: Rejected
Standpoint theory	ANALYSIS: None; single standpoint	ANALYSIS: None	FACT: <i>Samvṛti</i> / <i>paramārtha</i>	FACT: <i>Anekānta</i> , <i>naya</i> , <i>syādvāda</i>

2. Criticisms and replies - the consolidated grid

#	Criticism	Cārvāka's best reply	Residual assessment
1	FACT: Self-refutation : the universal denial of inference is itself inferential; other minds and ideas are never perceived	ANALYSIS: Soften the thesis to a denial of <i>apodictic certainty</i> , or restrict it to transcendental inference; or advance no thesis at all (<i>viṭaṇḍā</i>)	ANALYSIS: Decisive against the strong form; the softened form survives but is a much weaker doctrine
2	FACT: Science becomes impossible : without induction, no stable knowledge beyond isolated perceptions	ANALYSIS: Practical expectations remain available, tied to future perceptual check	ANALYSIS: Saves practice better than theory; narrows Cārvāka into radical empiricist caution
3	FACT: Perception itself errs (flat earth, static earth, small sun) - and is corrected <i>by inference</i>	ANALYSIS: The corrections are ultimately perceptual and practical; and fallibility about <i>how</i> things appear does not license unperceivable entities	ANALYSIS: Adequate for the flat-earth case, weak for heliocentrism; the hierarchy P over I is genuinely threatened
4	FACT: Emergence does not explain subjectivity : redness and intoxication are public; consciousness is private, and "neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard"	ANALYSIS: Positing an immaterial soul renames the gap rather than closing it	ANALYSIS: Both sides face the gap; the Cārvāka at least does not claim to have crossed it
5	FACT: Dependence is not production : light is necessary for sight but is not its cause; the two horns of a bull are constantly conjoined but not causally related	ANALYSIS: The instrument-hypothesis needs a user, and no user is perceived; materialism is the more economical of two unproven options	ANALYSIS: Genuinely undecided; an honest answer says so
6	FACT: Crude hedonism : no qualitative distinction among pleasures - "the pleasure of the pig"	ANALYSIS: The <i>suśikṣita</i> strand, the sixty-four arts, and Vātsyāyana's prudential regulation of desire	ANALYSIS: Supplies prudence and culture, not an independent standard of value
7	CAUTION: Hostile sources make fair reconstruction impossible	ANALYSIS: Convergence across Buddhist, Advaita, Jaina and Vedāntic doxographies fixes a doctrinal core	ANALYSIS: Use caution without abandoning content
8	ANALYSIS: Same-standpoint inconsistency (Sharma): perception is accepted and inference rejected at the same level, with no <i>vyāvahārika</i> / <i>pāramārthika</i> distinction available	ANALYSIS: Adopt the level-distinction as a repair	ANALYSIS: Effective, but the repair is the interpreter's, not the school's

Exam link

Use the complete 2018-2025 routing matrix and the 10/15/20-mark architecture. Every answer must end in a graded verdict tied to a named criterion.

Traps and recap

The synthesis-stage diagnostic questions are retained in the next section so that the complete Basic teaching remains separate from objective retrieval practice.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER-WRITING ARCHITECTURE

START / CONCEPT: COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER-WRITING ARCHITECTURE

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Comparative Synthesis · Writing Architecture · In simple words · One-line memory ·
Cārvāka · Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: In simple words: every Cārvāka answer should show a chain, not a list.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Use the complete 2018-2025 routing matrix and the 10/15/20-mark architecture.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The synthesis-stage diagnostic questions are retained in the next section so that the complete Basic teaching remains separate from objective retrieval practice.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Final verdict: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) is philosophically strongest as a critique of dogmatism and weak inference, but its restriction of knowledge to perception is too narrow to explain science, ordinary reasoning and its own universal claims.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice protocol - [CORE ANSWER]

Attempt each item before reading its key. Answer placement is balanced, deterministic and non-patterned using a stable topic seed. across all forty-eight diagnostics.

Questions 1-40 are original diagnostic practice. Answer placement is balanced, deterministic and non-patterned using a stable topic seed.

1. The three names

Which set correctly pairs each name of the school with the sense recorded in the standard textbooks?

- A. *Cārvāka* - "the four-element theorist"; *Lokāyata* - "the world-renouncer"; *Bārhaspatya* - a disciple of Jayarāśi.
- B. *Cārvāka* - from *carv*, "to chew", giving the "eat, drink and be merry" doctrine, or from *cāru-vāk*, "sweet-worded"; *Lokāyata* - *lokāyata-mata*, "the view of the common people"; *Bārhaspatya* - "of Bṛhaspati", the traditional founder whose *Sūtra* is lost.
- C. *Cārvāka* - a Buddhist sect of the *Majjhima Nikāya*; *Lokāyata* - the Jaina name for materialism; *Bārhaspatya* - a Mīmāṃsā sub-school.
- D. *Cārvāka* - "the sceptic"; *Lokāyata* - "the ritualist"; *Bārhaspatya* - the author of the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha*.

Answer: B. *Cārvāka* - from *carv*, "to chew", giving the "eat, drink and be merry" doctrine, or from *cāru-vāk*, "sweet-worded"; *Lokāyata* - *lokāyata-mata*, "the view of the common people"; *Bārhaspatya* - "of Bṛhaspati", the traditional founder whose *Sūtra* is lost.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta record both etymologies of "Cārvāka" - the name of a sage, or a descriptive name from *carv* ("eat, chew") or *cāru-vāk* ("nice word") - and gloss *lokāyatamata* as "the view of common people". Sharma records Bṛhaspati as "a heretical teacher ... regarded as the traditional founder of this school", whose *Sūtra* "has unfortunately perished". D misattributes the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha*, which is Jayarāśi's.

MEMORY: Trap: *Lokāyata* means "of the common people", not "world-renouncing" - the school is emphatically **this-worldly**.

2. The exact sense of *nāstika*

In Sanskrit philosophical literature, in what sense or senses is Cārvāka *nāstika*?

- A. Only in the modern vernacular sense of "atheist", since it denies God.
- B. In neither sense, since *nāstika* applies only to schools that deny the external world.

C. Only in the second sense, since Cārvāka accepts Vedic authority while rejecting the afterlife.

D. In **both** classical senses - it rejects the authority of the Vedas, which is the primary classificatory criterion, and it denies life after death; Jaina and Bauddha schools, by contrast, are *nāstika* on the first criterion but would count as *āstika* on the second.

Answer: D. In both classical senses - it rejects the authority of the Vedas, which is the primary classificatory criterion, and it denies life after death; Jaina and Bauddha schools, by contrast, are *nāstika* on the first criterion but would count as *āstika* on the second.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta set this out exactly: "'Āstika' means 'one who believes in the authority of the Vedas' or 'one who believes in life after death'... The six orthodox schools are 'āstika', and the Cārvāka is 'nāstika' in **both the senses**." They add that in the second sense "even the Jaina and Bauddha schools are 'āstika', as they believe in life after death." A adopts the modern vernacular sense, which fails because Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are non-theistic yet *āstika*. C reverses the school's most famous rejection.

MEMORY: Trap: *nāstika* is primarily about **Vedic authority**, not about God.

3. The source situation

Which statement best describes the textual situation of Cārvāka philosophy?

A. The complete *Brhaspati-sūtra* survives with three commentaries.

B. Nothing whatever is known of the school, since all sources are hostile.

C. The *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* is an independent primary source written by a Cārvāka.

D. No systematic primary work survives; the *Brhaspati-sūtra* is lost and only about a dozen *sūtras* and verses are quoted by other authors; knowledge of the school comes chiefly from works that state its views **in order to refute them**, so that, as Sharma puts it, "the weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted".

Answer: D. No systematic primary work survives; the *Brhaspati-sūtra* is lost and only about a dozen *sūtras* and verses are quoted by other authors; knowledge of the school comes chiefly from works that state its views in order to refute them, so that, as Sharma puts it, "the weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted".

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not find any systematic work on materialism... almost every work of the other schools states, **for refutation**, the materialistic views. Our knowledge of Indian materialism is chiefly based on these." Sharma adds that even the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* summary "seems to be based on such accounts", which disposes of C. B overstates: convergence across independent hostile sources still fixes a doctrinal core.

MEMORY: Trap: the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* is Mādhava's Vedāntic compendium - an opponent's summary, not Cārvāka scripture.

4. Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa

What is the correct scholarly use of Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa's *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* in a Cārvāka answer?

A. As a Nyāya refutation of Cārvāka epistemology.

B. As a Mīmāṃsā defence of Vedic authority against the materialists.

C. As the sole surviving text-witness of the tradition **and** as its internal limit-case - since Jayarāśi, a Cārvāka "of an extreme type", attacks the validity of **perceptual** knowledge itself and refuses to accept even the physical elements, so he cannot be used to state the school's defining thesis.

D. As the primary text establishing that perception alone is a *pramāṇa*.

Answer: C. As the sole surviving text-witness of the tradition and as its internal limit-case - since Jayarāśi, a Cārvāka "of an extreme type", attacks the validity of perceptual knowledge itself and refuses to accept even the physical elements, so he cannot be used to state the school's defining thesis.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta describe the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* as "an interesting specimen of Indian absolute scepticism" whose author "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the

validity of perceptual knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements", concluding "like an anti-intellectualist pragmatist" that practical life goes on regardless. Sharma records its publication by the Oriental Institute of Baroda in 1940. D is exactly the misuse the option is designed to test; A and B misplace him entirely.

MEMORY: **Trap:** using Jayarāśi to state Cārvāka epistemology destroys the very thesis - perception alone is a *pramāṇa* - that defines the school.

5. The *pramāṇa* ledger

Arranged by the number of independent *pramāṇas* admitted, which sequence is correct?

- A. Cārvāka 2 · Nyāya 3 · Mīmāṃsā 4 · Advaita 5.
- B. Cārvāka 1 · Nyāya 2 · Sāṃkhya 4 · Advaita 3.
- C. All schools admit exactly three *pramāṇas*, differing only in their names.
- D. Cārvāka 1 · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism 2 · Sāṃkhya-Yoga 3 · Nyāya 4 · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā 5 · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita 6.

Answer: D. Cārvāka 1 · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism 2 · Sāṃkhya-Yoga 3 · Nyāya 4 · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā 5 · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita 6.

Explanation: This is the standard ledger of classical Indian epistemology: Cārvāka admits perception alone; Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism add inference; Sāṃkhya-Yoga add testimony; Nyāya adds comparison; Prābhākara adds postulation; Bhāṭṭa and Advaita add non-apprehension. Cārvāka sits at the **lower bound**, which is precisely why every other school must justify its additions against him. A, B and C misplace multiple schools.

MEMORY: **Trap:** Cārvāka is not an eccentric outlier but the minimum of a shared ledger - say so, and the answer immediately looks structural rather than descriptive.

6. Internal perception and consciousness

An opponent argues: "Internal perception gives immediate knowledge of our mental states, and in these we perceive consciousness, which is nowhere found in external material objects; so there must be an immaterial substance whose quality consciousness is." How does the Cārvāka respond?

- A. He **admits** that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception, but denies that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material entity - consciousness is a quality of the perceptible living body itself, since no soul is ever perceived apart from it.
- B. He denies internal perception altogether, admitting only the five external senses.
- C. He accepts the argument and admits an immaterial soul while denying its immortality.
- D. He denies that consciousness exists.

Answer: A. He admits that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception, but denies that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material entity - consciousness is a quality of the perceptible living body itself, since no soul is ever perceived apart from it.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the reply verbatim in substance: "The Cārvākas admit that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception. But they deny that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material or spiritual entity. As consciousness is perceived to exist in the perceptible living body composed of the material elements, it must be a quality of this body itself." D makes him an eliminativist; B would gut the very reply he needs; C contradicts *dehātmavāda*.

MEMORY: **Trap:** Cārvāka is a **materialist** about consciousness, not a **denier** of it.

7. Truth as an "accident"

The Cārvāka concedes that people constantly act on inference and that inferences sometimes succeed. What philosophical conclusion does he draw from that concession?

- A. That inference is therefore a *pramāṇa* in practical matters.
- B. That "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" - so truth is not the essential and inseparable character that *pramāṇa*-hood requires, even though people go on inferring and often succeed.
- C. That success proves the underlying *vyāpti*.
- D. That all inferences are false.

Answer: B. That "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one" - so truth is not the essential and inseparable character that *pramāṇa*-hood requires, even though people go on inferring and often succeed.

Explanation: The formulation is Chatterjee and Datta's: people "act uncritically on the wrong belief that our inference is true"; sometimes inference succeeds and sometimes it errs; therefore truth is "only an accident, and a separable one, that we find only in some inferences." A and C are the very inferences the Cārvāka blocks. D overstates: he never claims all inferences are false, only that truth does not belong to inference **as such**.

MEMORY: Trap: the argument is about the **modality** of truth's attachment to inference - accidental and separable, not essential and inseparable.

8. The rejection of *śabda*

Which reconstruction correctly gives the Cārvāka argument against testimony as an independent *pramāṇa*?

- A. Words are unreal, therefore what they express is unreal.
- B. Only *ṛṣis* are reliable, and no *ṛṣi* is now perceivable.
- C. Scripture is composed by human beings, therefore every scriptural statement is false.
- D. Words heard through the ears are **perceived**, and knowledge of words is therefore valid; but insofar as words mean things not within our perception they "are not free from error and doubt", and acceptance of an authority runs through the suppressed inference "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" - so testimony, being based on inference, is "as precarious as inference".

Answer: D. Words heard through the ears are perceived, and knowledge of words is therefore valid; but insofar as words mean things not within our perception they "are not free from error and doubt", and acceptance of an authority runs through the suppressed inference "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" - so testimony, being based on inference, is "as precarious as inference".

Explanation: This is Chatterjee and Datta's argument step for step, and it explains why the Cārvāka can reject *śabda* as a *pramāṇa* without rejecting language: sounds are perceived, meanings are not. A is false - words are perceived and real. B invents a condition of reliability the Cārvāka never accepts. C is a non sequitur; the Cārvāka's charge against the Veda is epistemic and sociological, not a general inference from human authorship to falsity.

MEMORY: Trap: rejecting testimony as a *pramāṇa* is not rejecting communication.

9. Door 1

Why, according to the Cārvāka, can *vyāpti* not be established by perception?

- A. Because the invariable relation could be established only by knowledge of **all** cases of the mark and the probandum, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now in different parts of the world, to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".
- B. Because *vyāpti* is a relation between words rather than between things, and words are not perceived.
- C. Because perception is itself invalid, being contradicted by inference in cases such as the apparently flat earth.
- D. Because perception apprehends only universals and never the particulars between which the relation is supposed to hold.

Answer: A. Because the invariable relation could be established only by knowledge of all cases of the mark and the probandum, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now in different

parts of the world, to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta state the argument in exactly these terms: the major premise "can be established only if we have a knowledge of all cases of smoke and presence of fire. This, however, is not possible." C is Sharma's counter-attack against the Cārvāka, not the Cārvāka's own reasoning - he accepts perception as the one *pramāṇa*. D inverts the position, and would in any case describe Nyāya's *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* doctrine rather than Cārvāka's. B confuses the semantic vehicle of the universal with its content; the Cārvāka's objection is evidential, and he elsewhere insists that words heard **are** perceived.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the gap between the observed set and the universal claimed is a gap of **kind**, not of degree - no amount of further counting closes it.

10. The class-character reply

An objector says: granted we cannot perceive all individual smokes, we can perceive the class-characters "smokeness" and "fireness" and the relation between them, and so license the inference. What is the Cārvāka's two-part reply?

- A. That class-characters do not exist, since only Nyāya posits universals.
- B. That the relation between class-characters is established by testimony.
- C. That class-characters are perceived only by *yogins*.
- D. That even granting perception of a relation between smokeness and fireness, no invariable relation between **all individual** cases follows - to infer a **particular** fire one must know it is inseparably related to the **particular** smoke perceived; and further, that "smokeness" itself cannot be known by perception, since not all cases of smoke are perceived. Hence "the difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal remains here as before."

Answer: D. That even granting perception of a relation between smokeness and fireness, no invariable relation between all individual cases follows - to infer a particular fire one must know it is inseparably related to the particular smoke perceived; and further, that "smokeness" itself cannot be known by perception, since not all cases of smoke are perceived. Hence "the difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal remains here as before."

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give both limbs: the universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference, and the class-character is itself not perceptually knowable while all instances are not perceived. C invents a doctrine of yogic perception the Cārvāka would reject outright. A states a stronger ontological thesis than the reply requires. B contradicts the rejection of *śabda*.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the reply is **two-part**; giving only one limb halves the argument.

11. Door 2 and the deduction-induction pair

Sharma summarises the Cārvāka case against inference with the line "Induction is uncertain and deduction is argument in a circle." What exactly does each half assert?

- A. That induction is deductive and deduction is inductive.
- B. That both are valid but useless.
- C. That deduction is invalid in form and induction is invalid in matter.
- D. That **deduction** is a *petitio principii*, since its conclusion is already contained in a major premise whose validity is unproved; and **induction**, offered to establish that major premise, "proceeds unwarrantedly from the known to the unknown" - so each is repaired only by the other, and neither is independently secure.

Answer: D. That deduction is a petitio principii, since its conclusion is already contained in a major premise whose validity is unproved; and induction, offered to establish that major premise, "proceeds unwarrantedly from the known to the unknown" - so each is repaired only by the other, and neither is independently secure.

Explanation: Sharma states both halves in these terms, adding the Cārvāka gibe that "the logicians ... find themselves stuck up in the mud of inference." C is wrong on the first half: the Cārvāka concedes deductive **validity** and attacks the grounding of the premise. A is incoherent; B misses the epistemic point.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the dilemma is a trap because each horn's cure is the other horn's wound.

12. Door 3's second bolt

Besides the circularity of grounding inference in testimony whose own validity is inferred, what **second** objection does the Cārvāka raise against basing *vyāpti* on testimony?

- A. That testimony is a species of perception and therefore adds nothing.
- B. That "if inference always depended on testimony, **no one could infer anything by himself**" - which misdescribes inference, manifestly a first-person cognitive capacity, as parasitic on another's word.
- C. That testimony is always given in Sanskrit, which most people do not understand.
- D. That testimony belongs to the *āstika* schools alone.

Answer: B. That "if inference always depended on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself" - which misdescribes inference, manifestly a first-person cognitive capacity, as parasitic on another's word.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta and Sharma both record this reductio. It is independent of the circularity objection and is regularly omitted by candidates, which is exactly why it is worth carrying. C is irrelevant; D is false of Jainism and Buddhism, which reject Vedic authority but use testimony; A confuses the perception of **sounds** with the acceptance of **content**.

MEMORY: **Trap:** two bolts on Door 3 - circularity **and** the first-person point.

13. The upādhi example

In the standard textbook illustration of *upādhi*, which inference goes wrong, and why?

- A. A man perceives smoke and infers fire; he errs because smoke may arise without fire.
- B. A man who has repeatedly perceived fire accompanied by smoke later perceives **fire** and infers **smoke**; he errs because he failed to notice the condition (*upādhi*) of **wetness of fuel**, on the presence of which alone fire is attended with smoke.
- C. A man perceives a rope and infers a snake; he errs because of defective light.
- D. A man perceives a *gavaya* and infers a cow; he errs because similarity is not identity.

Answer: B. A man who has repeatedly perceived fire accompanied by smoke later perceives fire and infers smoke; he errs because he failed to notice the condition (upādhi) of wetness of fuel, on the presence of which alone fire is attended with smoke.

Explanation: This is Chatterjee and Datta's example verbatim in substance, and note the **direction**: the defective inference runs from fire to smoke, not from smoke to fire. Sharma and the authored knowledge file confirm the same case. A reverses the direction and states a claim the Cārvāka does not make in this illustration; C is the standard Advaita example of error; D concerns *upamāna*.

MEMORY: **Trap:** candidates routinely reverse this example. The *upādhi* case is **fire -> smoke**, defeated by wet fuel; a red-hot iron ball is fire without smoke.

14. The causal escape

A logician proposes: "We can ground the invariable relation between smoke and fire on a **causal** relation between them." How does the Cārvāka answer?

- A. That causal relations are established by scripture.
- B. That causation is a category of the understanding imposed by the mind.
- C. That "a causal relation, being **only a kind of invariable relation**, cannot be established by perception owing to the same difficulties" - so the proposal merely renames the problem; and repeated perception of two things occurring together cannot establish it either, since one must first be certain that no unperceived *upādhi* is operating.
- D. That causal relations hold only between material elements and therefore cannot ground any inference.

Answer: C. That "a causal relation, being only a kind of invariable relation, cannot be established by perception owing to the same difficulties" - so the proposal merely renames the problem; and repeated perception of two things occurring together cannot establish it either, since one must first be certain that no unperceived upādhi is operating.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give exactly this reply, and add the crucial second step about *upādhi*: mere repeated co-occurrence proves nothing until unconditionality is secured, and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden". A contradicts the rejection of *śabda*; B imports Kant; D is not the Cārvāka's argument.

MEMORY: Trap: the causal move is not an escape - a causal relation is a **species** of the invariable relation under attack.

15. The Socrates syllogism

According to the Cārvāka, what precisely is wrong with "All men are mortal; Socrates is a man; therefore Socrates is mortal"?

- A. The conclusion concerns a future event, and no statement about the future can be meaningful.
- B. The middle term is undistributed, making the syllogism formally invalid.
- C. Nothing in its **form** - but the major premise is an unrestricted universal functioning as *vyāpti*, and it can be established neither by perception (all men are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii* or regress), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); the deduction therefore merely re-states what induction never secured, and is an argument in a circle.
- D. Socrates is not perceived by the speaker, so no proposition about him can be entertained.

Answer: C. Nothing in its form - but the major premise is an unrestricted universal functioning as *vyāpti*, and it can be established neither by perception (all men are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii* or regress), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); the deduction therefore merely re-states what induction never secured, and is an argument in a circle.

Explanation: The Cārvāka grants formal validity and attacks the grounding of the universal; Sharma adds that the conclusion is "already contained in the major premise". B misdescribes a valid Barbara syllogism. D would abolish reference through testimony altogether, which even the Cārvāka does not do, since words are perceived. A imports a verificationist thesis about future-tensed statements that no Cārvāka source advances in this form.

MEMORY: Trap: never write that the Cārvāka calls the syllogism **invalid**.

16. The self-refutation charge

Which formulation states the self-refutation charge against Cārvāka most precisely?

- A. That the Cārvāka's acceptance of perception contradicts his acceptance of the four elements.
- B. That "no inference is a valid source of knowledge" is itself a **universal** proposition, not given in any single perception, so it is either inferential and self-defeating or fails its own standard; and further, as Sharma presses, thoughts, ideas and other minds "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the very act of refuting an opponent presupposes inference.
- C. That the Cārvāka contradicts scripture, which is self-refuting for any Indian school.
- D. That the Cārvāka's hedonism contradicts his materialism.

Answer: B. That "no inference is a valid source of knowledge" is itself a universal proposition, not given in any single perception, so it is either inferential and self-defeating or fails its own standard; and further, as Sharma presses, thoughts, ideas and other minds "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the very act of refuting an opponent presupposes inference.

Explanation: Sharma states the charge at length, concluding that "the self-refuted Cārvāka position is called sheer nonsense and no system of philosophy." C confuses heterodoxy with incoherence. D and A name tensions that are not the self-refutation charge - and A is not a tension at all, since the four elements are perceptible.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the sharpest form of the charge is the **other-minds** point, and it is the one most often omitted.

17. Anvaya and vyatireka

In the Nyāya construction of *vyāpti*, what do *anvaya* and *vyatireka* contribute, and why is the pair stronger than mere counting?

- A. *Anvaya* is agreement in presence - wherever the *hetu*, there the *sādhya*; *vyatireka* is agreement in absence - where the *sādhya* is absent, the *hetu* is absent. Together they make *bhūyodarśana* a **structured search for counter-instances** rather than a tally, so that a relation surviving deliberate attempts to find *hetu*-without-*sādhya* has a warrant that a mere count does not.
- B. *Anvaya* is perception and *vyatireka* is inference.
- C. *Anvaya* is the elimination of *upādhis* and *vyatireka* is hypothetical reasoning.
- D. *Anvaya* is the major premise and *vyatireka* the minor premise of the five-membered syllogism.

Answer: A. Anvaya is agreement in presence - wherever the hetu, there the sādhya; vyatireka is agreement in absence - where the sādhya is absent, the hetu is absent. Together they make bhūyodarśana a structured search for counter-instances rather than a tally, so that a relation surviving deliberate attempts to find hetu-without-sādhya has a warrant that a mere count does not.

Explanation: The authored Nyāya file lists repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*), supportive reasoning (*tarka*) and elimination of *upādhi* as the means of establishing *vyāpti*, and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence is the disciplined form the observation takes. D misdescribes the *pañcāvayava* structure; B and C misassign the terms - *upādhi*-elimination and *tarka* are distinct stages.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the Nyāya answer to Cārvāka is **negative-case testing**, not "we have seen many cases".

18. Tarka

What is *tarka*, and what is its status in Nyāya?

- A. The extraordinary perception through which a universal is presented in a particular.
- B. The technical name for the fallacy of the undistributed middle.
- C. Not a *pramāṇa* at all but a *pramāṇa-anugrahaka* - an auxiliary: by assuming the contradictory of a proposed relation and exhibiting an unacceptable consequence (*aniṣṭa-prasaṅga*), it removes the doubt that would otherwise block the grasp of *vyāpti*.
- D. A fifth *pramāṇa* alongside perception, inference, comparison and testimony.

Answer: C. Not a pramāṇa at all but a pramāṇa-anugrahaka - an auxiliary: by assuming the contradictory of a proposed relation and exhibiting an unacceptable consequence (aniṣṭa-prasaṅga), it removes the doubt that would otherwise block the grasp of vyāpti.

Explanation: Nyāya expressly refuses *tarka* independent *pramāṇa* status while assigning it a decisive doubt-removing role; the authored Nyāya file lists it among the means of establishing *vyāpti* alongside repeated observation and *upādhi*-elimination. D promotes it wrongly; A describes *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*; B confuses a supportive method with a formal fallacy.

MEMORY: **Trap:** *tarka* proves nothing by itself - say so, and the answer sounds like Nyāya rather than like a summary of Nyāya.

19. Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa

How does Nyāya answer the Cārvāka objection that "smokeness" cannot be perceived because not all smokes are perceived?

- A. By conceding the point and grounding *vyāpti* in scripture instead.

- B. Through **sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**, an extraordinary perception in which the universal itself is presented *through* any perceived particular - so the universal is not reached by adding up instances, and it is an error to say that Nyāya denies the perception of universals.
- C. By denying that universals exist.
- D. By arguing that "smokeness" is a mere name with no cognitive content.

Answer: B. Through sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa, an extraordinary perception in which the universal itself is presented through any perceived particular - so the universal is not reached by adding up instances, and it is an error to say that Nyāya denies the perception of universals.

Explanation: The authored Nyāya file lists as a standard trap the claim "that universals are not perceived. Nyāya allows their perception through **sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**." A abandons Nyāya's insistence that inference is *independent* of testimony; C and D are nominalist positions Nyāya explicitly rejects.

MEMORY: Trap: the device works only inside Nyāya's realism about universals - say so, and your evaluation looks balanced rather than partisan.

20. Parāmarśa

Why does the concept of *parāmarśa* undercut the Cārvāka's description of inference as "a leap in the dark"?

- A. Because *parāmarśa* is the elimination of all *upādhis* prior to inferring.
- B. Because *parāmarśa* is a second perception that confirms the first.
- C. Because *parāmarśa* is the operative cognition (*karaṇa*) of *anumiti* - the apprehension of the mark **as qualified by** its invariable concomitance ("this hill has smoke which is invariably accompanied by fire") - so the conclusion arises from a single complex cognition and there is no moment at which the mind is stranded between premises with a gap to cross.
- D. Because *parāmarśa* is a scriptural warrant for the inference.

Answer: C. Because parāmarśa is the operative cognition (karaṇa) of anumiti - the apprehension of the mark as qualified by its invariable concomitance ("this hill has smoke which is invariably accompanied by fire") - so the conclusion arises from a single complex cognition and there is no moment at which the mind is stranded between premises with a gap to cross.

Explanation: For Nyāya the inferential cognition is generated by *parāmarśa*, not by a psychological jump from one perception to an absent object. B, D and A misdescribe the concept - respectively as a further perception, a scriptural licence, and a stage of *vyāpti*-formation.

MEMORY: Trap: the memorable contrast - for Cārvāka a jump in the dark, for Nyāya a step taken in the light of a concomitance already grasped.

21. Four elements, not five

Which statement about Cārvāka cosmology is correct?

- A. Cārvāka admits five elements but denies that they are eternal.
- B. Cārvāka admits *ākāśa* but denies that sound is its quality.
- C. Cārvāka admits earth, water, fire and air, and rejects *ākāśa* because it is not perceived but only inferred - from sound to an imperceptible substrate - and inference is not a *pramāṇa*.
- D. Cārvāka admits only earth and water, treating fire and air as their modifications.

Answer: C. Cārvāka admits earth, water, fire and air, and rejects ākāśa because it is not perceived but only inferred - from sound to an imperceptible substrate - and inference is not a pramāṇa.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: the Cārvākas "reject ether, because its existence cannot be perceived; it has to be inferred." Sharma states the same. A contradicts Sharma's further point that "the elements are **eternal**, but their combinations undergo production and dissolution". B and D have no textual basis.

MEMORY: **Trap:** "five elements" is the single most examined factual error in this syllabus item.

22. Eternity and combination

What is the correct Cārvāka position on the permanence of the elements and of the things composed from them?

- A. The elements are **eternal**, while their combinations "undergo production and dissolution" - so Cārvāka is a realist materialism with a stable substrate, not a doctrine of universal flux; living bodies are combinations that are "reduced on death" to the elements.
- B. The elements are eternal and their combinations are equally eternal, so nothing ever perishes.
- C. Both the elements and their combinations are momentary.
- D. The elements are produced by God and are therefore contingent.

Answer: A. The elements are eternal, while their combinations "undergo production and dissolution" - so Cārvāka is a realist materialism with a stable substrate, not a doctrine of universal flux; living bodies are combinations that are "reduced on death" to the elements.

Explanation: Sharma states the doctrine exactly, and Chatterjee and Datta supply the biological corollary that living organisms are composed of the four elements, "by the combination of which they are produced and to which they are reduced on death." C imports Buddhist momentariness; D imports a creator the school denies; B contradicts the observed dissolution of bodies.

MEMORY: **Trap:** this is what makes Cārvāka a **realist** materialism and sharpens its contrast with Buddhist *kṣaṇikavāda*.

23. Two analogies, two objections

The betel analogy and the fermentation analogy both support *bhūta-caitanya-vāda*. What distinct work does each do?

- A. Both answer the same objection, that consciousness cannot be perceived.
- B. The betel analogy is Nyāya's and the fermentation analogy Cārvāka's.
- C. The **betel** analogy answers the objection that consciousness is present in none of the elements taken separately, by showing that a combination of different ingredients - leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red" - may exhibit a property absent from each; the **fermentation** analogy answers the objection that the elements are unchanged before and after, by showing that "even the same thing placed under a different condition may develop qualities originally absent", as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting.
- D. The betel analogy establishes that consciousness is a colour and the fermentation analogy that it is a power.

Answer: C. The betel analogy answers the objection that consciousness is present in none of the elements taken separately, by showing that a combination of different ingredients - leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red" - may exhibit a property absent from each; the fermentation analogy answers the objection that the elements are unchanged before and after, by showing that "even the same thing placed under a different condition may develop qualities originally absent", as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the two cases with exactly this division of labour - compositional emergence and transformational emergence. B misattributes both; indeed the fermentation case appears in the transmitted *Bṛhaspati sūtra kiṇvādhībhya madaśaktivad vijñānam*. A collapses two distinct arguments; D is a category confusion.

MEMORY: **Trap:** present them as **two** analogies answering **two** objections, not as one illustration repeated.

24. Pot, potter and svabhāva

An objector argues that a jar requires not only clay (material cause) but a potter (efficient cause), so the four elements need God as the world's shaper. What is the Cārvāka reply, and what labels does it earn?

- A. That the analogy fails because jars are perceived and the world is not.
- B. That the elements are shaped by *adṛṣṭa* rather than by God.

C. That "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", by whose inherent natures and laws they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God" and "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design" - earning the labels **naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*)**, **mechanism (*yadṛcchāvāda*)** and, in the textbook's own words, **positivism**, "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena".

D. That God exists but is the material rather than the efficient cause.

Answer: C. That "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", by whose inherent natures and laws they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God" and "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design" - earning the labels naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*), mechanism (*yadṛcchāvāda*) and, in the textbook's own words, positivism, "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena".

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the exchange and then supply all three labels in the same passage. B retains *adṛṣṭa*, which the school explicitly rejects as an unperceived law. D is Vedāntic, not Cārvāka. A is not the reply given, and would concede the design question.

MEMORY: Trap: note the internal tension worth flagging in an answer - *svabhāvavāda* grounds regularity in fixed natures, while *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".

25. The formula of *dehātmavāda*

What does *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ* assert, and what does it not assert?

A. It asserts that consciousness is a fifth element.

B. It asserts that the body is an instrument used by the self.

C. It asserts that the self is the *manas* rather than the gross body.

D. It asserts that the person **is** the body **qualified by consciousness** - that is, the living, conscious body, identical with the self, not merely correlated with it; it does **not** assert that the self is a corpse, that there is no self at all, or that consciousness is identical with any single element.

Answer: D. It asserts that the person is the body qualified by consciousness - that is, the living, conscious body, identical with the self, not merely correlated with it; it does not assert that the self is a corpse, that there is no self at all, or that consciousness is identical with any single element.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta render the Cārvāka position as "this conscious living body (*caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā*)". A contradicts the four-element doctrine. B is Sharma's *objection* - that the body is "a mere instrument for the manifestation of consciousness" - not the Cārvāka thesis. C names one of Sadānanda's four materialist variants recorded in the *Vedāntasāra*, not the mainstream formula.

MEMORY: Trap: every word of the formula is load-bearing; "qualified by consciousness" is what makes a body a **self**.

26. The argument from first-person statements

What is the logical force of the Cārvāka appeal to judgements like "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind"?

A. That the soul possesses bodily attributes by inherence.

B. That such statements are figurative and therefore prove nothing.

C. That bodily predicates are attached directly to "I" in ordinary self-ascription, which is intelligible only if the subject and the bearer of the predicate are the same thing; were the "I" an immaterial soul, these would be **meaningless** category mistakes - so the burden falls on the dualist to explain why ordinary self-description runs this way.

D. That the body is the object of self-knowledge but not its subject.

Answer: C. That bodily predicates are attached directly to "I" in ordinary self-ascription, which is intelligible only if the subject and the bearer of the predicate are the same thing; were the "I" an immaterial soul, these would be meaningless category mistakes - so the burden falls on the dualist to explain why ordinary self-description runs this way.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: "we have direct evidence of the identity of the self with the body in our daily experiences and judgments like, 'I am fat,' 'I am lame,' 'I am blind'. If the 'I', the self, were different from the body, **these would be meaningless.**" B is the dualist's *reply*, not the argument. D and A concede the dualist framework the argument is designed to challenge.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the argument shifts the burden; it does not by itself prove materialism, and saying so improves the answer.

27. Sharma's objection battery

Which pair of objections, taken together, shows that the Cārvāka's evidence establishes only **dependence** of consciousness on the body rather than **production** by it?

- A. That the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost, and that Jayarāśi attacks perception.
- B. That consciousness is private, and that the Vedas are authorless.
- C. That animals lack rational consciousness, and that the elements are eternal.
- D. That in swoons, fits, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body is seen **without** consciousness while in dreams consciousness is seen without the living body; and that mere co-existence is not causation - "the eye cannot see in darkness. Sight is not possible without light, yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", just as "the two horns of a bull which are always found together cannot be regarded as causally related" - so "the body is a mere **instrument** for the manifestation of consciousness and cannot be regarded as its cause".

Answer: D. That in swoons, fits, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body is seen without consciousness while in dreams consciousness is seen without the living body; and that mere co-existence is not causation - "the eye cannot see in darkness. Sight is not possible without light, yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", just as "the two horns of a bull which are always found together cannot be regarded as causally related" - so "the body is a mere instrument for the manifestation of consciousness and cannot be regarded as its cause".

Explanation: Sharma advances precisely this pair, and their joint effect is to sever the inference from constant co-occurrence to causation. B pairs a genuine objection with an irrelevant Mīmāṃsā doctrine. C pairs a weaker objection with a doctrine that is not an objection at all. A concerns sources, not the mind-body question.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the honest verdict is that both sides argue from the same evidence to different best explanations - say so rather than declaring a winner.

28. Cārvāka versus Buddhist denial of self

Which statement differentiates the two denials of *ātman* most precisely?

- A. Cārvāka accepts rebirth without a soul; Buddhism denies rebirth.
- B. Both deny the self for identical reasons, differing only in vocabulary.
- C. Cārvāka denies the self on soteriological grounds, Buddhism on epistemological grounds.
- D. Cārvāka denies the self's **transcendence** while retaining a substantial bearer - the living body - on **epistemic** grounds, and terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism denies **substantiality** as such on **ontological and soteriological** grounds (*pratītyasamutpāda*, *kṣaṇikavāda*, and the claim that self-belief breeds craving), replacing the bearer with the *santāna* so that karma, rebirth and *nirvāṇa* are preserved - and since *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*, this analysis rules out the Cārvāka body-self by name.

Answer: D. Cārvāka denies the self's transcendence while retaining a substantial bearer - the living body - on epistemic grounds, and terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism denies substantiality as such on ontological and soteriological grounds (pratītyasamutpāda, kṣaṇikavāda, and the claim that self-belief breeds craving), replacing the bearer with the santāna so that karma, rebirth and nirvāṇa are preserved - and since rūpa is itself one of the five skandhas, this analysis rules out the Cārvāka body-self by name.

Explanation: The authored Buddhism file states that Cārvāka "denies self beyond body and tends toward materialist reduction" while Buddhism "denies permanent self but does not reduce personhood simply to gross body", concluding

that "both reject an eternal *ātman*, but for very different reasons and with very different moral-metaphysical consequences." C reverses the grounds; A inverts both positions on rebirth; B is the error the 2024 question was set to detect.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the one-line formula - Cārvāka **relocates** the self, Buddhism **dissolves** it.

29. *Adṛṣṭa* and transmigration

Why is *adṛṣṭa* the ideal test case for the Cārvāka's epistemic principle, and what does its rejection entail?

- A. Because *adṛṣṭa* is by definition "the unseen" - an entity whose very name announces its imperceptibility - so an epistemology admitting only perception must refuse it; and with it falls the carrier of moral desert across time, which is one of the four things transmigration requires, alongside a self distinct from the body, that self's survival after death, and knowledge that any of these obtains.
- B. Because *adṛṣṭa* is another name for *svabhāva*.
- C. Because *adṛṣṭa* is accepted only by the Jainas.
- D. Because *adṛṣṭa* is a perceptible quality of the soul.

Answer: A. Because *adṛṣṭa* is by definition "the unseen" - an entity whose very name announces its imperceptibility - so an epistemology admitting only perception must refuse it; and with it falls the carrier of moral desert across time, which is one of the four things transmigration requires, alongside a self distinct from the body, that self's survival after death, and knowledge that any of these obtains.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta name it among the casualties: "God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and **any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*)** cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception." C is false - *adṛṣṭa* is a Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā device. D contradicts its definition. B confuses an unseen moral potency with an inherent natural disposition, which is the very substitution the Cārvāka makes *against* it.

MEMORY: **Trap:** *svabhāva* is what the Cārvāka puts **in place of *adṛṣṭa***, not a synonym for it.

30. *Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*

What is the correct reading of the transmitted *sūtra* "death alone is liberation"?

- A. A *reductio* of the very concept of *mokṣa*: if liberation means the soul's freedom from bodily bondage it is "absurd because there is no soul", and if it means a state free from all pain in this life it is "an impossible ideal", since embodiment "is bound up with pleasure as well as pain" - so the only state satisfying the definition is death, "and no wise man would willingly work for that end".
- B. A recommendation of suicide as the highest human end.
- C. The Jaina doctrine that liberation is attained at the moment of bodily death.
- D. A ritual prescription for the moment of death.

Answer: A. A *reductio* of the very concept of *mokṣa*: if liberation means the soul's freedom from bodily bondage it is "absurd because there is no soul", and if it means a state free from all pain in this life it is "an impossible ideal", since embodiment "is bound up with pleasure as well as pain" - so the only state satisfying the definition is death, "and no wise man would willingly work for that end".

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta set out both horns and the residue, adding the decisive clause that no wise man would work for such an end - which by itself refutes B. C attributes a soul the school denies. D restores the ritual efficacy the school rejects.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the verse attacks the **coherence of the goal**, not the value of life.

31. Ethics and the two Cārvākas

Which statement about Cārvāka ethics is accurate on the textbooks' own evidence?

- A. All Cārvākas were gross sensualists, and no source suggests otherwise.

B. *Kāma* is the ultimate end and *artha* only its **means**, while *dharma* is rejected because "virtue and vice are distinctions made by the **scriptures**, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted" and *mokṣa* because it is obtainable only by death; and the sources distinguish **dhūrta** (cunning) from **suśikṣita** (cultured) Cārvākas, with the sixty-four fine arts, the incorporation of *daṇḍanīti* and *vārttā*, the report that some regarded the **king as God**, and Vātsyāyana's disciplined hedonism as evidence of the refined strand.

C. Cārvāka accepts *dharma* and *artha* while rejecting *kāma* and *mokṣa*.

D. Cārvāka ethics is deontological, grounding duty in the fixed natures of things.

Answer: B. *Kāma* is the ultimate end and *artha* only its means, while *dharma* is rejected because "virtue and vice are distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted" and *mokṣa* because it is obtainable only by death; and the sources distinguish *dhūrta* (cunning) from *suśikṣita* (cultured) Cārvākas, with the sixty-four fine arts, the incorporation of *daṇḍanīti* and *vārttā*, the report that some regarded the king as God, and Vātsyāyana's disciplined hedonism as evidence of the refined strand.

Explanation: Every clause is from Chatterjee and Datta, who add that "egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline" and that the *dhūrta* / *suśikṣita* distinction "makes it likely that the Cārvākas were not all of the same gross, uncultured type." A ignores that distinction. C inverts the verdict on all four *puruṣārthas*. D is incompatible with a hedonistic value theory.

MEMORY: **Trap:** *dharma* is rejected on **epistemic** grounds - it is a scriptural category - not because pleasure is more agreeable.

32. The positivism verdict

Which is the most defensible verdict on whether Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic?

A. Straightforwardly yes, since both admit only observable phenomena.

B. Straightforwardly no, since positivism is a nineteenth-century European movement and cross-traditional comparison is illegitimate.

C. Positivistic in **spirit** - an empiricist criterion, an anti-metaphysical temper, suspicion of unverifiable authority, and even a quasi-verificationist register in which questions about rebirth become "meaningless", a resemblance the standard textbook itself endorses by calling the theory "positivism ... because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" - but **not** in **method**, since positivism is built on the inference Cārvāka denies *pramāṇa*-status and possesses a constructive programme, formal tools and (in Comte) a philosophy of history that Cārvāka wholly lacks. The safer labels are **radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism**.

D. Yes, because Comte's law of three stages is anticipated in the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*.

Answer: C. Positivistic in spirit - an empiricist criterion, an anti-metaphysical temper, suspicion of unverifiable authority, and even a quasi-verificationist register in which questions about rebirth become "meaningless", a resemblance the standard textbook itself endorses by calling the theory "positivism ... because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" - but not in method, since positivism is built on the inference Cārvāka denies *pramāṇa*-status and possesses a constructive programme, formal tools and (in Comte) a philosophy of history that Cārvāka wholly lacks. The safer labels are radical empiricism or naturalistic materialism.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta both apply the label and supply the material that qualifies it, since they also record the wholesale denial of inference and compare the Cārvāka view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". A ignores the methodological chasm; B refuses a comparison the tradition of exposition has itself made; D invents a claim about a lost text.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the decisive paradox - Cārvāka reaches a **materialist** conclusion by an **anti-inferential** route, whereas modern materialism reaches it by a thoroughly inferential one.

33. Which statement best captures Cārvāka's criticism of Vedic ritual without reducing it to mere abuse?

A. Every ritual is false because fire cannot transform material objects.

- B. Ritual is rejected only because it causes physical pain.
- C. Cārvāka accepts ritual when performed without priests.
- D. The decisive criticism is epistemic: ritual promises an unseen result through Vedic testimony, but neither the authority of the text nor the link between sacrifice and heaven is perceptually established; the social polemic against priests is secondary.

Answer: D. The decisive criticism is epistemic: ritual promises an unseen result through Vedic testimony, but neither the authority of the text nor the link between sacrifice and heaven is perceptually established; the social polemic against priests is secondary.

Explanation: The school first rejects *śabda* as an independent *pramāṇa* and then refuses the unseen causal bridge from an observable offering to *svarga* or merit. Doxographical ridicule can illustrate this derivation, but treating ridicule as the argument would confuse rhetoric with epistemology.

34. Which comparison between Cārvāka and Jainism is accurate?

- A. Cārvāka admits four perceptible *bhūtas*, whereas Jainism admits six *dravyas* and defines reality through origination, decay and persistence; Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* are media of motion and rest, not moral merit and demerit.
- B. Both admit six substances but disagree about their qualities.
- C. Cārvāka accepts *ākāśa*, while Jainism rejects it.
- D. Both identify consciousness as an accidental product of matter.

Answer: A. Cārvāka admits four perceptible *bhūtas*, whereas Jainism admits six *dravyas* and defines reality through origination, decay and persistence; Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* are media of motion and rest, not moral merit and demerit.

Explanation: This answer combines ontology, the Jaina formula *utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya*, and a classic factual trap. Jainism accepts *ākāśa* and treats consciousness as the inseparable nature of *jīva*; Cārvāka rejects both claims as inference-dependent.

35. A question asks whether Cārvāka is "positivistic." Which answer strategy best obeys the directive?

- A. Narrate Comte's law of three stages and mention Cārvāka in the conclusion.
- B. Give a graded verdict: positivistic in anti-metaphysical and experience-oriented spirit, but not in scientific method because positivism relies on disciplined inference; prefer "radical empiricism" or "naturalistic materialism."
- C. Reject the comparison because Western categories may never be used in Indian philosophy.
- D. Answer yes because both deny God.

Answer: B. Give a graded verdict: positivistic in anti-metaphysical and experience-oriented spirit, but not in scientific method because positivism relies on disciplined inference; prefer "radical empiricism" or "naturalistic materialism."

Explanation: The directive asks for reasons and justification, so a binary label is insufficient. The decisive disanalogy is not atheism but inference: scientific positivism preserves theoretical and inductive reasoning that the strong Cārvāka thesis denies *pramāṇa*-status.

36. Which statement about Cārvāka ethics is the safest examiner-grade formulation?

- A. It privileges this-worldly *kāma* and the material means of *artha* after rejecting scripture-dependent *dharma* and post-mortem *mokṣa*, but a strong reconstruction allows prudence, deferred gratification and social consequences rather than crude self-destruction.
- B. It commands indiscriminate sensual indulgence regardless of consequences.
- C. It rejects *artha* because wealth delays pleasure.
- D. It accepts *dharma* as social convention while rejecting only *mokṣa*.

Answer: A. It privileges this-worldly kāma and the material means of artha after rejecting scripture-dependent dharma and post-mortem mokṣa, but a strong reconstruction allows prudence, deferred gratification and social consequences rather than crude self-destruction.

Explanation: Cārvāka ethics follows from its finite embodied horizon, not from a command to act irrationally. Hostile doxography may exaggerate gross hedonism; the philosophically defensible version is prudential, though still thin on independent duties to others.

37. What is the most defensible relation between Cārvāka's strong and soft readings of inference?

- A. The strong reading accepts scientific inference, while the soft reading rejects it.
- B. The strong reading denies *anumāna* independent *pramāṇa*-status because *vyāpti* lacks certainty; the soft reading permits corrigible, perception-bound practical expectation while refusing inference to establish supersensible entities.
- C. Both readings claim every inference is false.
- D. The soft reading is Jayarāṣi's claim that perception alone is infallible.

Answer: B. The strong reading denies anumāna independent pramāṇa-status because vyāpti lacks certainty; the soft reading permits corrigible, perception-bound practical expectation while refusing inference to establish supersensible entities.

Explanation: The distinction separates *pramāṇa*-status from ordinary action. It avoids the factual error that Cārvākas never form expectations, but its cost is doctrinal shrinkage: once useful inference is admitted, the disagreement with Nyāya increasingly concerns certainty and transcendental reach.

38. Which statement correctly distinguishes Cārvāka's body-self from Buddhist no-self?

- A. Both identify the person exclusively with *rūpa*.
- B. Buddhism rejects karma and rebirth because it rejects *ātman*.
- C. Cārvāka relocates selfhood into the conscious body, while Buddhism denies selfhood to body and mind alike by analysing the person into five conditioned *skandhas* and preserving continuity through a causal stream rather than a substance.
- D. Cārvāka accepts a mental stream after bodily death.

Answer: C. Cārvāka relocates selfhood into the conscious body, while Buddhism denies selfhood to body and mind alike by analysing the person into five conditioned skandhas and preserving continuity through a causal stream rather than a substance.

Explanation: *Rūpa* is itself only one *skandha*, so Buddhism rejects the Cārvāka body-self as well as an immaterial soul. Their aftermaths diverge: Cārvāka ends karma and rebirth at death, whereas Buddhism retains both without a permanent owner.

39. In a 2020 answer on ākāśa and transmigration, which organizing thesis is strongest?

- A. The two topics are unrelated and should be answered as separate notes.
- B. Both are applications of one epistemic restriction: *ākāśa* is an inferred substrate and transmigration requires an unperceived surviving self, karmic carrier and post-mortem process; therefore both denials are as strong and as vulnerable as the rejection of inference.
- C. The rejection of *ākāśa* is scientific, while rejection of transmigration is ethical.
- D. Cārvāka rejects *ākāśa* but accepts a transmigrating material soul.

Answer: B. Both are applications of one epistemic restriction: ākāśa is an inferred substrate and transmigration requires an unperceived surviving self, karmic carrier and post-mortem process; therefore both denials are as strong and as vulnerable as the rejection of inference.

Explanation: This thesis obeys both directives while supplying unity. A high-scoring answer still evaluates each half separately, especially the slide from "not established" to "unreal" and the distinction between bodily dependence and production of consciousness.

40. Which source-attribution sentence is methodologically sound?

- A. "On the standard reconstruction derived from convergent but largely hostile witnesses, Cārvāka affirms perceptualism and materialism; the lost *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*, internal diversity and Jayarāṣi's contested affiliation require caution about quotations and uniformity."
- B. "The extant *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* definitively proves that every Cārvāka accepted crude hedonism."
- C. "Jayarāṣi's scepticism is the official and uniform doctrine of all Lokāyatas."
- D. "Because the sources are hostile, no Cārvāka doctrine can be reconstructed."

Answer: A. "On the standard reconstruction derived from convergent but largely hostile witnesses, Cārvāka affirms perceptualism and materialism; the lost *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*, internal diversity and Jayarāṣi's contested affiliation require caution about quotations and uniformity."

Explanation: Responsible reconstruction avoids both credulity and despair. Convergence supports a doctrinal core, while source loss prevents fabricated quotations or claims that one surviving sceptical text straightforwardly represents the standard school.

REMEDIAL DIAGNOSTIC MCQS

Questions 41-48 repair recurrent factual, attribution and directive errors. The same B → C → D → A rotation continues.

41. "Denies the self" versus "denies a transcendental self"

A student writes: "Cārvāka, like Buddhism, denies the self." Which correction is required?

- A. Both deny the self identically; the difference is only terminological.
- B. Cārvāka denies the **transcendental, immaterial** self and positively affirms a **material** one - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the body qualified by consciousness - whereas Buddhism denies **substantiality** as such, including the body-self, since *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*; the two are therefore not the same denial, and Buddhist analysis refutes Cārvāka's self as decisively as it refutes Nyāya's.
- C. Buddhism denies the self only in the Mahāyāna schools.
- D. Cārvāka denies the self entirely and Buddhism affirms a permanent self.

Answer: B. Cārvāka denies the transcendental, immaterial self and positively affirms a material one - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the body qualified by consciousness - whereas Buddhism denies substantiality as such, including the body-self, since *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*; the two are therefore not the same denial, and Buddhist analysis refutes Cārvāka's self as decisively as it refutes Nyāya's.

Explanation:

42. "Rejects inference" versus "never infers"

A student writes: "According to Cārvāka nobody ever infers anything, since inference is impossible." Which correction is required?

- A. Cārvāka denies inference **as a *pramāṇa***, that is, as a truth-guaranteeing means; he explicitly concedes that "in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference" and that inference sometimes succeeds, concluding only that "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" - and his sharpest target is **transcendental** inference, which no perception could ever check.
- B. Cārvāka rejects inference only when it is used by Naiyāyikas.
- C. Cārvāka accepts inference as a *pramāṇa* in worldly matters and rejects it only in scripture.
- D. Cārvāka rejects perception as well, following Jayarāṣi.

Answer: A. Cārvāka denies inference as a *pramāṇa*, that is, as a truth-guaranteeing means; he explicitly concedes that "in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference" and that inference sometimes succeeds, concluding only that "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a

separable one" - and his sharpest target is transcendental inference, which no perception could ever check.

Explanation:

43. Svabhāva versus adrṣṭa

A student writes: "Cārvāka explains the world's regularity by *adrṣṭa*, the inherent unseen power of things." Which correction is required?

- A. *Adrṣṭa* is a Cārvāka term meaning the fixed nature of the elements.
- B. **Adrṣṭa** is the **unseen moral potency** of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā that links an act to a later fruit, and Cārvāka rejects it by name - Chatterjee and Datta list "any unperceived law (like *adrṣṭa*)" among the casualties; what Cārvāka puts **in its place** is **svabhāva**, the inherent natural disposition of the elements, which explains regularity without moral bookkeeping.
- C. Cārvāka accepts *adrṣṭa* but denies *karma*.
- D. Both terms are synonyms in classical Indian philosophy.

Answer: B. Adrṣṭa is the unseen moral potency of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā that links an act to a later fruit, and Cārvāka rejects it by name - Chatterjee and Datta list "any unperceived law (like adrṣṭa)" among the casualties; what Cārvāka puts in its place is svabhāva, the inherent natural disposition of the elements, which explains regularity without moral bookkeeping.

Explanation:

44. Upādhi versus incomplete enumeration

A student writes: "The *upādhi* objection is simply the point that we have not observed enough cases." Which correction is required?

- A. *Upādhi* applies only to inferences about the future.
- B. *Upādhi* is the Nyāya name for the middle term.
- C. *Upādhi* means a defect in the form of the syllogism.
- D. Incomplete enumeration is a defect of **sample size**, curable in principle by further observation; the **upādhi** objection is that even exhaustively observed regularity may track an **unnoticed condition**, so that what remains uncertified is the **identification of the relevant ground** of the relation - Chatterjee and Datta: "unconditionality ... cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may **always remain hidden and escape notice**." This is why Nyāya must introduce *tarka* rather than merely more observation.

Answer: D. Incomplete enumeration is a defect of sample size, curable in principle by further observation; the upādhi objection is that even exhaustively observed regularity may track an unnoticed condition, so that what remains uncertified is the identification of the relevant ground of the relation - Chatterjee and Datta: "unconditionality ... cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden and escape notice." This is why Nyāya must introduce tarka rather than merely more observation.

Explanation:

45. Naturalism, mechanism and positivism

A student writes: "Cārvāka's *svabhāvavāda* is a scientific naturalism, and therefore Cārvāka is a positivist." Which correction is required?

- A. *Svabhāvavāda* is a Sāṃkhya doctrine, not a Cārvāka one.
- B. Cārvāka has no explanatory principle at all.
- C. *Svabhāvavāda* is a **metaphysical refusal of teleology**, not an experimental programme; the textbook applies three distinct labels - naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*), mechanism (*yadrucchāvāda*, which denies conscious purpose and treats the world as a fortuitous combination) and positivism ("because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena") - and the positivism label must in any case be qualified, since positivism runs on the very inference Cārvāka denies. Note also the internal tension between grounding regularity in fixed **natures** and calling the world's

objects **fortuitous**.

D. *Yadṛcchāvāda* means "the doctrine of divine will".

Answer: C. Svabhāvavāda is a metaphysical refusal of teleology, not an experimental programme; the textbook applies three distinct labels - naturalism (svabhāvavāda), mechanism (yadṛcchāvāda, which denies conscious purpose and treats the world as a fortuitous combination) and positivism ("because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena") - and the positivism label must in any case be qualified, since positivism runs on the very inference Cārvāka denies. Note also the internal tension between grounding regularity in fixed natures and calling the world's objects fortuitous.

Explanation:

46. What survives of the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*

A student writes: "As *Bṛhaspati* says in his *Sūtra*, earth, water, fire and air are the elements." Which correction is required?

- A. The ***Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost**; about a **dozen** *sūtras* and verses survive only as **quotations in other authors' works**, so the correct form is "as transmitted in the *sūtra* quoted by later authors" or "on the standard reconstruction" - the content of *prthivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* is well attested, but its textual status is not that of an available primary source.
- B. The *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives complete and may be quoted directly.
- C. The *sūtra* is genuine but was composed by Cārvāka rather than *Bṛhaspati*.
- D. The *sūtra* is preserved inside the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha*.

Answer: A. The *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost; about a dozen *sūtras* and verses survive only as quotations in other authors' works, so the correct form is "as transmitted in the *sūtra* quoted by later authors" or "on the standard reconstruction" - the content of *prthivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* is well attested, but its textual status is not that of an available primary source.

Explanation:

47. The "ghee and debt" verse

A student opens an answer: "The Cārvāka scripture says: let a man live happily and feed on ghee even though he runs in debt." Which correction is required?

- A. The verse is preserved in the **Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha**, Mādhava's fourteenth-century Vedāntic compendium - an **opponent's** summary written for refutation - and is not attributable to any surviving primary Cārvāka text; it should be presented as a **doxographical characterisation** of the school's spirit, and its buried argument (that deferral is irrational under a finite horizon) should be extracted rather than the slogan repeated.
- B. The verse comes from the *Sāmaññaphala-sutta*.
- C. The verse is quoted from Vātsyāyana's *Kāma-sūtra*.
- D. The verse is a Jain parody with no relation to Cārvāka.

Answer: A. The verse is preserved in the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha, Mādhava's fourteenth-century Vedāntic compendium - an opponent's summary written for refutation - and is not attributable to any surviving primary Cārvāka text; it should be presented as a doxographical characterisation of the school's spirit, and its buried argument (that deferral is irrational under a finite horizon) should be extracted rather than the slogan repeated.

Explanation:

48. Jayarāśi and the standard Cārvāka

A student writes: "Since Jayarāśi shows that perception too is unreliable, the Cārvākas rejected all *pramāṇas*." Which correction is required?

- A. Jayarāśi was not a Cārvāka at all but a Buddhist.
- B. Jayarāśi accepts the four elements and differs from the standard Cārvāka only on ethics.

C. Jayarāṣi's work is lost and cannot be assessed.

D. Jayarāṣi is described as a Cārvāka "of an **extreme type**" who "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of **perceptual** knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements" - so his position is the tradition's internal **limit-case**, not its standard doctrine; the defining Cārvāka thesis remains that perception **alone** is a *pramāṇa*, and using Jayarāṣi to state it destroys it.

Answer: D. Jayarāṣi is described as a Cārvāka "of an extreme type" who "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of perceptual knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements" - so his position is the tradition's internal limit-case, not its standard doctrine; the defining Cārvāka thesis remains that perception alone is a pramāṇa, and using Jayarāṣi to state it destroys it.

Explanation:

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

- 9 COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

2018 · Q8(b) · 15 marks

Question: Is Cārvāka rejection of inference acceptable to the other systems of Indian philosophy? If not, why? Do you think the views of other systems to be justified? Give reasons for your answer.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāṣi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three-limbed: a factual survey, an explanatory account, and an evaluative judgement in the candidate's own voice
Limb 1	Is it accepted? - a cross-school survey; the answer is overwhelmingly no
Limb 2	If not, why not? - the <i>reasons</i> , school by school, not a single generic reason
Limb 3	Are they justified? - the candidate's graded verdict, with reasons
Scope boundary	Stay on inference ; do not drift into Cārvāka ethics or the ritual polemic
Ideal thesis	The other systems are justified against the strong thesis, but the Cārvāka's residual point - that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal - survives, and Nyāya concedes it by shifting from certainty to warrant
Non-negotiables	<i>Vyāpti</i> ; the three doors; <i>upādhi</i> ; at least three named schools with their distinct reasons; the self-refutation charge; a criterion-named verdict

Independent model answer

The Cārvāka holds that *anumāna* is not a *pramāṇa*, because *vyāpti* cannot be secured: not by perception, since all cases past, present and future are never surveyed; not by inference, which yields a *petitio principii*; and not by testimony, whose own validity is inferred - and which, if it grounded inference, would mean "no one could infer anything by himself". *Upādhi* deepens this: the wet-fuel condition shows that unconditionality can never be perceptually certified.

No system accepts this. Nyāya replies that *vyāpti* is built by *anvaya-vyatireka*, elimination of suspected *upādhis*, *tarka* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*, and that *parāmarśa* - the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance - means no "leap" occurs. Sāṃkhya must reject it, since *prakṛti* and *puruṣa* are established only inferentially. Mīmāṃsā must, since injunction and *apūrva* presuppose it. Buddhism, through Dignāga and Dharmakīrti, constructs an entire logic, and the *Tattvasaṅgraha* attacks Cārvāka's naïve perceptualism directly. Jainism needs inference for *matī* and *śruta*.

Advaita alone partly agrees, but denies **ultimate** validity to perception as well - a level-distinction, as Sharma observes, "unknown to the Cārvāka".

Are they justified? Largely yes. The universal denial of inference is itself a universal; other minds and ideas are never perceived; Sharma is right that "the Cārvāka can understand others only through inference".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: they are justified against the strong thesis but not entitled to complacency, since Nyāya answers only by replacing omniscient certainty with disciplined warrant - a substitution that concedes the Cārvāka's logical point while denying his epistemological conclusion.

Depth refinement. The dispute is therefore not between reason and anti-reason. It concerns whether *pramāṇa* means indefeasible truth or responsibly corrigible warrant. Nyāya is strongest by the latter criterion; Cārvāka survives as a challenge to unrestricted universals.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** state the Cārvāka thesis with its argument -> survey the schools with **distinct** reasons -> the self-refutation charge -> the candidate's graded verdict. All three limbs must be visibly answered.
- **Doctrine:** *vyāpti*, *upādhi*, *petitio principii*, *anvaya-vyatireka*, *tarka*, *parāmarśa*, *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must appear as three, not as a vague "cannot be proved".
- **Distinction:** rejection of inference as *pramāṇa* versus rejection of practical inference - flag it, or the answer looks naïve.
- **Comparison:** at least four schools with school-specific reasons. A generic "all schools accept inference" earns half the marks.
- **Criticism:** self-refutation stated as steps, plus Sharma's point that thoughts and other minds are never perceived.

2019 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

Question: Are the Cārvākas consistent when they hold that inference is not a source of knowledge? Discuss.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Discuss with an explicit verdict on consistency - a yes/no question that requires a qualified answer
Core issue	Whether the denial of inference can be stated and defended without using inference
Scope boundary	This is about internal coherence , not about whether inference is in fact valid
Ideal thesis	Inconsistent on the strong reading; consistent on the softened reading - but the softened reading is a much weaker doctrine
Non-negotiables	The charge reconstructed as steps; at least two of the three replies; the point that other minds and ideas are never perceived; a graded verdict

Independent model answer

The charge. The Cārvāka asserts that no inference is a valid source of knowledge. That assertion is a **universal**, quantifying over all inferential acts; no universal is given in any single perception. So it is either itself inferential - and self-defeating - or it fails its own standard. Sharma presses further: thoughts and ideas "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the Cārvāka "can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference".

The replies. ANALYSIS: Three are available. (i) *Vitaṇḍā*: the Cārvāka advances no thesis, only destroys the opponent's claim to certainty - but he does assert four elements and a body-self, so this cannot be global. (ii) The **softened thesis**: he denies not inference itself but its capacity to yield **apodictic certainty**, especially about the

transcendent. (iii) The **level-distinction**: concede *vyāvahārika* validity, deny the *pāramārthika* - though Sharma notes this distinction is "unknown to the Cārvāka".

ANALYSIS: **Verdict**: inconsistent as an unrestricted denial; consistent as a fallibilist warning. The Cārvāka may be **radical or consistent, but not both**.

Depth refinement. A practical concession needs an epistemic status: if successful worldly inference is knowledge, the absolute thesis contracts; if it is only expectation, Cārvāka must explain why rational action may trust what philosophy disqualifies.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure**: state the charge as numbered steps -> give the replies -> deliver the verdict. Do not narrate the *vyāpti* argument at length; the question presupposes it.
- **Doctrine**: the exact form of the thesis being tested - "no inference is a *pramāṇa*" - and its universality.
- **Argument**: the step from "universal claim" to "not perceptually given" must be explicit.
- **Distinction**: *pramāṇa*-status versus practical usability; strong versus softened formulation.
- **Technical terms**: *viṭaṇḍā*, *vyāvahārika* / *pāramārthika*, *pramāṇa*.
- **Criticism**: the other-minds point is the sharpest form of the charge and is usually omitted.

2019 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: What is wrong according to the Cārvākas with the following argument? All men are mortal. Socrates is a man. Therefore, Socrates is mortal. Justify your answer with arguments.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāṣi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Diagnose a specific argument, then justify the diagnosis - application, not recitation
Core issue	Whether the candidate attacks the right thing: the major premise , not the form
Scope boundary	Use the smoke-and-fire material only as illustration; the syllogism itself must stay in focus
Ideal thesis	The syllogism is valid but epistemically empty - it transmits a certainty in the major premise that was never independently acquired
Non-negotiables	Explicit refusal to attack validity; the major premise identified as <i>vyāpti</i> ; the three doors applied to "All men are mortal"; <i>petitio principii</i> ; <i>upādhi</i> ; one line of self-critical balance

Independent model answer

The Cārvāka objection is **not** that the argument is formally invalid. If the premises hold, the conclusion follows; the Cārvāka concedes this and attacks elsewhere.

The target is the **major premise**, "All men are mortal", which functions exactly as *vyāpti* does in Indian inference: an invariable, exceptionless concomitance between man-ness and mortality. How is such a universal known?

Not by perception. No one has perceived all men. Chatterjee and Datta press the point: we cannot perceive even all present cases, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future." Nor does relocating the relation among class-characters help: "it is not possible even to know by perception what 'smokeness' ... is, because we do not perceive all cases of smoke", and a relation between universals does not license an inference about **this** particular.

Not by inference. Establishing the universal inferentially requires a further universal - *petitio principii*, or an endless regress.

Not by testimony. Testimony's validity is itself inferred; and if inference depended on testimony, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hence, in Sharma's formulation, the syllogism is an **argument in a circle**: the conclusion "Socrates is mortal" is already contained in "All men are mortal". Deduction merely extracts what induction never established. *Upādhi* deepens the charge: perhaps what is genuinely invariable is not man-ness with mortality but organic embodiment under conditions never fully surveyed.

ANALYSIS: Verdict: the syllogism is valid but epistemically empty. The charge is a serious one about induction - though the Cārvāka must still explain how his own universal denial of inference is known.

Depth refinement. This diagnosis anticipates the problem of induction without making Cārvāka a modern empiricist. Its precise claim is not that deduction fails formally, but that deduction cannot manufacture warrant absent from its universal premise.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** disclaim the attack on validity -> identify the major premise as *vyāpti* -> run the three doors **on this premise** -> *petitio principii* -> *upādhi* -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** *vyāpti*, *sāmānya* / class-character, *upādhi*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be applied to "All men are mortal" specifically, not narrated abstractly about smoke.
- **Distinction:** validity versus soundness; deduction's circularity versus induction's insecurity, and the fact that each is cured only by the other.
- **Technical terms:** major premise as *vyāpti*; *sādhya* and *hetu*; *anumāna* and *pramāṇa*.
- **Comparison:** one line noting that Nyāya would answer with *anvaya-vyatireka*, *tarka* and *parāmarśa*.

2020 · Q6(b) · 15 marks

Question: Critically evaluate Cārvākas' rejection of Ākāśa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate and examine</i> - two tasks, both requiring two-sided assessment
Core issue	That both rejections are the same argument applied twice , once to cosmology and once to soteriology
Scope boundary	Two halves, roughly balanced; do not let <i>ākāśa</i> consume the answer
Ideal thesis	The rejections are impeccably consistent with the epistemology, and are therefore exactly as strong - and as vulnerable - as that epistemology
Non-negotiables	The Vaiśeṣika sound-to- <i>ākāśa</i> inference named and refused; the four requirements of transmigration each cut; at least two objections with replies; a criterion-named verdict

Independent model answer

Ākāśa. FACT: Most Indian schools admit five elements; Cārvāka admits four - earth, water, fire and air. The reason is exact: *ākāśa* "is not perceived but **inferred**" (Sharma). The Vaiśeṣika reaches it by argument - sound is a quality; qualities inhere in substances; sound belongs to no other admitted substance; therefore *ākāśa* exists as its substrate. Since inference is not a *pramāṇa*, that route is closed.

ANALYSIS: Critical evaluation. The rejection is consistent and economical, and it correctly identifies that *ākāśa* is a **theoretical posit**, not a datum. But it carries a cost: the Cārvāka accepts the four elements *as substances*, so he

cannot refuse the substance-quality scheme for sound alone without argument. His strongest line is therefore to naturalise sound as a modification of perceptible air - a naturalising rather than a merely sceptical move.

Transmigration. FACT: Transmigration requires (a) a self distinct from the body, (b) its survival after death, (c) a carrier of moral desert, and (d) knowledge that these obtain. Cārvāka cuts each: *dehātmavāda* makes the self the living body - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*; "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *karma* and *adrṣṭa* are unperceived; and only scripture or inference could supply the knowledge.

ANALYSIS: Examination. Strengths: consistency, economy, and the exposure of unfalsifiable postulates.

Weaknesses: Sharma shows that dependence is not production - "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; the argument slides from "unestablished" to "unreal"; and, as Sharma adds, the soul's non-existence "too cannot be demonstrated".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: one epistemic cut, applied twice - and its force is exactly the force of that cut.

Depth refinement. The burden of proof remains crucial: Cārvāka may show that the opponent has not established *ākāśa* or transmigration, but the stronger claim of non-existence needs a bridge from epistemic absence to ontological absence.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** two clearly signposted halves, each with exposition and evaluation; a unifying final sentence.
- **Doctrine:** four *bhūtas*; the Vaiśeṣika sound-substrate inference; *dehātmavāda*; *adrṣṭa*.
- **Argument:** the four requirements of transmigration, each explicitly cut.
- **Distinction:** rejecting *ākāśa* as an entity versus denying that sound is heard; "unestablished" versus "unreal".
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *bhūta*, *adrṣṭa*, *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *pramāṇa*.
- **Criticism:** at least two - the instrument objection and the unestablished/unreal slide; ideally Sharma's symmetry point too.

2020 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the differences</i> - a sustained axis-by-axis comparison, not two mini-essays
Core issue	Conceptions of reality : what exists, how it is known, and how change and persistence are accommodated
Scope boundary	Metaphysics and its epistemology; ethics only if it illuminates the ontology
Ideal thesis	The deepest difference is not materialism versus spiritualism but the number of standpoints each admits - Jainism multiplies both entities and viewpoints; Cārvāka admits one of each
Non-negotiables	<i>Pramāṇas</i> ; the definition of <i>sat</i> ; four <i>bhūtas</i> versus six <i>dravyas</i> ; <i>ākāśa</i> ; soul and consciousness; <i>anekāntavāda</i> and <i>syādvāda</i> ; karma; liberation; and the shared <i>nāstika</i> ground

Independent model answer

Epistemic root. FACT: Cārvāka admits one *pramāṇa*, *pratyakṣa*. Jainism admits a fivefold knowledge - *matī*, *śruta*, *avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya*, *kevala* - and hence inference. Every later divergence follows from this.

Definition of the real. FACT: For Jainism, *sat* is *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya* - origination, decay and persistence together; the gold that becomes bracelet and then ring persists as *dravya* while its *paryāyas* change. Cārvāka has no

such analysis: elements are eternal, combinations transient, and that is all.

Constituents. FACT: Four *bhūtas* for Cārvāka; **six dravyas** for Jainism - *jīva*, *pudgala*, *dharma*, *adharma*, *ākāśa*, *kāla*. *Ākāśa* is rejected by the Cārvāka as inferred; for Jainism it is a distinct substance providing accommodation.

Soul and consciousness. FACT: Cārvāka: no *jīva*; the self is the living body, and consciousness an emergent by-product. Jainism: infinitely many *jīvas*, with consciousness their **inseparable essence** - expressly denying, as the sources put it, the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".

Standpoint. FACT: Jainism's **anekāntavāda**, with *nayavāda* and *syādvāda*, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned. Cārvāka admits a single standpoint and no level-distinction at all.

Karma and liberation. FACT: Jainism: karma as **subtle matter** adhering to the *jīva*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*, with *mokṣa* through the three jewels and *kevala-jñāna*. Cārvāka: no karma, and *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Their agreement is instructive: both are *nāstika*, both realists about the perceptible world, both reject a creator. The divergence is over standpoints and substances - which is why Jainism can hold change and persistence together while Cārvāka can only assert them side by side.

Depth refinement. Jainism buys explanatory articulation through ontological plurality; Cārvāka buys economy through restriction. Jainism therefore wins on change-and-persistence, while Cārvāka preserves the question of evidential cost.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** named axes, each carrying both positions in the same sentence or row; then the unifying thesis; then the shared ground.
- **Doctrine:** *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*; six *dravyas*; *guṇa* and *paryāya*; *anekānta*, *naya*, *syādvāda*; four *bhūtas*.
- **Argument:** show that the metaphysical divergence is *generated* by the epistemic divergence.
- **Distinction:** Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* are **media of motion and rest**, not merit and demerit - a classic trap.
- **Technical terms:** *sat*, *dravya*, *jīva*, *pudgala*, *bhūta*, *kevala-jñāna*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*.
- **Comparison:** at least seven axes; fewer looks thin at 15 marks.

2021 · Q5(e) · 10 marks

Question: Comment on the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities by them.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Comment on the bearing</i> - the examiner wants the derivation , not two lists
Core issue	That a single epistemic premise severs every transcendent entity at once
Scope boundary	Do not narrate the <i>vyāpti</i> argument at length; compress it and spend the words on the derivation
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka ontology is the exact ontological shadow of its epistemology, so the denials are consequences and not separate acts of unbelief
Non-negotiables	The compressed epistemic argument; the bridging principle named as a presupposition; at least five entities derived; one line of evaluation

Independent model answer

For Cārvāka, ontology is the shadow cast by epistemology. Perception alone is a *pramāṇa*: *anumāna* fails because *vyāpti* is established neither by perception (all cases are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii*), nor by

testimony (whose own validity is inferred); *śabda* fails because words certify only that something was said. Chatterjee and Datta accordingly state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" this epistemological conclusion.

The **bearing** is systematic. The bridging principle - ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *pramāṇas* - is then applied without exception. *Ākāśa* falls, being inferred from sound. *Ātman* falls, never being perceived apart from the living body. *Īśvara* falls, being reached only by design-inference while *svabhāva* discharges the explanatory work. *Karma*, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *mokṣa* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states no perception could present. Vedic authority falls with *śabda*, and ritual loses its rationale with it.

ANALYSIS: **Comment:** the derivation is impeccably consistent; its cost is that the whole ontology stands or falls with the rejection of inference.

Depth refinement. The denials are not object-level duplicates: some reject theoretical substrates, some moral mechanisms, and some authoritative testimony. Their unity lies in one evidential filter rather than one identical argument.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** epistemology compressed into one paragraph -> the bridging principle -> the derivation, entity by entity -> one evaluative line.
- **Doctrine:** *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*; the bridging principle; *svabhāvavāda*.
- **Argument:** the derivation must read as a *consequence*, with connectives such as "hence", "therefore", "with it".
- **Distinction:** the bridging principle is a **presupposition**, not a theorem - an opponent could accept the epistemology and still hold that reality exceeds knowledge.
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *ātman*, *Īśvara*, *karma*, *adṛṣṭa*, *svarga*, *mokṣa*, *śabda*.
- **Comparison:** if space allows, one clause noting that Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are also non-theistic but keep *karma* and rebirth, because their epistemology admits inference.

2024 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Do you think Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	An explicit personal verdict with reasons and justifications - a graded answer, never a flat yes or no
Core issue	Whether an empiricist criterion and anti-metaphysical temper suffice for the label, given that Cārvāka rejects inference
Scope boundary	Comparative epistemology and method; do not turn it into a history of logical positivism
Ideal thesis	Positivistic in spirit , not in method ; "radical empiricism" is the safer label
Non-negotiables	The evidential point that the textbooks themselves apply the word; at least three points for and three against; the inference divergence; a named alternative label

Independent model answer

ANALYSIS: **Yes in spirit, no in method.**

The case for. FACT: The label is not imported by the examiner: Chatterjee and Datta write that the Cārvāka theory "may also be called **positivism**, because it believes only in **positive facts or observable phenomena**", and compare its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". Cārvāka restricts the knowable to what perception presents; rejects God, soul, *karma* and heaven as unwarranted; refuses scriptural authority; grounds value in this-worldly pleasure and pain; and even adopts a quasi-verificationist register, since questions about rebirth and

heaven are said to become "meaningless".

The case against. ANALYSIS: Positivism is built on **inference** - science is systematised inference - which Cārvāka denies *pramāṇa*-status. Positivism admits unobservables that earn their explanatory keep; Cārvāka refuses them. Positivism offers a constructive programme with formal and semantic tools; Cārvāka offers a polemical minimalism. Comte's law of three stages and sociology have no Indian counterpart.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** an illuminating analogy, not a historical identity. **Radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism** is the more accurate description. The paradox is that Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an **anti-inferential** route.

Depth refinement. The comparison is heuristic, not genealogical. Cārvāka resembles positivism in policing metaphysical admission but differs because its anti-inferentialism weakens the law-governed science that later positivisms elevate.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** verdict first -> case for -> case against -> refined label. A graded verdict announced early controls the whole answer.
- **Doctrine:** the textbook's own use of the word "positivism", with its stated reason - this is the strongest single evidential move available.
- **Argument:** the inference divergence must be identified as the **decisive** disanalogy, not listed among equals.
- **Distinction:** spirit versus method; empiricism versus positivism; verificationism versus mere anti-metaphysics.
- **Technical terms:** *pratyakṣa*, *anumāna*, *pramāṇa*, *svabhāvavāda*, verification, unobservables.
- **Comparison:** at least one named Western reference point - Comte or Ayer - used precisely.

2024 · Q6(a) · 20 marks

Question: Differentiate between the Cārvākas' refutation of self as a transcendental category and the Buddhist rejection of ātmā.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāṣi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Differentiate</i> - sustained contrast on named axes; separate descriptions will not do
Core issue	That two denials of <i>ātman</i> can be philosophically opposite in target, ground, aftermath and metaphysical price
Scope boundary	The self; bring in karma, rebirth and liberation only as consequences of the two denials
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves it into process. Substance retained versus substance abolished
Non-negotiables	<i>Dehātmavāda</i> with its formula; the five <i>skandhas</i> ; <i>santāna</i> ; the epistemic versus ontological-soteriological grounds; the point that <i>rūpa</i> is itself a <i>skandha</i> ; the divergent aftermaths

Independent model answer

Both schools reject the *ātman* of Nyāya and Vedānta, but the rejections are not species of one genus.

Cārvāka: relocation. FACT: The doctrine is *dehātmavāda* - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the person is the body qualified by consciousness. The **ground is epistemological**: perception alone is a *pramāṇa*, and "the non-material soul is never perceived". The positive argument is drawn from ordinary speech: we say "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind", and if the "I" were distinct from the body these would be meaningless. Consciousness is admitted, but as an **emergent by-product** of the organised elements - as the betel leaf, lime and nut together yield a redness none

possesses, and as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting. Since no self survives the body's dissolution, "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *karma*, rebirth, *svarga* and *mokṣa* all lapse, and *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

Buddhism: dissolution. FACT: *Anātman* denies not the transcendence but the **substantiality** of the self. The person is analysed into five *skandhas* - *rūpa*, *vedanā*, *saṃjñā*, *saṃskāra*, *viññāna* - with no owner behind them; "chariot" names an arrangement of parts, and so does "person". The **ground is ontological and soteriological**: *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda* leave no room for a permanent entity, and belief in a self generates craving and suffering. Continuity is preserved by *santāna*, the causal stream, with *pratisandhāna* and, in Yogācāra, *ālaya-vijñāna* bearing *bījas*. Hence karma and rebirth survive **without** a self, and *nirvāṇa* remains the goal.

ANALYSIS: **The four differentiating theses.** (i) **Targets** differ: Cārvāka substitutes a material self, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality of any kind - and since *rūpa* is itself one of the *skandhas*, Buddhist analysis refutes the Cārvāka body-self **by name**. (ii) **Grounds** differ: epistemic versus ontological-soteriological. (iii) **Aftermaths** differ: Cārvāka terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism is engineered precisely to continue it. (iv) **Prices** differ: Cārvāka must explain how matter yields subjectivity; Buddhism must explain how an ownerless stream yields memory, desert and liberation.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** Cārvāka denies the self's **transcendence** while retaining its **substantiality**; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its **moral continuity**.

Depth refinement. Both views face continuity problems of different kinds: Cārvāka must explain identity through bodily change without a separate subject; Buddhism must explain responsibility across an ownerless causal series. This symmetry prevents a one-sided comparison.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** the two positions stated compactly -> four explicit differentiating theses -> a one-line verdict. Do not write two biographies.
- **Doctrine:** *dehātmavāda* with the Sanskrit formula; the five *skandhas* named in order; *santāna*; *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda*.
- **Argument:** the "I am fat / lame / blind" argument, and the chariot analogy, both reproduced.
- **Distinction:** transcendence versus substantiality - this single distinction carries the whole answer.
- **Technical terms:** *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *anātman* / *nairātmyavāda*, *pudgala-nairātmya*, *ālaya-vijñāna*, *bīja*.
- **Criticism:** the point that *rūpa* is itself a *skandha*, so Buddhism rules out the Cārvāka self explicitly - very few candidates make it.

2025 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Explain the ground on which Cārvāka rejects inference as a valid source of knowledge.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the ground</i> - a focused, architecturally clean exposition; evaluation is secondary
Core issue	The impossibility of establishing <i>vyāpti</i>
Scope boundary	Stay on the ground for rejection; do not survey the other schools' replies at length
Ideal thesis	The ground is that <i>vyāpti</i> , without which inference cannot claim certainty, is unobtainable by any means the Cārvāka admits

Element	Requirement
Non-negotiables	<i>Vyāpti</i> defined; the three doors; <i>upādhi</i> ; the "accident and separable" line; one closing sentence of balance

Independent model answer

FACT: The ground is the **impossibility of establishing vyāpti**. Inference moves from a perceived mark to an unperceived *sādhya*, and is licensed only by an invariable concomitance - "wherever smoke, there fire". For inference to be a *pramāṇa*, that universal must be beyond doubt.

It cannot be had by perception: we cannot perceive all cases of smoke and fire even now, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future"; and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known while all instances are not perceived.

Nor by inference: that would be a *petitio principii*, since the further inference needs its own *vyāpti*.

Nor by testimony: testimony's own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on it, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Upādhi completes the case: fire yields smoke only where fuel is wet, and hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice", so unconditionality is never certified.

ANALYSIS: Hence truth is "only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" in inference - not the guaranteed character a *pramāṇa* requires.

Depth refinement. The strongest soft reading permits corrigible, perception-redeemable practical expectation. It protects ordinary life but transforms the dispute into one about certainty, scope and transcendental overreach.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** define *vyāpti* -> three doors -> *upādhi* -> the "accident and separable" conclusion. Clean, fast, complete.
- **Doctrine:** *vyāpti*, *liṅga* and *sādhya*, *upādhi*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be visibly three; a vague "it cannot be proved" earns little.
- **Distinction:** rejection as *pramāṇa* versus everyday expectation - one clause is enough, but it must be there.
- **Technical terms:** at least four Sanskrit terms, each glossed on first use.
- **Comparison:** at most one clause on Nyāya's reply; the question does not ask for it.

These six questions are original practice prompts, not UPSC PYQs. Each model is written independently for learner use.

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Explain why the Cārvāka rejects *śabda* as an independent *pramāṇa*, and assess whether the rejection is consistent with his acceptance of perception. **(10 marks, ~150 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain</i> then <i>assess</i> - exposition plus a consistency verdict
Core issue	Whether admitting words-as-sounds while refusing words-as-evidence is coherent
Ideal thesis	The rejection is internally consistent, since the perceived item is the sound and the disputed item is the content

Full independent model answer

FACT: The Cārvāka argument runs in steps. Words heard through the ears are **perceived**, so knowledge of words is perceptual and valid. But insofar as words "suggest or mean things not within our perception", they "are not free from error and doubt". Acceptance of an authority proceeds through a suppressed inference - "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" - and, being based on inference, testimony is "as precarious as inference". In

the special case of the Veda, claims of authority cannot be perceptually certified, and Chatterjee and Datta report the Cārvāka's charge that the texts are "the works of some cunning priests".

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** The rejection is consistent, because the Cārvāka carefully separates two objects: the **sound**, which is perceived, and the **content**, which is not. He therefore denies testimony independent *pramāṇa*-status without denying communication. The residual cost is that a life without testimonial knowledge is unliveable - but that is a charge of impracticality, not of inconsistency.

Why this earns marks

- The five-step argument reproduced, not merely summarised.
- The sound/content distinction stated explicitly - this is what secures consistency.
- The suppressed reliability premise identified as an **inference**.
- One line on the Veda, framed epistemically rather than as abuse.
- A verdict that distinguishes **inconsistency** from **impracticality**.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish *svabhāva* from *yadṛcchā* in Cārvāka metaphysics and examine whether they are consistent. (10 marks, ~150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Distinguish</i> then <i>examine</i> consistency - a conceptual distinction put to critical work
Core issue	Whether fixed natures and fortuitous combination can both be asserted
Ideal thesis	They are compatible only if <i>svabhāva</i> governs the behaviour of elements while <i>yadṛcchā</i> governs their initial concurrence ; otherwise there is tension

Full independent model answer

FACT: **Svabhāva** is naturalism: "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", and it is by these inherent natures and laws that they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God"; fire is hot and water cool by their own natures. FACT: **Yadṛcchā** is mechanism or accidentalism: it "denies the existence of conscious purpose behind the world" and explains it "as a mere mechanical or **fortuitous** combination of elements".

ANALYSIS: **Examination.** There is a real tension. If the elements combine **by their fixed natures**, the resulting world is lawful and not fortuitous; if the combination is **fortuitous**, natures cannot be doing the explanatory work. The most charitable reconstruction assigns them different roles: *svabhāva* explains how each element **behaves** once in combination, while *yadṛcchā* denies that any **purpose** governs which combinations occur. On that reading they are consistent, and their joint target is teleology rather than regularity. ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka's own caution supports this: he grants that there is "neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future".

Why this earns marks

- Both terms defined with the textbook's own glosses.
- The tension named explicitly rather than glossed over.
- A charitable reconstruction offered, with its division of labour.
- The "no guarantee of future uniformity" line used as evidence for the deflationary reading.
- A verdict that identifies **teleology**, not regularity, as the common target.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Examine the Cārvāka doctrine that consciousness is an emergent by-product of the four elements, with the objections it faces. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Examine ... with the objections</i> - exposition plus a serious objection set and replies
Core issue	Whether the emergence analogies establish emergence of the right logical type
Ideal thesis	The analogies establish that novel public qualities emerge; consciousness is private and first-personal, so the explanatory gap remains - though dualism does not close it either

Full independent model answer

FACT: The doctrine. *Kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam*: consciousness arises from matter as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents. The objection it answers is stated by Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not perceive consciousness in any of the four material elements. How can it then come to qualify their product, the body?" The reply uses two analogies with distinct functions. **Betel** - leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red", yielding a reddish tinge when chewed together - establishes **compositional** emergence. **Fermentation** - molasses, "originally non-intoxicant", becoming intoxicant when allowed to ferment - establishes **transformational** emergence. Consciousness is accordingly "an **epiphenomenon** or by-product of matter".

ANALYSIS: Objections. (i) The analogies concern **public, third-person** qualities; consciousness is **private** - Sharma notes it "is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard", and "consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others". (ii) In swoon, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body persists **without** consciousness, so the property is not inseparable. (iii) Constant co-occurrence is not causation: "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", and the two horns of a bull are conjoined without being causally related - so the body may be the **instrument** of consciousness rather than its cause.

ANALYSIS: Replies and verdict. The Cārvāka may answer that the property is essential to a specific **organisation** rather than to bare bodily existence, and that positing an immaterial soul merely **renames** the gap. The honest verdict: the evidence establishes **dependence**, not production; both sides face the gap, and only one claims to have crossed it.

Why this earns marks

- The transmitted *sūtra* quoted or paraphrased.
- Both analogies, with their **distinct** functions named.
- The word *epiphenomenon* used precisely.
- At least three objections, at least two of them from the standard battery.
- The Cārvāka's replies given before the verdict.
- A verdict distinguishing **dependence** from **production**.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: "The Cārvāka's *upādhi* objection is a stronger argument than his objection from incomplete enumeration." Critically discuss. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically discuss</i> an evaluative comparison between two of the Cārvāka's own arguments
Core issue	Sample size versus identification of the relevant variable
Ideal thesis	The claim is correct: enumeration is curable in principle by more observation, whereas <i>upādhi</i> is not

Full independent model answer

FACT: The enumeration objection. *Vyāpti* requires knowledge of all cases, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now ... to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".

FACT: The upādhi objection. Even where two things are repeatedly observed together, an unnoticed condition may be operating. One who has often seen fire accompanied by smoke may infer smoke from fire and err, having failed to

notice the *upādhi* of **wetness of fuel**, on whose presence alone fire is attended with smoke. Hence "so long as the relation between two phenomena is not proved to be **unconditional**, it is an uncertain ground for inference" - and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may **always remain hidden**".

ANALYSIS: **Why the second is stronger.** Enumeration is a defect of **quantity**: more observation improves the position, even if it never completes it. *Upādhi* is a defect of **identification**: it concerns whether the property picked out is the genuine ground of the relation, and no amount of further counting settles it. The proof is dialectical - Nyāya answers enumeration with *bhūyodarśana* and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence, but must bring in **tarka** and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* to address *upādhi*, and concedes that only **suspected** conditions can be eliminated.

ANALYSIS: **Counter-consideration and verdict.** Nyāya may reply that a relation surviving systematic negative-case testing plus *tarka* is rationally warranted even if not indefeasible. That defends inference; it does not refute the *upādhi* point. The claim therefore stands: *upādhi* is the deeper argument, and it is the one that forces Nyāya to change the standard from certainty to warrant.

Why this earns marks

- Both objections stated accurately, with the *upādhi* example running **fire -> smoke**.
- The quantity/identification distinction stated as the pivot of the answer.
- The dialectical proof: Nyāya's differential response to the two objections.
- *Tarka* correctly described as an auxiliary, not a *pramāṇa*.
- A verdict that concedes Nyāya's warrant-based defence while upholding the comparison.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Cārvāka's metaphysics is nothing but its epistemology written out as a list of denials." Critically evaluate. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate</i> a strong interpretive claim - say how far it is true and where it fails
Core issue	Whether the metaphysics is wholly derivative or contains independent positive commitments
Ideal thesis	Largely true of the denials , false of the affirmations - the four elements, emergence and <i>svabhāva</i> are positive theses not entailed by the epistemology alone

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The case for the claim.** Chatterjee and Datta state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" the epistemological conclusion: if perception is the only reliable source of knowledge, "we can rationally assert only the reality of perceptible objects. God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like *adrṣṭa*) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

The derivation is exact. *Ākāśa* falls because it is inferred from sound. *Ātman* falls because no soul is perceived apart from the living body. *Īśvara* falls because he is reached only by design-inference. *Karma*, *adrṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *mokṣa* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states. Vedic authority falls with *śabda*, and ritual with it. One cut, seven casualties.

ANALYSIS: **Where the claim fails.** Three points. (i) The derivation needs a **bridging principle** - that ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *pramāṇas* - which is a **presupposition**, not a theorem. An opponent could accept the epistemology and hold that reality exceeds knowledge; the Cārvāka's refusal of that gap is a substantive metaphysical decision.

(ii) The metaphysics contains **positive** theses the epistemology does not yield. That there are exactly **four** elements, that they are **eternal** while their combinations perish, that consciousness **emerges** from organised matter as redness emerges from betel and intoxication from fermented molasses, and that *svabhāva* explains regularity - none of these is entailed by "only perception is a *pramāṇa*". They are empirical and explanatory hypotheses.

(iii) There is even an internal strain among them: *svabhāvavāda* grounds regularity in fixed natures while *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products". A purely derivative metaphysics could not generate such a tension.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** The claim is **true of the negative half and false of the positive half**. Cārvāka's denials are indeed epistemology written out as a list - which is why they stand or fall entirely with the rejection of inference. But its affirmations are a materialist research programme in miniature, and they carry explanatory burdens of their own: chiefly the explanatory gap between public emergent qualities and private consciousness, which no epistemic restriction can discharge. ANALYSIS: Criterion named: **derivational economy** supports the claim, **explanatory content** refutes it.

Why this earns marks

- The derivation reproduced compactly, with connectives.
- The bridging principle named as a **presupposition**.
- At least three positive theses identified as underivable from the epistemology.
- The internal *svabhāva* / *yadṛcchā* tension used as evidence.
- A split verdict - true of the denials, false of the affirmations - with a named criterion.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Compare the Cārvāka and Nyāya positions on *vyāpti*, and assess whether Nyāya successfully answers the Cārvāka. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Compare then assess success</i> - the assessment must name a standard of success
Core issue	Whether replacing certainty with warrant answers the objection or changes the subject
Ideal thesis	Nyāya succeeds against the practical challenge and concedes the logical point; the dispute is ultimately about the concept of knowledge

Full independent model answer

FACT: **Cārvāka.** *Vyāpti* is required for inference to claim certainty, and it can be had from no admitted source. Not from perception: all cases past, present and future are never surveyed, and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known. Not from inference: *petitio principii* or regress; deduction is circular and induction unwarranted. Not from testimony: its own validity is inferred, and if inference depended on it "no one could infer anything by himself". *Upādhi* completes the case, since unconditionality cannot be certified while hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice".

FACT: **Nyāya.** *Vyāpti* is **assembled**, not intuited in one act. Repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*) is disciplined as **anvaya** (co-presence) and **vyatireka** (co-absence), making it a structured search for counter-instances. Suspected *upādhis* are identified and the universal restated at the correct level - "fire joined with wet fuel, there smoke". **Tarka** - not a *pramāṇa* but a *pramāṇa-anugrahaka* - assumes the contradictory and exhibits an unacceptable consequence, removing the doubt that blocks *vyāptigraha*. **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** answers the class-character objection by presenting the universal through the particular. Finally, **parāmarśa** - the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance - shows that no "leap" occurs at all.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** Nyāya succeeds on three counts. *Tarka* has real bite against Cārvāka specifically, since the Cārvāka's own acting, expecting and arguing presuppose the regularities he refuses to certify. *Parāmarśa* dissolves the "leap" picture on which the objection trades. And Sharma's counter-attack reverses the hierarchy: perception errs - the flat earth, the static earth, the small solar disc - and is corrected **by inference**, while "mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless conception ... has arranged into order ... the loose threads of sense-data".

ANALYSIS: Yet three concessions remain. Only **suspected upādhis** can be eliminated. *Tarka* proves nothing alone. *Sāmānyalakṣaṇa* is defensible only inside Nyāya's realism about universals.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Nyāya answers the Cārvāka **by changing the standard** - from omniscient certainty to disciplined rational warrant, since "the Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice". Judged by **warrant**, Nyāya wins; judged by **entailment**, the Cārvāka's logical point survives untouched. The real disagreement is therefore about the concept of knowledge, not about the logic of induction, on which both agree.

Why this earns marks

- Both positions given their strongest form, with Sanskrit terms glossed.
- The eight-stage Nyāya construction at least summarised.
- *Tarka* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* correctly characterised, including their limits.
- Sharma's counter-attack on perception included.
- A verdict that names **two** criteria and delivers a different result under each.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Enrichment only. A competent core answer does not require this block. Use it selectively for qualification, comparison, objections/replies and a higher-quality verdict after the Basic doctrine and answer structure are secure. Every substantive legacy Layer 3 point is retained below under the same nine subtopics.

1. Historical Reconstruction and the Source Problem

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka was not marginal to Indian philosophy; it was structural.** Chatterjee and Datta make the point in their concluding section and it is worth reproducing as an evaluative sentence: "every system of Indian thought tried to meet the Cārvāka objections and made the Cārvāka a **touchstone** of its theories." They add that its value "lies directly in supplying fresh philosophical problems and indirectly in compelling other thinkers to give up dogmatism, and become critical and cautious in speculation as well as in the statement of views" - and they compare this to Kant's admission that "the scepticism of Hume roused me from my dogmatic slumber."

ANALYSIS: **Sharma's counterweight, which a balanced answer should also carry:** "Materialism in Indian Philosophy has never been a force. Born in discontent, it soon died in serious thought." The two verdicts are not contradictory: Cārvāka failed as a *positive system* while succeeding as a *critical function*. That two-sided judgement is exactly the graded verdict UPSC rewards.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The reconstruction problem here belongs to a general class: how to state fairly a position preserved only in the words of those who rejected it. The same methodological question arises in reading the Greek Sophists through Plato, or the Presocratics through Aristotle. ANALYSIS: Use this as a *methodological* remark of one sentence. It is a conceptual parallel, **not** a dated development, and it must never be written as though it were news.

2. Epistemology - Perception as the Sole Pramāṇa

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka's scepticism is selective, and Sharma turns that selectivity into an objection.** Śūnyavāda Buddhism and Advaita Vedānta also reject the *ultimate* validity of inference - but, as Sharma notes, "the Śūnyavādin and the Advaitin reject the ultimate validity of **all** means of knowledge as such **including perception**, though they insist on the empirical validity of all means of knowledge. The distinction between ultimate and empirical knowledge is **unknown to the Cārvāka**. To accept the validity of perception and, at the same time and from the same standpoint, to reject the validity of inference is a thoughtless self-contradiction."

ANALYSIS: This gives you a **three-way comparison** that very few candidates will produce:

School	Perception	Inference	Level-distinction available?
Cārvāk a	FACT: Valid, full stop	WRONG: Rejected, full stop	WRONG: None - hence Sharma's charge of "same standpoint" inconsistency

School	Perception	Inference	Level-distinction available?
Śūnya vāda	ANALYSIS: Empirically valid, ultimately not	ANALYSIS: Empirically valid, ultimately not	FACT: <i>Samvṛti</i> / <i>paramārtha</i>
Advaita	ANALYSIS: <i>Vyāvahārika</i> validity only	ANALYSIS: <i>Vyāvahārika</i> validity only	FACT: <i>Vyāvahārika</i> / <i>pāramārthika</i>

ANALYSIS: **The Cārvāka's best available repair**, and you should offer it before evaluating: *adopt the level-distinction*. If the Cārvāka says "inference has *vyāvahārika* usefulness but no *pāramārthika* validity", Sharma's charge of same-standpoint inconsistency loses its grip - at the price of conceding that the doctrine is a thesis about certainty rather than about usability. That is precisely the softened reading defended in Subtopic 3.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The Cārvāka analysis of *śabda* - that a hearer's acceptance of testimony always runs through a suppressed premise about the speaker's reliability - is the ancestor of the modern **reductionist** position in the epistemology of testimony, and it is the exact point at issue in contemporary debates about credibility and misinformation. ANALYSIS: Label it as a conceptual parallel in a single clause if at all; do not import modern examples into a Paper I answer in place of *pratyakṣa*, *anumāna* and *śabda*, and do not present it as a dated event.

3. The Critique of Inference - Vyāpti, Upādhi, the Socrates Syllogism and Self-Refutation

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Distinguish two Cārvāka claims that are constantly run together in scripts:**

CLAIM A (epistemic) : inference does not GUARANTEE truth
 -> defensible; almost universally granted today
 CLAIM B (semantic/ : the words "wherever smoke, there fire" express
 ontological) no knowable proposition at all
 -> far stronger; hard to hold while doing philosophy

ANALYSIS: Most of the force of the Cārvāka critique lives in Claim A. Most of the vulnerability to self-refutation lives in Claim B. A first-class answer separates them and says which one it is defending.

ANALYSIS: **A further refinement on the target.** The Cārvāka's practical inferences are always **perceptually redeemable**: I infer fire, I climb the hill, I see fire. Transcendental inferences are **structurally unredeemable**: I infer heaven from *agnihotra*, and no perception could ever cash the claim. The Cārvāka's position becomes far more defensible when stated as: *an inference is worth something to the extent that its conclusion is in principle perceptually checkable* - which is a verificationist criterion in Indian dress, and is exactly the material needed for the 2024 "positivism" question.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The *vyāpti* argument is a strikingly early and complete statement of what Western philosophy calls **the problem of induction**: that no finite set of observations entails an unrestricted universal, and that attempts to justify induction inductively are circular. The *upādhi* argument anticipates the modern problem of **confounding variables** - the possibility that an observed regularity tracks an unnoticed third factor. ANALYSIS: These are conceptual parallels for one clause of comparative colour, not dated developments, and they must never displace the Indian vocabulary in a Paper I script.

4. The Nyāya Defence of Inference - and a Critically Balanced Verdict

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **What the debate is really about, stated at the highest level.** Both sides agree that finite observation cannot logically entail an unrestricted universal. They disagree about what follows.

CARVAKA : entailment fails => no knowledge => no pramana-status
 NYAYA : entailment fails => but WARRANT does not require entailment
 => disciplined procedure yields knowledge
 => pramana-status is preserved

ANALYSIS: The disagreement is therefore about the **concept of knowledge**, not about the logic of induction, on which the two are in near-agreement. Writing that sentence identifies the true locus of the dispute and is the mark of a top script.

ANALYSIS: **The honest residue against Nyāya**, which a balanced answer must supply so as not to look partisan: (i) *tarka* is admittedly not a *pramāṇa* and cannot by itself establish anything; (ii) *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* is defensible only inside Nyāya's realism about universals, so it is not a neutral answer; (iii) the elimination of *upādhis* is always elimination of **suspected** conditions, never a proof that none remains. Nyāya's inference is therefore highly disciplined but not indefeasible - which is precisely what a fallibilist Cārvāka wanted to hear.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: Nyāya's replacement of certainty by disciplined warrant, with negative-case testing and the systematic elimination of confounders, is conceptually parallel to modern accounts of **inference under uncertainty** - controlled comparison, elimination of alternative explanations, and degrees of confirmation rather than proof. ANALYSIS: Use at most one clause of this in an answer, explicitly as a conceptual analogy, never as a dated development or as authority.

5. Metaphysics and Materialism - Four Bhūtas, the Rejection of Ākāśa, and Svabhāvavāda

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka materialism is not modern scientific materialism, and saying why is worth marks.**

Axis	Cārvāka	Modern scientific materialism
Basic entities	FACT: Four perceptible gross elements	Unobservable micro-entities: fields, particles, forces
Attitude to inference	FACT: Denies it <i>pramāṇa</i> -status	Depends on it absolutely - theory is inference from data
Attitude to unobservables	FACT: Refuses them as unwarranted	Admits them freely when they earn their explanatory keep
Method	ANALYSIS: Polemical minimalism	Experiment, prediction, controlled testing, revision
Status of laws	ANALYSIS: <i>Svabhāva</i> , with no guarantee of future uniformity	Law-like regularities, projectible and quantified

ANALYSIS: **The resulting paradox, which is the best single sentence in this subtopic:** *Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an anti-inferential route, whereas modern materialism reaches a materialist conclusion by a thoroughly inferential route. The agreement in ontology conceals a total disagreement in method.* That sentence is the pivot of any good answer on whether Cārvāka is "scientific" or "positivistic".

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: *Bhūta-caitanya-vāda* is an early statement of what is now called **emergent physicalism**, and the objection pressed above - that redness and intoxicating power are third-person properties whereas consciousness is first-personal - is recognisably the modern **explanatory gap** objection. ANALYSIS: This is a conceptual parallel offered for one clause of comparative framing. It is not a dated development, it carries no authority, and in a Paper I script it must never displace *bhūta*, *caitanya*, *svabhāva* and the betel and fermentation analogies.

6. Self, Body and Consciousness - Dehātmanvāda, and Cārvāka versus Buddhist Anātman (2024, 20 marks)

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **The point almost no candidate makes, and it is decisive.** Buddhism's *anātman* is **not** a weaker version of Cārvāka's denial; it is a **wider** one. *Rūpa* - material form - is itself one of the five *skandhas*, and is expressly declared not to be self. The Buddhist analysis therefore rules out the Cārvāka's body-self *by name*. Writing this sentence demonstrates that you understand the doctrines rather than the labels: *for the Buddhist, "I am this body" is one of the very identifications that anātman is formulated to dismantle.*

ANALYSIS: **A second refinement: the Puggalavāda foil.** The authored Buddhism file records that some Buddhists, associated with the Vātsīputrīyas, posited a *pudgala* "neither the same as nor different from the *skandhas*", and that the mainstream criticised this as a relapse towards self-theory. ANALYSIS: Use this to show that the pressure to preserve a bearer of moral continuity was felt *inside* Buddhism, and was refused - which makes the contrast with

Cārvāka, who simply keeps a bearer and makes it material, doubly instructive.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The Cārvāka-Buddhist-Nyāya triangle is the Indian version of the contemporary three-cornered debate between **substance dualism**, **reductive physicalism** and **bundle or process theories of the self**. ANALYSIS: Note it in a clause if it helps frame the answer; it is a conceptual parallel only, not a dated development, and the Sanskrit vocabulary must carry the answer.

7. The Rejection of Transcendent Entities - God, Soul, Karma, Rebirth, Heaven, Mokṣa, Veda and Ritual

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka's atheism is structurally different from every other Indian denial of God, and this comparison is high-value in Paper I and Paper II alike.**

School	Denies a creator God because	Accepts anumāna?	Accepts scriptural authority?
Cārvāka	FACT: No <i>pramāṇa</i> establishes him, and <i>svabhāva</i> suffices	WRONG: No	WRONG: No
Sāṃkhya	FACT: <i>Prakṛti</i> explains evolution; a God is superfluous and would compromise <i>puruṣa</i> 's inactivity	FACT: Yes	FACT: Yes
Mīmāṃsā	FACT: The Veda is <i>apauruṣeya</i> and <i>apūrva</i> matures without a dispenser	FACT: Yes	FACT: Yes - supremely
Jainism	FACT: The world is uncreated; karma is material and self-operating; but godhood is attained by the liberated soul	FACT: Yes	WRONG: Rejects Vedic authority
Buddhism	FACT: Dependent origination explains arising; an immutable cause cannot yield succession	FACT: Yes	WRONG: Rejects Vedic authority

ANALYSIS: **The resulting single sentence, which is worth memorising: Cārvāka is the only Indian school whose atheism is generated by its epistemology rather than by its cosmology or its soteriology - which is why it also rejects the karma, rebirth and liberation that Sāṃkhya, Mīmāṃsā, Jainism and Buddhism all retain.** Non-theism is common in Indian philosophy; **this-worldliness is Cārvāka's alone.**

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The demand that a postulate be in principle checkable, and the treatment of unfalsifiable claims as unwarranted rather than merely unproved, is conceptually parallel to modern **scientific scepticism** and to verificationist criteria of meaning. ANALYSIS: Offer this as a labelled conceptual parallel only, and be careful: the parallel is exactly what makes the 2024 "positivism" question tempting *and* what makes an unqualified "yes" to it wrong, since Cārvāka rejects the very inferential machinery on which modern science runs.

8. Ethics and the Political-Social Meaning - and Cārvāka versus Jaina Reality (2020, 15 marks)

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Was Cārvāka a social philosophy?** Two pieces of evidence, both from Chatterjee and Datta, suggest more than pure appetite: the incorporation of *daṇḍanīti* (political philosophy, the science of governance) and *vārttā* (economics, the science of livelihood) into the philosophy of the Lokāyatikas; and the report that some Cārvākas "regard the **king as God**". ANALYSIS: The natural reading is a **secular theory of political authority**: order is guaranteed not by cosmic *dharma* or divine sanction but by the sovereign, and prosperity by the productive arts. CAUTION: The evidence is thin and doxographical, and must be presented as suggestive rather than established - but it is precisely the material that saves a Cārvāka answer from ending in caricature, and it directly supports the "secular" half of the 2024 label.

ANALYSIS: **A final ethical refinement.** Cārvāka's ethics lacks two things that every rival supplies: a **qualitative** distinction among pleasures (Sharma's "pleasure of the pig") and an account of **other-regarding** obligation. Vātsyāyana supplies a partial answer to the first through cultivation and the fine arts, and Chatterjee and Datta gesture at the second through the necessity of social discipline and the king. But neither is derived from the Cārvāka's

own value theory; both are added to it. ANALYSIS: **The honest verdict:** Cārvāka's ethics is a fully coherent theory of *prudence* and an incomplete theory of *morality*.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: Cārvāka's grounding of value in embodied pleasure and pain, without supernatural sanction, is conceptually parallel to modern **secular and naturalistic ethics**; and the *dhūrta* / *suśikṣita* distinction mirrors the Western contrast between crude and refined, or quantitative and qualitative, hedonism. ANALYSIS: Conceptual parallel only, offered in a clause; not a dated development, and never a substitute for *puruṣārtha*, *kāma*, *artha* and the Sanskrit sources.

9. Comparative Synthesis and Answer-Writing Architecture

3. Five verdicts you may safely defend

ANALYSIS: Each of these is defensible, criterion-named and examiner-friendly. Choose according to the question.

1. "Cārvāka's epistemology is more successful as a **critique of certainty** than as a **theory of knowledge**."
2. "Cārvāka's ontology is impeccably derived from its epistemology; its vulnerability is therefore located entirely in that epistemology, not in its metaphysics."
3. "Cārvāka wins the argument that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal, and loses the argument that this abolishes inference as a **pramāṇa** - because Nyāya replaces the demand for omniscient certainty with a demand for disciplined warrant."
4. "Cārvāka denies the **transcendence** of the self while retaining its **substantiality**; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its moral continuity. The two denials are not species of one genus."
5. "Cārvāka is a complete theory of prudence and an incomplete theory of morality; its historical value is critical rather than constructive - it was, as Chatterjee and Datta put it, the **touchstone** on which every other system tested itself."

4. Is Cārvāka positivistic? - the full treatment of the 2024 demand

ANALYSIS: The question ("Do you think Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications") invites a **graded** answer. A flat yes or a flat no both lose marks. Structure it as three movements.

ANALYSIS: **Movement 1 - establish that the label is not imported by the examiner.** FACT: Chatterjee and Datta apply it themselves: "The Cārvāka theory on the whole may also be called **positivism**, because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena." They also compare its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". This is a decisive evidential point: you are not being asked to invent a comparison, you are being asked to test one already present in the tradition of exposition.

ANALYSIS: **Movement 2 - the case for the label:**

Respect	Cārvāka	Positivism
Criterion of the knowable	FACT: Only what is presented in perception	Only what is empirically verifiable
Attitude to metaphysics	FACT: Transcendent entities are rejected as unwarranted	Metaphysical statements are rejected as unverifiable
Attitude to theology	FACT: God and afterlife have no <i>pramāṇa</i>	Theological statements are cognitively empty
Attitude to authority	FACT: Scripture is not an independent source	Revelation is not evidence
Register of dismissal	ANALYSIS: Questions about rebirth and heaven become "meaningless" (Chatterjee and Datta's word)	Unverifiable statements are meaningless
Value theory	FACT: Naturalistic, this-worldly, consequential	Naturalistic and anti-transcendent

ANALYSIS: **Movement 3 - the case against, and it is the stronger half:**

Respect	Cārvāka	Positivism
Inference	FACT: Denied pramāṇa-status - the fatal divergence	Depends utterly on inference; science <i>is</i> systematised inference

Respect	Cārvāka	Positivism
Unobservables	FACT: Refused	Freely admitted when they earn their explanatory keep
Programme	ANALYSIS: Polemical minimalism; no method of confirmation	A constructive programme: unified science, criteria of significance, logical analysis
Tools	ANALYSIS: None of formal logic, semantics or probability	Formal logic, verification and confirmation theory, language analysis
Comte's specific content	ANALYSIS: Absent	Law of three stages, sociology, a philosophy of history
Fallibilism	ANALYSIS: Demands indubitability, then finds nothing meets it	Accepts corrigible, revisable knowledge as the norm

ANALYSIS: **The verdict formula.** *Cārvāka is positivistic in spirit - in its empiricist criterion, its anti-metaphysical temper and its suspicion of unverifiable authority, a resemblance Chatterjee and Datta themselves note. It is not positivistic in method, because positivism is built on the very inference Cārvāka refuses to certify, and possesses a constructive programme that Cārvāka wholly lacks. The safer and more accurate label is radical empiricism or naturalistic materialism; "positivism" is a useful analogy, not a historical identity.* ANALYSIS: Add the paradox from Subtopic 5: Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an anti-inferential route, whereas positivism reaches its conclusions by a thoroughly inferential one.

5. India and the West - convergence and divergence

Western figure or movement	Convergence with Cārvāka ANALYSIS:	Divergence ANALYSIS:
Epicurus / Lucretius	Materialist atomism; this-worldly ethics; freedom from fear of the gods and of death	Epicurus offers <i>ataraxia</i> and a theory of prudent, qualitatively ordered pleasure; Cārvāka as transmitted offers no such refinement - though the <i>suśikṣita</i> strand approaches it
Hume	Induction cannot be rationally justified; causal relation is not perceived	Hume grounds inference in custom and treats it as psychologically indispensable, retaining it as knowledge; Cārvāka denies it <i>pramāṇa</i> -status outright
Logical positivism (Ayer)	Suspicion of unverifiable metaphysics; the "meaningless" register	Ayer preserves scientific inference and analyses meaning through formal tools absent in India
Comte	Rejection of theological explanation in favour of observable phenomena	Comte's positivism is a philosophy of history and a science of society; Cārvāka has neither
Contemporary physicalism	Consciousness as arising from material organisation	Modern physicalism is inference-driven and posits unobservables freely

ANALYSIS: **Chatterjee and Datta's own comparative line, which is safe to quote in substance:** the criticism of inference put in the Cārvāka's mouth "reminds us of similar criticism made in modern times against the soundness of deductive logic", and the Cārvāka view "that no inference can yield certain knowledge is the view of many contemporary Western thinkers like the pragmatists and logical positivists." They also compare the school's fate to that of the Epicureans of Greece, who "have been more hated than understood".

Canonical cross-school and answer-depth ledgers

6A. PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER ANALYSIS:

Doctrine	Presupposition	What collapses if denied
Perception as sole pramāṇa	Immediate presentation is the only secure mark of knowledge	The entire anti-inference and anti-scripture programme loses its foundation
Vyāpti critique	Universality must be certain, not merely probable, to ground pramāṇa-status	Anumāna can be rehabilitated as disciplined fallible knowledge
Upādhi problem	Hidden conditions can always qualify observed regularities	Nyāya-style upādhi-elimination can secure reliable universals
Rejection of śabda	Words require independent proof of speaker competence and truth	Veda, reliable testimony, and social knowledge regain pramāṇa-status
Four bhūtas and rejection of ākāśa	Only perceptibly grounded elements are ontologically admissible	A fifth element can be inferred from sound or spatial accommodation
Bhūta-caitanya / emergent consciousness	Consciousness can arise from organized material elements	A non-material self or consciousness-substance becomes necessary
Rejection of karma and rebirth	No unseen moral continuity is perceptually established	Dharma, rebirth, and liberation-soteriology regain metaphysical force
Svabhāvavāda	Observable natures are enough to explain regularity	Divine will, adṛṣṭa, karma, or teleology may be invoked as deeper explanation
Hedonist ethics	Value must be anchored in embodied this-worldly experience	Dharma and mokṣa can override kāma and artha
Rejection of mokṣa	Bondage and liberation require an unproved self and post-mortem destiny	The whole puruṣārtha scheme beyond worldly life becomes defensible

6B. PŪRVAPAKṢA-SIDDHĀNTA LEDGER ANALYSIS:

Objector	Objection	Cārvāka reply	Residual force ANALYSIS:
Nyāya	Self-refutation: rejection of inference is itself inferential. Vyāpti is securable through upādhi-elimination, tarka , and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa . The self is proved because desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain, and cognition inhere in a substance.	Dogmatic wing: inference never reaches certainty because vyāpti cannot be secured. Sceptical/Jayarāśi wing: the Naiyāyika's own definitions fail from within. ANALYSIS:	Nyāya gives the strongest systematic defence of inference; Cārvāka must either soften or face self-refutation.
Buddhism	Karma and rebirth are accepted without eternal ātman; momentariness does not imply materialism. Buddhists also accept inference as valid.	ANALYSIS: Reconstructed reply: rebirth and karma still outrun perception; momentary streams are as unseen as souls when used to explain post-mortem continuity.	Buddhism avoids eternal soul while preserving moral continuity, making it a subtler opponent than theism.
Jainism	Consciousness cannot be a property of elements because elements individually lack it; an emergent property needs a bearer.	ANALYSIS: Reconstructed reply: combinations may display novel properties absent in parts; positing jīva adds an unperceived substance.	Emergence is asserted more than explained; Jaina pluralism exposes the bearer-problem.
Advaita / Vedānta	Consciousness is self-luminous; the body is known by consciousness, so it cannot be the source of consciousness.	ANALYSIS: Reconstructed reply: "self-luminosity" is a metaphysical description of experienced awareness, not proof of a disembodied ātman.	The subject-object problem remains hard for materialist emergence.
Mīmāṃsā	The Veda's authority is intrinsic; ridicule of ritual is not an argument against apauruṣeyatva or dharma.	Dogmatic reply: intrinsic authority is not perceived; testimony needs proof, and ritual results are unseen. ANALYSIS:	Mīmāṃsā has a sophisticated theory of language and obligation; satire alone is insufficient.
Yoga / Sāṃkhya	Puruṣa is distinct from prakṛti; experience, agency, and liberation require a consciousness-principle beyond matter.	ANALYSIS: Reconstructed reply: puruṣa is not perceived apart from embodied awareness; liberation is a projection from metaphysical dualism.	Cārvāka struggles to explain witness-consciousness, discipline, and the felt distinction between body and awareness.

6C. INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING ANALYSIS:

School	Pramāṇas	Self	Consciousness	Karma/rebirth	Scripture	God	Puruṣārthas	Liberation
Cārvāka	Pratyakṣa alone in strict doctrine; lokasiddha inference only as practical habit ANALYSIS:	Body-self; no surviving ātman	Emergent bhūta-caitanya	Rejected	Rejected as independent pramāṇa	Rejected	Kāma and artha emphasized; dharma/mokṣa rejected	Rejected
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	Perception, inference, comparison, testimony	Enduring ātman-substance	Quality of self, revealed through cognition	Accepted	Accepted as reliable testimony	Generally affirmed in later Nyāya	All four	Apavarga
Buddhism	Varies; perception and inference central in epistemological schools	No enduring ātman	Stream of momentary consciousness/events	Accepted without eternal self	Buddhist teaching accepted within its framework	Creator-God denied	Path-oriented revaluation	Nirvāṇa
Jainism	Multiple pramāṇas with standpoint theory	Plural jīvas	Intrinsic to jīva, obscured by karma	Accepted	Jaina teaching authoritative	Creator-God denied	Ethical-spiritual discipline	Mokṣa of jīva
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	Perception, inference, reliable testimony	Puruṣa distinct from prakṛti	Puruṣa as pure consciousness	Accepted	Accepted	Classical Sāṃkhya non-theistic; Yoga admits Īśvara	All four subordinated to release	Kaivalya
Mīmāṃsā	Perception, inference, comparison, postulation, non-cognition, śabda in developed lists	Enduring self	Attribute/manifestation tied to self	Accepted	Veda intrinsically authoritative	Creator-God not central	Dharma central	Often secondary to ritual/dharma, varies
Advaita Vedānta	Six pramāṇas commonly accepted, with śruti decisive for Brahman	Ātman identical with Brahman	Self-luminous consciousness	Empirical-level acceptance	Upaniṣadic śruti decisive	Īśvara at empirical level	Mokṣa supreme	Liberation through knowledge

Why Cārvāka matters structurally. ANALYSIS: Cārvāka is the standing **pūrvapakṣa** of Indian philosophy. Nyāya clarifies vyāpti by answering it; Mīmāṃsā sharpens Vedic authority against it; Buddhism and Jainism defend karma without crude eternalism; Vedānta defends self-luminosity against body-materialism. Knowing Cārvāka well therefore improves answers on pramāṇa, scripture, karma, self, and liberation across the whole Indian syllabus.

6D. CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON ANALYSIS:

Western comparator	Point of contact	Decisive disanalogy
Hume	Both question whether observed conjunctions establish necessary universal connection; both are suspicious of metaphysical entities such as substance, soul, and God when they outrun impressions/perception.	Hume does not deny that we should reason inductively; he denies its rational-demonstrative foundation while treating custom as the great guide of life. Cārvāka draws the stronger normative conclusion that inference is not a pramāṇa. Hume targets necessary connexion through impressions and ideas; Cārvāka targets vyāpti through regress and upādhi. Hume's bundle view of self differs from Cārvāka's positive deha-ātmavāda, and Hume has a developed moral psychology unlike Cārvāka hedonism.
A.J. Ayer / logical positivism	Both reject metaphysics on experience-linked grounds and dismiss God, soul, and afterlife when not verifiable.	Ayer's claim is semantic: unverifiable metaphysics is meaningless, neither true nor false. Cārvāka's claim is epistemic/ontological: such entities are not known and therefore not admitted. Ayer preserves scientific theoretical statements through indirect/weak verifiability; strict Cārvāka anti-inference threatens science too. Ayer's verification principle is charged with self-refutation, paralleling the self-refutation charge against Cārvāka.
Epicurus / Lucretius	Materialism, rejection of fear-based religion, and this-worldly pleasure make the comparison tempting.	Epicurean pleasure is ascetic and calculative, aiming at ataraxia (tranquillity); Cārvāka hedonism is usually presented as straightforward embodied enjoyment, though a refined prudential reading is possible.
Pyrrhonism / Jayarāśi	Jayarāśi's sceptical wing and Pyrrhonism both allow ordinary life to continue after suspension or collapse of foundations.	Pyrrhonism seeks tranquillity through epochē (suspension), whereas Jayarāśi works through pramāṇa-definition destruction within Indian debate; do not merge the traditions.
Feuerbach / Marx on religion's social function	Cārvāka's charge that ritual is the livelihood of priests anticipates a functional critique of religion as serving human/social interests.	Feuerbach and Marx build broader theories of projection, alienation, ideology, and society. Cārvāka offers sharp anti-ritual polemic without a historical-materialist theory.
Locke / general empiricism	Knowledge must be tied to experience; innate or purely speculative metaphysical claims are distrusted.	Locke and most empiricists accept abstraction, probability, testimony, and science-friendly inference. Cārvāka's strict pratyakṣa-only thesis is much narrower and more disruptive.

Rubric. ANALYSIS: Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Indian argument, and belong in at most one or two lines **after** the Cārvāka case is complete. These are conceptual analogies, not historical influences. Writing "Cārvāka is the Indian Hume" without stating the disanalogies is a marked weakness.

6E. DIRECTIVE DECODER ANALYSIS:

Directive	What the examiner is testing	Structural move for a Cārvāka answer	Closing verdict
Discuss	Breadth and balanced presentation	State doctrine -> explain pramāṇa basis -> show metaphysical consequences -> add one criticism	"Cārvāka is best read as radical epistemic economy, not mere denial."
Examine	Internal logic	Trace how pratyakṣa-only leads to anti-inference and anti-transcendence	"The conclusion follows if its strict perceptual premise is accepted."
Critically examine	Doctrine plus objections	Present Cārvāka argument, then Nyāya/Vedānta/Mīmāṃsā objections and replies	"Powerful as critique, unstable as complete system."
Analyse	Component-wise causal logic	Break into pramāṇa, vyāpti, upādhi, śabda, ontology, ethics	"Its metaphysics is generated by epistemology."
Evaluate	Final judgement required	Weigh strengths, weaknesses, and contested source-history	"Valuable negative philosophy; limited positive account."
Compare	Relation with another school	Use fixed axes: pramāṇa, self, consciousness, karma, liberation	"Similarity at one point must not hide doctrinal difference."
Distinguish	Sharp contrasts	Define both terms/schools first, then contrast on 4-5 axes	"The safest answer is difference plus one connecting insight."
Elucidate / Comment / Bring out	Clarity of explanation	Give thesis, one argument, one example, one implication	"This shows why the doctrine matters in the larger system."
Do you agree?	Reasoned personal verdict	State qualified agreement/disagreement after doctrinal exposition	"Agree with its critique of unwarranted transcendence, not with its total pramāṇa restriction."
"Cārvāka's rejection of X is self-refuting - critically examine"	Ability to handle the recurring self-refutation pattern	Show why the dogmatic wing is vulnerable; then introduce lokasiddha inference and Jayarāśi's prasaṅga-style escape route	"The charge is decisive only against an absolute denial of all reasoning; it is weaker against refined empiricism or dialectical scepticism."

6F. GRADED VERDICT ON CĀRVĀKA ANALYSIS:

Strong FACT:

- A genuine early principle of epistemic economy: do not multiply unseen entities without warrant.
- A real and still powerful problem about the warrant for universals and vyāpti.
- A valuable naturalistic check on speculative metaphysics, ritualism, and unverifiable claims.
- A functional critique of ritual religion as serving priestly livelihood rather than truth.
- In Jayarāśi, a serious dialectical scepticism that can challenge every pramāṇa-definition from within.

Weak ANALYSIS:

- The self-refutation problem is serious for the dogmatic wing.
- Svabhāvavāda gives no full account of why natures are stable.
- Bhūta-caitanya asserts emergence but does not adequately explain subjectivity.
- The ethics cannot easily distinguish prudence from impulse unless reconstructed charitably.

Genuinely contested CAUTION:

- What the school actually held, because no primary systematic text of the materialist wing survives.
- Whether dhūrta and suśikṣita Cārvāka name real internal schools or hostile doxographical types.
- Whether yadṛcchāvāda belongs to Cārvāka or is a distinct ahetuvāda option.
- Whether Jayarāśi is properly a Cārvāka or an allied radical sceptic.

Ready verdicts. ANALYSIS:

- **10 marks:** Cārvāka is strongest as an epistemological protest against unverifiable metaphysics, but weakest when its rejection of inference becomes absolute.
- **15 marks:** Its pratyakṣa-only principle powerfully explains the rejection of ātman, karma, Īśvara, and mokṣa; yet Nyāya's self-refutation and vyāpti replies show why it cannot stand as a complete theory of knowledge.
- **20 marks:** The best verdict is graded: dogmatic Cārvāka is vulnerable, refined Cārvāka is a coherent empiricist restriction on supersensible inference, and Jayarāśi's wing is a serious prasaṅga-style scepticism rather than crude materialism.

Anti-caricature warning. FACT: A strong UPSC answer presents Cārvāka as a serious epistemological position and standing pūrvapakṣa, not as mere hedonism or a stock joke about pleasure.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

A. Source status

- The *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost.
- Most doctrine survives through refutational doxographies.
- Convergence supports a recoverable core, but exact quotation requires caution.
- Jayarāśi is a sceptical witness associated with the stream, not a simple manual of standard doctrine.

B. Epistemic thesis

- Standard reconstruction: perception alone is an independent *pramāṇa*.
- External and internal perception ground ordinary cognition.
- Testimony depends on prior trust and is not independently self-validating.
- Practical expectation may be admitted without granting certain inference.

C. Critique of inference

- Inference requires universal *vyāpti*.
- Perception cannot survey all times, places and cases.
- Inference cannot prove *vyāpti* without circularity or regress.
- Testimony cannot rescue inference if testimony itself depends on inference.

D. Upādhi and self-refutation

- Hidden conditions defeat over-broad universals.
- The Socrates syllogism is formally valid but its universal premise remains epistemically contested.
- Absolute denial of inference appears self-refuting.
- A softened reading restricts secure inference, especially about supersensible entities.

E. Nyāya reply

- Repeated agreement and difference establish provisional concomitance.
- Elimination of suspected conditions and *tarka* strengthen *vyāpti*.
- Universal-character perception and *parāmarśa* explain inferential cognition.
- Nyāya offers disciplined warrant, not omniscient enumeration.

F. Material reality

- Four perceptible elements: earth, water, fire and air.
- Ether is rejected because it is imperceptible.
- *Svabhāvavāda* explains natural processes without transcendent agency.
- Modern scientific materialism must not be read back into the ancient position.

G. Self and consciousness

- *Dehātmavāda*: the conscious living body is the self.
- Consciousness emerges from material combination, often illustrated through fermentation or betel.
- Death ends the individual because no separable soul remains.
- The explanatory gap between matter and subjectivity remains a serious objection.

H. Transcendent denials

- No independently established ātman, Īśvara, karma, rebirth, heaven, hell or mokṣa.
- Vedic authority and sacrificial claims fail the perceptual test.
- Withholding assent and categorical denial should be distinguished.
- The epistemology drives the metaphysical rejection.

I. Ethics

- *Artha* is the practical means and *kāma* the operative end.
- Pleasure is not automatically momentary recklessness; consequences are perceptible.
- Famous “borrow ghee” style verses require source caution.
- Cārvāka is a this-worldly ethic, not merely an invitation to vice.

J. Comparative map

Comparison	Cārvāka	Rival
Jainism	four-element materialism	many-sided realist pluralism
Buddhism	body-self materialism	no-self process theory
Nyāya	perception-only challenge	four pramāṇas and inference defence
Vedānta	no transcendent self	self/Brahman as fundamental

K. Labels and evaluation

- “Positivistic” is defensible only as qualified anti-metaphysical empiricism.
- “Naturalistic” fits the rejection of supernatural explanation.
- “Materialist” is central; “scientific materialist” is anachronistic.
- The strongest achievement is epistemic protest; the weakest point is absolute anti-inferentialism.

L. Final answer discipline

1. Begin with the hostile-source qualification.
2. State the perception-only thesis precisely.
3. Reconstruct the *vyāpti/upādhi* argument in steps.
4. Connect epistemology to materialism and transcendent denials.
5. Present the strongest version before criticism.
6. Add the Nyāya reply or relevant comparative school.
7. End with a graded verdict: powerful critique, incomplete positive epistemology.

Final judgement: Cārvāka is best read as a disciplined empiricist and materialist challenge to unsupported transcendence. Its historical source problem demands caution, and its absolute rejection of inference remains internally unstable.

Detailed inherited nine-subtopic register

Register-last rule satisfied. The first matrix separates what is required for a core answer from what is optional enrichment. The detailed nine-register legacy revision set follows, preserving source cautions, Sanskrit terminology, argument spines, comparisons, PYQ routes and rapid recall.

CORE BASIC versus OPTIONAL ADVANCED - nine-subtopic recall matrix

Subtopic	CORE BASIC - required for a competent answer	OPTIONAL ADVANCED - enrichment only
1. Source problem	Lost <i>Brhaspati-sūtra</i> ; hostile doxography; convergent core; cautious use of Jayarāṣi. Selective transmission; Cārvāka as structural <i>pūrvapakṣa</i> and critical touchstone.	
2. Sole pramāṇa	<i>Pratyakṣa</i> alone; external/internal perception; testimony derivative; practical expectation is not certainty. Strong versus softened thesis; possible level-distinction is a repair, not secure historical doctrine.	
3. Inference critique	<i>Vyāpti</i> cannot be secured by perception, inference or testimony; <i>upādhi</i> threatens universality. Problem of induction; perceptual redeemability; self-refutation repairs and residual pressure.	
4. Nyāya defence	<i>Anvaya-vyatireka</i> , suspected- <i>upādhi</i> elimination, <i>tarka</i> , <i>sāmānyalakṣaṇa</i> , <i>parāmarśa</i> . Knowledge as disciplined warrant rather than entailment; Nyāya remains fallible, not indefeasible.	
5. Materialism	Four <i>bhūtas</i> , no <i>ākāśa</i> ; <i>bhūta-caitanya</i> ; betel/fermentation; <i>svabhāva</i> . Emergentism and explanatory gap; anti-inferential materialism differs from modern scientific materialism.	
6. Body-self	<i>Dehātmavāda</i> ; conscious living body; first-person predicates; death ends the individual. Personal identity, privacy, instrument-versus-cause objection, Buddhist process comparison and Puggalavāda foil.	
7. Transcendent denials	No <i>ātman</i> , <i>Īśvara</i> , <i>karma</i> , <i>adṛṣṭa</i> , rebirth, heaven, hell, <i>mokṣa</i> or Vedic authority. Withholding versus denial; ritual reductios; epistemic atheism versus other Indian non-theisms.	
8. Ethics/social meaning	<i>Artha</i> as means, <i>kāma</i> as end; refined versus crude hedonism; source caution for famous verses. Prudence versus morality; <i>daṇḍanīti</i> , <i>vārttā</i> , king-as-God report; positivism and naturalism qualified.	
9. Synthesis	ONE pramāṇa, FOUR elements, TWO operative aims, ZERO transcendent entities; reconstruct before criticising. Cross-school positioning, controlled comparison, directive decoder and criterion-named graded verdicts.	

Rapid answer spine

SOURCE CAUTION

- > PRATYAKṢA ALONE
- > VYAPTĪ / UPADHĪ CRITIQUE
- > NYAYA REPLY
- > FOUR-ELEMENT MATERIALISM
- > BODY-SELF AND EMERGENT CONSCIOUSNESS
- > NO TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES
- > ARTHA AS MEANS, KAMA AS END
- > COMPARISON + CRITERION-NAMED VERDICT

Rapid recall: ONE *pramāṇa* · FOUR *bhūtas* · TWO operative aims · ZERO transcendent entities.

PYQ routes at a glance

Route	Verified primary-owned questions
Inference and consistency	2018 Q8(b); 2019 Q5(c); 2019 Q6(c); 2025 Q5(a)
Materialism and transcendence	2020 Q6(b); 2021 Q5(e)
Comparisons	2020 Q7(c), Cārvāka-Jainism; 2024 Q6(a), Cārvāka-Buddhism
Comparative label	2024 Q5(a), positivistic nature

KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

Term	Rapid meaning
<i>Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda</i>	Perception alone is an independent <i>pramāṇa</i>
<i>Vyāpti</i>	Exceptionless relation required by inference
<i>Upādhi</i>	Hidden qualifying condition that defeats an over-broad universal
<i>Lokasiddha anumāna</i>	Practical, perception-redeemable expectation; not secure proof of transcendence
<i>Dehātmavāda</i>	The conscious living body is the self
<i>Bhūta-caitanya-vāda</i>	Consciousness emerges from organised elements
<i>Svabhāvavāda</i>	Natural own-natures replace divine or unseen governance
<i>Yadṛcchāvāda</i>	Accidentalism; association with Cārvāka is contested
<i>Dhūrta / suśikṣita</i>	Opponent-preserved crude/refined differentiation; use cautiously
Answer sentence	Cārvāka's ontology is the consequence of restricting valid knowledge to perception

Detailed legacy consolidated register - preserved

Placement note: These register notes come **after** all teaching and practice, and cover **every one of the nine subtopics** taught in this session. They are the last-mile revision layer, not a substitute for the session above.

Register 1 - Sources, names and historical setting

Item	Register entry
Syllabus wording	FACT: "Carvaka : Theory of Knowledge; Rejection of Transcendent Entities" (printed wording retained)
Names	FACT: Cārvāka (<i>carv</i> , to chew / <i>cāru-vāk</i> , sweet-worded) · Lokāyata (<i>lokāyata-mata</i> , view of common people) · Bārhaspatya (of Bṛhaspati)
Traditional founder	FACT: Bṛhaspati; his <i>Sūtra</i> is lost; about a dozen <i>sūtras</i> survive as quotations
Transmission	FACT: Known "chiefly" from works that state the views in order to refute them
Sharma's verdict on sources	FACT: "The weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted. So we get only a faint caricature and not a true picture"
Key doxographies	FACT: <i>Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha</i> (Mādhava) · <i>Ṣaḍ-darśana-samuccaya</i> (Haribhadra) · <i>Prabodhacandrodaya</i> (a play, Kṛṣṇamiśra) · <i>Tattvasaṅgraha</i> (Śāntarakṣita) · <i>Vedāntasāra</i> (Sādānanda)
Only surviving text	FACT: <i>Tattvopaplavasīmha</i> , Jayarāśi Bhāṭṭa , c. 8th century CE, published Baroda 1940 - but he attacks perception too and admits not even the elements
Six transmitted <i>sūtras</i>	FACT: four elements · bodies-senses-objects from combination · consciousness as intoxicating power · <i>caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ</i> · <i>kāma evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ</i> · <i>marāṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>
<i>Nāstika</i> - exact sense	FACT: Rejects the authority of the Veda (primary sense); also denies life after death (secondary sense); <i>nāstika</i> in both
Historical anchors	FACT: Ajita Kesakambalī (<i>Majjhima Nikāya</i> ; believed only in perception and four elements) · Pūraṇa Kassapa · Makkhali Gosāla · Sañjaya Belaṭṭhiputta (<i>Sāmaññaphala-sutta</i>)

Item	Register entry
Causes of its rise (Sharma)	FACT: Protest against monkdom and ritual externals; Upaniṣadic idealism unsuited to commoners; exploitation and social crisis
Two standing verdicts	ANALYSIS: Chatterjee-Datta: the school was the touchstone of every system · Sharma: "Born in discontent, it soon died in serious thought"
Mnemonic	MEMORY: ONE, FOUR, TWO, ZERO - one <i>pramāṇa</i> , four elements, two <i>puruṣārthas</i> , zero transcendent entities

Register 2 - Epistemology

- FACT: **Thesis:** *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda* - perception alone is a *pramāṇa*.
- FACT: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend **logically** on their epistemology" (Chatterjee and Datta).
- FACT: **The standard demanded:** knowledge "about which we can have no doubt" and "which must be true to reality".
- FACT: **Both** external (*bāhya*) and internal (*mānasa*) perception are admitted.
- FACT: Consciousness **is** established by perception; what is denied is the inference from consciousness to an immaterial bearer.
- FACT: **The concession:** "in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference" - but "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an **accident**, and a **separable** one."
- ANALYSIS: **Laukika / vyāvahārika** inference (corrigible, perceptually redeemable) versus **alaukika / pāramārthika** inference (structurally uncheckable). The second is the real target.
- FACT: **Śabda in five steps:** words are heard, hence perceived -> what they *mean* is unperceived -> acceptance runs through "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" -> that is inference -> hence testimony is "as precarious as inference".
- FACT: **The Veda:** "the works of some cunning priests who earned their living by duping the ignorant and the credulous".
- FACT: Sharma's reductio: if testimony proved *vyāpti*, "none would be able to infer anything by himself".
- ANALYSIS: **One template kills the rest:** *upamāna*, *arthāpatti* and *anupalabdhi* each require an unperceived universal.
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's same-standpoint charge:** Śūnyavāda and Advaita reject the *ultimate* validity of **all** *pramāṇas* including perception while retaining empirical validity; the *vyāvahārika* / *pāramārthika* distinction is "unknown to the Cārvāka", so accepting perception and rejecting inference at one level is "a thoughtless self-contradiction".
- MEMORY: **Ledger to reproduce:** Cārvāka 1 · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism 2 · Sāṃkhya-Yoga 3 · Nyāya 4 · Prābhākara 5 · Bhāṭṭa and Advaita 6.

Register 3 - The critique of inference

- FACT: Inference is "a leap in the dark"; some inferences are true only "accidentally".
- FACT: The attack targets the **major premise** (*vyāpti*), never syllogistic form.
- FACT: **Door 1 - perception:** all cases past, present and future can never be surveyed.
- FACT: **The class-character (sāmānya) exchange:** even *dhūmatva* cannot be perceptually known, since not all smokes are perceived; and a universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference. "The difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal ... remains here as before."
- FACT: **Door 2 - inference:** *petitio principii* or regress. Sharma: "Induction is uncertain and deduction is argument in a circle. The logicians, therefore, find themselves stuck up in the mud of inference."
- FACT: A **causal** relation is only a species of invariable relation and inherits the same defect.
- FACT: **Door 3 - testimony:** its own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on testimony, no one could infer by himself.

- FACT: **Upādhi**: the wet-fuel condition - one who infers **smoke from fire** errs, because fire is attended with smoke only where fuel is wet. Unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden".
- ANALYSIS: *Upādhi* is a problem of the **right variable**, not of sample size - which is why more observation alone cannot answer it, and why Nyāya must bring in *tarka*.
- FACT: **2019 Socrates syllogism**: the form is granted; "All men are mortal" is the *vyāpti*; it fails the three doors; the deduction merely re-states an unestablished universal.
- FACT: **Self-refutation (Sharma)**: the denial is itself a universal; thoughts, ideas and other minds are never perceived; "the self-refuted Cārvāka position is called sheer nonsense and no system of philosophy".
- ANALYSIS: **Three replies**: *vitaṇḍā* / no-thesis · softened certainty-thesis (strongest) · level-distinction (a repair, not a historical doctrine).
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's tu quoque**: flat earth, static earth, small solar disc - perception errs and is corrected by *inference*; and mere sensation is not knowledge "unless conception or thought has arranged into order ... the loose threads of sense-data" (*Tattvasaṅgraha*).
- MEMORY: **Verdict formula**: the Cārvāka may be **consistent** or **radical**, but not both.

Register 4 - The Nyāya defence

- FACT: **The eight-stage ladder**: *bhūyodarśana* -> *upādhi*-elimination -> *tarka* -> *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* -> *vyāptigraha* -> *liṅga-darśana* -> *parāmarśa* -> *anumiti*.
- FACT: **Anvaya** (wherever *hetu*, there *sādhya*) and **vyatireka** (where no *sādhya*, no *hetu*) - the joint method; systematic search for negative cases, not mere counting.
- FACT: **Upādhi** is a condition that pervades the *sādhya* but not the *hetu*; a defective universal is **restated** at the correct level - "fire joined with wet fuel".
- FACT: **Tarka** is *pramāṇa-anugrāhaka*, not a *pramāṇa*: it assumes the contradictory and exhibits *aniṣṭa-prasaṅga*, removing the doubt that blocks *vyāptigraha*.
- FACT: **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**: the universal is presented through the particular - Nyāya's direct answer to the class-character objection.
- FACT: **Parāmarśa**: the cognition of the mark as qualified by concomitance is the *karaṇa* of *anumiti* - hence, for Nyāya, no "leap" occurs at all.
- FACT: **Nirvikalpaka / savikalpaka**: determinate perception is already conceptually qualified, so the Cārvāka's "pure given" is either pre-cognitive or not pure.
- ANALYSIS: **The decisive move**: replace **omniscient certainty** with **disciplined rational warrant**. "The Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice."
- ANALYSIS: **Honest residue**: *tarka* proves nothing alone; *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* presupposes realism about universals; only **suspected** *upādhis* can be eliminated.
- FACT: **Cross-school survey (2018 Q8(b))**: Nyāya, Sāṃkhya-Yoga, Mīmāṃsā, Jainism and Buddhism all retain inference; Advaita retains it *vyāvahārika*ally while denying ultimate validity to all *pramāṇas*.
- MEMORY: **Verdict**: Cārvāka loses the war and wins a battle - inference survives as **warranted**, not as **indubitable**.

Register 5 - Metaphysics and materialism

- FACT: **Bridging principle**: ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *pramāṇas*. Name it as a **presupposition**.
- FACT: *prthivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* - four *bhūtas*; *tatsamudāye śarīrendriya-viśaya-saṃjñā* - bodies, senses and objects from their combination.
- FACT: Living organisms too are elemental combinations, "reduced on death" to the elements.
- FACT: **The elements are eternal; only their combinations arise and perish** (Sharma). Hence Cārvāka is a **realist** materialism, not a flux doctrine.
- FACT: **Ākāśa rejected** "because it is not perceived but inferred" - the Vaiśeṣika inference from sound to an imperceptible substrate is refused.

- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka's most defensible line on sound: naturalise it into the perceptible air, rather than abandon the substance-quality scheme he uses for the four elements.
- FACT: *kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam* - consciousness arises as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents.
- FACT: **Betel** (leaf, lime, nut -> red): **compositional** emergence. **Fermentation** (*guḍa* -> intoxicant): **transformational** emergence. Two analogies, two distinct objections answered.
- FACT: Consciousness is an "**epiphenomenon** or by-product of matter"; "matter secretes mind as liver secretes bile".
- ANALYSIS: **Explanatory gap**: redness and intoxication are public, third-person qualities; consciousness is private and first-personal. Best Cārvāka reply: the soul-hypothesis **renames** the gap rather than closing it.
- FACT: **Pot and potter**: clay is the material cause and the potter the efficient cause; the Cārvāka answers with *svabhāva* - "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design".
- FACT: **Three labels from the textbook**: naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*) · mechanism (*yadrūcchāvāda*) · **positivism** ("believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena").
- ANALYSIS: **Two uses of svabhāva**: deflationary (regularity, with "neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future") and substantive (nature in place of God). The "empty label" objection bites only on the second.
- FACT: **Sadānanda's Vedāntasāra**: four materialist schools identify the self with the gross body, the senses, the vital breaths, or *manas*. Śāntarākṣita reports *Kambalāśvatara* holding that consciousness arises from the body **associated with vital breaths**.
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka reaches materialism by an **anti-inferential** route; modern materialism by a thoroughly **inferential** one.

Register 6 - Self, body and consciousness

- FACT: *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ / caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā* - the person is the **living** body qualified by consciousness. Not the corpse; not "no self at all"; not identity with any single element.
- FACT: **Negative argument**: "the non-material soul is **never perceived**".
- FACT: **Positive argument**: "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind" - if the "I" were different from the body these would be **meaningless**.
- FACT: **Covariation**: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease visibly alter awareness.
- FACT: **Consequence**: "death of the body means the end of the individual"; questions of previous life, after-life, rebirth, heaven and hell "become meaningless".
- FACT: **Sharma's objection battery**: self-consciousness versus animal life · swoon, fits, epilepsy and dreamless sleep = body without consciousness · dreams = consciousness "without the living body", and the waking dreamer disowns the dream-body but **owns** the dream-consciousness · subject cannot be reduced to object · **co-existence is not causation** (light and sight; the two horns of a bull) · consciousness is "neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard" · consciousness is **private** · the self-manifestation regress · the non-existence of a surviving soul is equally undemonstrable.
- ANALYSIS: **Best evaluative line**: the evidence establishes **dependence**; dependence is compatible with the body being the **instrument** rather than the cause.
- FACT: **Memory**: Nyāya/Vedānta invoke *ātman* · Cārvāka invokes bodily-psychological continuity of one organism · Buddhism invokes *santāna*, *pratisandhāna* and (Yogācāra) *ālaya-vijñāna* carrying *bījas*.
- FACT: **2024 core contrast**: Cārvāka **relocates** the self into matter; Buddhism **dissolves** the self into process. Substance retained versus substance abolished.
- FACT: **Grounds**: Cārvāka's is epistemic (never perceived); Buddhism's is ontological (*pratītyasamutpāda*, *kṣaṇikavāda*) and soteriological (self-belief breeds *trṣṇā*).
- FACT: **Aftermaths**: Cārvāka ends the moral narrative at death; Buddhism preserves karma, rebirth and *nirvāṇa* without an owner.
- ANALYSIS: **The decisive refinement**: *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*, so Buddhist *anātman* rules out the Cārvāka body-self **by name**.

- ANALYSIS: **Foils: Puggalavāda** (Vātsīputrīya) inside Buddhism; **Sadānanda's four materialisms** inside Cārvāka.

Register 7 - Rejection of transcendent entities

- FACT: **The template:** X is imperceptible -> only inference or testimony could reach X -> neither is a *pramāṇa* -> X is unwarranted -> X is rejected.
- ANALYSIS: Note the gap between **withholding assent** and **denying**; the doxographies attribute denial ("the Cārvākas, therefore, prefer atheism"), the argument licenses only the weaker conclusion.
- FACT: **God falls twice:** epistemically (no *pramāṇa*) and explanatorily (*svabhāva* suffices; the world's objects are "fortuitous products of the elements").
- FACT: **Adṛṣṭa** is named among the casualties - "any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*)". Its very name means "the unseen", making it the perfect test case.
- FACT: **Transmigration requires** a separable self, its survival, a carrier of desert, and knowledge of all three. Cārvāka cuts every one.
- FACT: **Heaven and hell** are "the inventions of the priests"; *svarga* rests on "the unproved existence of a life after death".
- FACT: **The liberation dilemma:** freedom of a soul (absurd - there is no soul) · freedom from all pain in this life (impossible - embodiment mixes pleasure and pain) · residue: *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*, which "no wise man would willingly work for".
- ANALYSIS: *Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ* is a **reductio of the concept of mokṣa**, not a recommendation of death.
- FACT: **Three ritual reductions:** *śrāddha* and the traveller's food · food downstairs feeding a person upstairs · *jyotiṣṭoma* - "why do they not rather sacrifice their own old parents?" The last is an argument from **revealed preference**.
- FACT: *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*: the Agnihotra, the three Vedas, the three staves and ashes were "made by Nature as the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness"; "the three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons". CAUTION: Quote with a source-caution.
- ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka's uniqueness:** Sāṃkhya, Mīmāṃsā, Jainism and Buddhism are also non-theistic. Cārvāka alone derives its atheism from its **epistemology**, and alone discards *karma*, rebirth and liberation as well.
- ANALYSIS: Internal tension worth flagging: *svabhāvavāda* grounds regularity in fixed natures; *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world "fortuitous".

Register 8 - Ethics and social meaning

- FACT: *kāma evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ* - enjoyment is the only end; **artha is its means**; *dharma* and *mokṣa* are rejected.
- FACT: *Dharma* falls on **epistemic** grounds: "virtue and vice are distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted".
- FACT: **Criterion:** a good action yields a balance of pleasure; a bad one brings more pain than pleasure. Hence hedonism.
- FACT: **Dhūrta** (cunning / crude) versus **suśikṣita** (cultured / refined) Cārvākas - "the Cārvākas were not all of the same gross, uncultured type".
- FACT: **Evidence for refinement:** sixty-four fine arts (*catuḥ-śaṣṭi-kalāḥ*) · *daṇḍanīti* and *vārttā* incorporated into Lokāyata · some Cārvākas "regard the **king as God**", implying faith in society and its head.
- FACT: **Vātsyāyana** is "the best positive evidence of refined hedonism", but he "believes in God and in life after death" and is a materialist only "according to a wider sense of the term" - one who explains higher phenomena by lower.
- FACT: **Vātsyāyana's regulation:** *brahmacarya*, urbanity (*nāgarika-vṛtti*), education of the senses through the arts; and the prudential argument that refusing to defer "would prevent a man even from the toil of cultivation and sowing seeds".
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "Egoistic hedonism in its gross form is **not compatible with social discipline**."

- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's counterweight**: "crude individual hedonism"; the school's downfall lay in "the denial of all human values"; "**the pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher.**"
- CAUTION: **The "debt and ghee" verse** - "let him feed on ghee even though he runs in debt" - is preserved in the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*, an opponent's compendium. Use with an explicit source-caution; its buried argument concerns the rationality of deferral under a finite horizon, and Vātsyāyana himself answers it.
- ANALYSIS: **Verdict**: Cārvāka's ethics is a coherent theory of **prudence** and an incomplete theory of **morality** - it supplies no qualitative ordering of pleasures and no independent account of other-regarding obligation.

Register 9 - Comparative synthesis and answer craft

Item	Register entry
2020 Jainism axes	FACT: 1 <i>pramāṇa</i> vs fivefold knowledge · 4 <i>bhūtas</i> vs 6 <i>dravyas</i> · <i>ākāśa</i> rejected vs accepted · no soul vs infinite <i>jīvas</i> with consciousness as inseparable essence · no <i>guṇa-paryāya</i> vs <i>utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya</i> · single standpoint vs <i>anekānta</i> , <i>naya</i> , <i>syādvāda</i> · no karma vs material karma (<i>bhāvabandha</i> , <i>dravyabandha</i>) · no liberation vs <i>mokṣa</i> and <i>kevala-jñāna</i>
Shared ground with Jainism	FACT: Both <i>nāstika</i> ; both realists about the perceptible world; both reject a creator God
2024 positivism verdict	ANALYSIS: Positivistic in spirit (empiricist criterion, anti-metaphysics, "meaningless" register - and the textbook itself applies the word), not in method (positivism runs on inference and has a constructive programme). Safer labels: radical empiricism , naturalistic materialism
The paradox to quote	ANALYSIS: Cārvāka reaches materialism by an anti-inferential route; modern materialism by an inferential one
Western convergences	ANALYSIS: Epicurus and Lucretius (materialism, this-worldliness) · Hume (induction unjustifiable) · Ayer (unverifiable metaphysics) · Comte (observable phenomena). Chatterjee and Datta themselves compare the Cārvāka view of inference to "the pragmatists and logical positivists" and the school's reputation to that of "the Epicureans of Greece"
10-mark spine	Thesis -> three doors -> one sharp addition (<i>upādhi</i> or self-refutation) -> verdict linking epistemology to the denial asked about
15-mark spine	Frame with the source caution -> full anti-inference argument -> the rival's positive case -> Cārvāka's best reply and its cost -> graded verdict with a named criterion
20-mark spine	Classify (epistemology generating metaphysics) -> theory of knowledge in full -> ontological consequences -> the demanded comparison on named axes -> two objections with replies and residual pressure -> criterion-named verdict
PYQ centre of gravity	FACT: 5 of 9 owned parts concern inference ; 2 the self and transcendent entities; 1 the Jaina comparison; 1 the positivism label
Criteria to name in verdicts	ANALYSIS: Evidential economy · explanatory adequacy · internal consistency · perceptual redeemability · moral sufficiency · historiographical reliability
The five safe verdicts	ANALYSIS: Critique of certainty, not a theory of knowledge · ontology impeccably derived, so vulnerability lies in the epistemology · wins on entailment, loses on <i>pramāṇa</i> -status · relocation versus dissolution of the self · complete prudence, incomplete morality
Final memory spine	MEMORY: ONE, FOUR, TWO, ZERO · three doors · wet fuel · betel and fermentation · "I am fat, I am lame, I am blind" · <i>maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i> · <i>dhūrta</i> and <i>suśikṣita</i> · touchstone

End of the complete learning session.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

High-yield use: Follow the sessions consecutively as one continuous source-derived teaching and answer-writing route.

Cārvāka / Lokāyata – COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

START / CENTRAL QUESTION

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

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--- SESSION 01: HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM

| DEFINITION / TERMS : Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: One-line memory: Cārvāka is known mostly through its critics, so reconstruct firmly but quote cautiously.

| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: That does not make reconstruction impossible; it makes epistemic honesty about the reconstruction itself a mark-earning move.

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Chatterjee and Datta state the consequence directly: the six orthodox schools are āstika, "and the Cārvāka is nāstika in both the senses".

| EXAM OPENING: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

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--- SESSION 02: EPISTEMOLOGY – PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE PRAMĀṆA

| DEFINITION / TERMS : Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda: perception alone is a pramāṇa; everything else in the system follows logically from this. Chatterjee and Datta: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend logically on their epistemology." The Cārvāka's test for pramāṇa-hood: knowledge "about which we can have no doubt" and "which must be true to reality". Both external and internal perception are admitted; consciousness is perceived, an immaterial soul is not. Cārvāka denies the inference from consciousness to a soul, not consciousness itself. "Truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one." Distinguish laukika (corrigible, practical) from pāramārthika (uncheckable, transcendental) inference; the second is the real target. Śabda in five steps: words heard are perceived → what they mean is unperceived → acceptance runs through a reliability inference → inference is precarious → testimony is not independent. Sharma's reductio: if testimony proved vyāpti, "none would be able to infer anything by himself". The Veda is rejected as the work of "cunning priests" whose promises benefit only the officiants – an epistemic charge with a sociological edge. The single template that kills upamāna, arthāpatti and anupalabdhi: each needs an unperceived universal. Sharma's charge: Cārvāka accepts perception and rejects inference from the same standpoint, lacking the saṃvṛti/paramārtha or vyāvahārika/pāramārthika distinction that saves Sūnyavāda and Advaita.

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda: perception alone is a pramāṇa; everything else in the system follows logically from this. Chatterjee and Datta: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend logically on their epistemology." The Cārvāka's test for pramāṇa-hood: knowledge "about which we can have no doubt" and "which must be true to reality". Both external and internal perception are admitted; consciousness is perceived, an immaterial soul is not. Cārvāka denies the inference from consciousness to a soul, not consciousness itself. "Truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one." Distinguish laukika (corrigible, practical) from pāramārthika (uncheckable, transcendental) inference; the second is the real target. Śabda in five steps: words heard are perceived → what they mean is unperceived → acceptance runs through a reliability inference → inference is precarious → testimony is not independent. Sharma's reductio: if testimony proved vyāpti, "none would be able to infer anything by himself". The Veda is rejected as the work of "cunning priests" whose promises benefit only the officiants – an epistemic charge with a sociological edge. The single template that kills upamāna, arthāpatti and anupalabdhi: each needs an unperceived universal. Sharma's charge: Cārvāka accepts perception and rejects inference from the same standpoint, lacking the saṃvṛti/paramārtha or vyāvahārika/pāramārthika distinction that saves Sūnyavāda and Advaita.

| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Chatterjee and Datta frame the architecture of the whole system on this thesis: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend logically on their epistemology." Every later denial – of soul, God, karma, rebirth, heaven and liberation – is a consequence drawn from this one epistemic restriction, not a separate act of unbelief.

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Chatterjee and Datta present the strongest objection to Cārvāka materialism precisely through internal perception: "do we not have a kind of perception, called internal, which gives an immediate knowledge of our mental states?"

| EXAM OPENING: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

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--- SESSION 03: THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE – VYĀPTI, UPĀDHI, THE SOCRATES SYLLOGISM AND SELF-REFUTATION

| DEFINITION / TERMS : The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference cannot establish certainty because vyāpti (invariable concomitance) cannot be universally known without circular inference and may always be defeated by an undiscovered upādhi (hidden limiting condition).

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Inference is "a leap in the dark"; some inferences are true only "accidentally".

The attack is on the major premise (vyāpti), never on syllogistic form. Door 1 (perception): all cases past, present and future can never be surveyed. Class-character reply: even dhūmatva and vahnitva cannot be perceptually known, since all instances are not perceived; and universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference. Door 2 (inference): petitio principii or infinite regress; deduction is circular, induction unwarranted. Causal relation is only a species of invariable relation and inherits the same defect. Door 3 (testimony): testimony's validity is itself inferred; and "if inference always depended on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself." Upādhi: the wet-fuel condition; unconditionality can never be perceptually certified because conditions may remain hidden. Upādhi is a problem of the right variable, not merely of sample size – which is why more observation alone cannot answer

it. Self-refutation: the universal denial of inference is itself a universal; and other minds, thoughts and ideas are never perceived. Three replies: no-thesis (vitaṇḍā) · softened certainty-thesis · level-distinction.

| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This is why the correct one-line statement of the doctrine is: the Cārvāka critique of inference is a critique of the grounding of vyāpti, not of syllogistic validity.

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Against the uncompromising formulation the self-refutation charge is decisive; against the softened formulation it loses its force but so does the doctrine, which becomes a fallibilist warning rather than a denial of a pramāṇa.

| EXAM OPENING: The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference cannot establish certainty because vyāpti (invariable concomitance) cannot be universally known without circular inference and may always be defeated by an undiscovered upādhi (hidden limiting condition).

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+- SESSION 04: THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE – AND A CRITICALLY BALANCED VERDICT

| DEFINITION / TERMS : Nyāya's reply is architectural: vyāpti is assembled through five distinguishable operations, and the burden of certainty is distributed across them.

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Nyāya's reply is architectural: vyāpti is assembled through five distinguishable operations, and the burden of certainty is distributed across them.

| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The question says "the other systems" – plural – and asks for your own verdict as a third limb. Do not present Advaita as agreeing with Cārvāka about inference.

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: In simple words: Nyāya does not claim that one casual observation proves a universal rule.

| EXAM OPENING: Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons, and a criterion-named verdict on whether they are justified.

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+- SESSION 05: METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM – FOUR BHŪTAS, THE REJECTION OF ĀKĀŚA, AND SVABHĀVAVĀDA

| DEFINITION / TERMS : Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible bhūtas (material elements) combine according to svabhāva (inherent nature) to produce the world, without requiring ākāśa (ether), a creator, or a supersensible cause.

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Cārvāka's best reply is that the soul-hypothesis renames the gap rather than closing it. Pot-and-potter: the objector needs an efficient cause; the Cārvāka answers with svabhāva and denies that design is proved. Three labels from the textbook: naturalism (svabhāvavāda), mechanism (yadrcchāvāda), and positivism ("believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena"). Separate the deflationary use of svabhāva (regularity, with no guarantee of future uniformity) from the substantive cosmological use (nature in place of God). Vedāntasāra: four materialist schools identify the self with gross body, senses, vital breaths, or manas. Cārvāka's materialism is anti-inferential; modern materialism is thoroughly inferential.

| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The elemental ledger is therefore the neatest possible demonstration that Cārvāka metaphysics is epistemology applied.

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: State the explanatory gap and the Cārvāka's reply that dualism merely renames it. Do not translate svabhāvavāda as "scientific naturalism".

| EXAM OPENING: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible bhūtas (material elements) combine according to svabhāva (inherent nature) to produce the world, without requiring ākāśa (ether), a creator, or a supersensible cause.

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+- SESSION 06: SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS – DEHĀTMAVĀDA, AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS BUDDHIST ANĀTMAN (2024, 20 MARKS)

| DEFINITION / TERMS : caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ / caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā – the person is the living body qualified by consciousness. Negative argument: "the non-material soul is never perceived."

Positive argument: "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind" – bodily predicates attach directly to "I"; on dualism they would be meaningless. Covariation: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease alter awareness. Consequence: death of the body is the end of the individual; questions of rebirth, heaven and hell "become meaningless". Sharma's objections: swoon and dreamless sleep (body without consciousness) · dreams (consciousness without body) · subject cannot be reduced to object · co-existence is not causation (light and sight; the two horns of a bull) · consciousness is neither smelt, tasted, seen, touched nor heard · consciousness is private · non-existence of the soul is equally undemonstrable. Best evaluative line: the evidence establishes dependence, and dependence is compatible with the body being the instrument rather than the cause. Memory: Nyāya/Vedānta invoke ātman; Cārvāka invokes bodily-psychological continuity; Buddhism invokes santāna, pratisandhāna and ālaya-vijñāna. 2024 contrast in one line: Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves the self into process. Cārvāka's ground is epistemic; Buddhism's is ontological (pratītyasamutpāda, kṣaṇikavāda) and soteriological (self-belief breeds craving). Cārvāka rejects rebirth, karma and mokṣa; Buddhism retains rebirth, karma and nirvāṇa without a self. Rūpa is one of the five skandhas – so Buddhist anātmā refutes the Cārvāka body-self by name. Puggalavāda (Vātsīputriya) is the internal Buddhist foil; Sadānanda's four materialisms are the internal Cārvāka foil.

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ / caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā – the person is the living body qualified by consciousness. Negative argument: "the non-material soul is never perceived."

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| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Use shared denial but different reconstruction: Cārvāka relocates self into body; Buddhism dissolves self into a causal process.

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: He denies a transcendental self and affirms a material one. Do not say Buddhism reduces the person to the body.

| EXAM OPENING: Dehātmaavāda (doctrine that the body is the self) explains consciousness as an emergent

property of the living body, whereas Buddhist anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine) analyses the person as a causal continuum without identifying self and body.

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++- SESSION 07: THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES – GOD, SOUL, KARMA, REBIRTH, HEAVEN, MOKṢA, VEDA AND RITUAL

| DEFINITION / TERMS : Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, karma (moral causation across lives), rebirth and mokṣa (liberation) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The template: X is imperceptible → only inference or testimony could reach X → neither is a pramāṇa → X is unwarranted → X is rejected. Note the gap between withholding assent and denying; the doxographies attribute denial, the argument licenses only the weaker conclusion. God falls twice over: epistemically (no pramāṇa) and explanatorily (svabhāva suffices; "no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design"). Adṛṣṭa is named explicitly among the casualties – "any unperceived law (like adṛṣṭa)". Transmigration requires a separable self, its survival, a carrier of desert, and knowledge of all three; Cārvāka cuts every one. Heaven and hell are "the inventions of the priests"; svarga is rejected because it rests on "the unproved existence of a life after death". The liberation dilemma: freedom of a soul (absurd – there is no soul) or freedom from all pain in this life (impossible – embodiment mixes pleasure and pain); residue – maraṇam eva apavargaḥ. Three ritual reductions: śrāddha and the traveller's food · food downstairs for a person upstairs · jyotiṣṭoma and "why not sacrifice their own old parents". Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha: Agnihotra, the three Vedas, the three staves and ashes are "the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness"; "the three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons" – quote with a source-caution. The jyotiṣṭoma argument is an argument from revealed preference about what the priest actually believes. Cārvāka is not the only non-theistic Indian school; it is the only one whose atheism is generated epistemologically, and the only one that also discards karma, rebirth and mokṣa. Internal tension worth noting: svabhāvavāda grounds regularity in fixed natures, while yadṛcchāvāda calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".

| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Cārvāka is the only school whose atheism follows from its epistemology and which also discards karma, rebirth and liberation. Do not forget adṛṣṭa by name.

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha summary, as reproduced by Sharma, is the sharpest form of the polemic and should be used with an explicit source-caution: "There is no heaven, no final liberation, nor any soul in another world; nor do the actions of the four castes, orders etc. produce any real effect."

| EXAM OPENING: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, karma (moral causation across lives), rebirth and mokṣa (liberation) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

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++- SESSION 08: ETHICS AND THE POLITICAL-SOCIAL MEANING – AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS JAINA REALITY (2020, 15 MARKS)

| DEFINITION / TERMS : This Cārvāka ethics may be called, therefore, hedonism or the theory that pleasure is the highest goal."

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Hence hedonism. Dhūṛta (cunning/crude) versus suśikṣita (cultured/refined) Cārvākas – the textbooks refuse a single, gross portrait. Evidence for refinement: the sixty-four fine arts (catuḥ-śaṣṭi-kalāḥ); daṇḍanīti and vārttā incorporated into Lokāyata; some Cārvākas regard the king as God. Vātsyāyana is "the best positive evidence of refined hedonism" – but he believes in God and an afterlife and so is a materialist only "in a wider sense". Vātsyāyana's regulation: brahmacarya, urbanity (nāgarika-vṛtti), education of the senses, and the argument that refusing to defer would prevent even sowing a crop. Chatterjee and Datta: "Egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline." Sharma's counterweight: "crude individual hedonism"; the school fell through "the denial of all human values"; "the pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher." The "ghee and debt" verse comes from the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha – an opponent's compendium; quote with caution, and extract the argument about deferral under a finite horizon. Chatterjee and Datta apply the word positivism to Cārvāka themselves – "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" – and compare its view of inference to the pragmatists and logical positivists. 2020 comparison: one pramāṇa versus five kinds of knowledge · four bhūtas versus six dravyas · ākāśa rejected versus accepted · no soul versus infinite jīvas with consciousness as inseparable essence · single standpoint versus anekāntavāda and syādvāda · no karma versus material karma · no liberation versus mokṣa and kevala-jñāna. Shared ground with Jainism: both nāstika, both realist about the perceptible world, both reject a creator God. Verdict: Cārvāka's ethics is a coherent theory of prudence and an incomplete theory of morality.

| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This Cārvāka ethics may be called, therefore, hedonism or the theory that pleasure is the highest goal."

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: One-line memory: this-worldly enjoyment is central, but intelligent enjoyment is not identical with reckless indulgence.

| EXAM OPENING: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

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++- SESSION 09: COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER-WRITING ARCHITECTURE

| DEFINITION / TERMS : In simple words: every Cārvāka answer should show a chain, not a list.

| MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: In simple words: every Cārvāka answer should show a chain, not a list.

| CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Use the complete 2018-2025 routing matrix and the 10/15/20-mark architecture.

| TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The synthesis-stage diagnostic questions are retained in the next section so that the complete Basic teaching remains separate from objective retrieval practice.

| EXAM OPENING: Final verdict: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) is philosophically strongest as a critique of dogmatism and weak inference, but its restriction of knowledge to perception is too narrow to explain science, ordinary reasoning and its own universal claims.

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ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

definition → exact terms → mechanism/evidence → consequence/contrast

→ objection/trap → qualified answer-use